

Frankenstein

Mary Shelley · 1818

1831 revised edition (with the 1818 Preface)

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

Common Core edition (standards shown for this framework only)

30 chapter lessons plus 3 seminar day(s), a test day and an essay day: 36 class days of 90 minutes, 5 a week (block schedule), 8 weeks
Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–30), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Whole-book test and answer key
6. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: The reading text is Mary Shelley's revised 1831 edition (Standard Ebooks, from Project Gutenberg #42324), which also prints the 1818 Preface and the 1831 Introduction. In 1818 Elizabeth is Victor's cousin; in 1831 she is the orphaned daughter of a Milanese nobleman, adopted by Victor's mother. Chapter breaks also differ (e.g. around Chapter III). Cite this edition.

Content note for teachers: The novel includes suicide, the murder of a child, a wrongful execution and the murder of a bride; see the chapter notes and the safe-messaging script.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (also 7–8; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Excerpt-based support track: these novels are above the grades 6–8 text-complexity band, so Middle School prompts work from teacher-selected passages. **Weeks:** 8. **Class days:** 36 × 90 minutes (30 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does Frankenstein suggest about the costs of unchecked ambition?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about creation and responsibility?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about isolation and the need for companionship?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about nature versus nurture?
- What does Frankenstein suggest about the sublime power of nature?

Objectives

- Cite textual evidence to support analysis of what the text says explicitly and implicitly.
- Determine themes and analyze their development over the course of the novel.
- Analyze how characters, setting and point of view interact.
- Determine the meaning of words and phrases as they are used in the text.
- Write arguments to support claims with clear reasons and relevant evidence.

Standards: Common Core

RL.7.2, RL.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2, RL.9-10.3, RL.9-10.4, RL.9-10.5, RL.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2, RL.11-12.4, RL.11-12.5, W.7.1, W.9-10.1, W.11-12.1, L.9-10.4, L.11-12.4

Common Core State Standards (ELA-Literacy), thecorestandards.org

Assessments: Daily chapter quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-book test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Middle School through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Chapter lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* Introduction Preface Letter I Letter II	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the costs of unchecked ambition* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
2	Letter III *Socratic seminar on the costs of unchecked ambition* Letter IV Chapter I Chapter II	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*creation and responsibility* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on the costs of unchecked ambition • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
3	Chapter III Chapter IV Chapter V Chapter VI Chapter VII	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*isolation and the need for companionship* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
4	Chapter VIII Chapter IX *Socratic seminar on creation and responsibility* Chapter X Chapter XI	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*nature versus nurture* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on creation and responsibility • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
5	Chapter XII Chapter XIII Chapter XIV	5 × 90 min	*the sublime power of nature* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

	Chapter XV Chapter XVI	(450 min)	do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	
6	Chapter XVII Chapter XVIII Chapter XIX *Socratic seminar on isolation and the need for companionship* Chapter XX	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*the costs of unchecked ambition* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Socratic seminar on isolation and the need for companionship • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt
7	Chapter XXI Chapter XXII Chapter XXIII Chapter XXIV *Whole-book test (90 minutes)*	5 × 90 min (450 min)	*creation and responsibility* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Whole-book test (90 minutes) • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay
8	*Final essay workshop and submission*	1 × 90 min (90 min)	*isolation and the need for companionship* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Chapter quizzes in the app • Final essay workshop and submission • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Whole-book test and final essay

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Frankenstein

Author biography

Mary Wollstonecraft Godwin was born in London on 30 August 1797, the daughter of two of the most famous radical writers of the 1790s: the philosopher William Godwin (author of Political Justice) and the feminist Mary Wollstonecraft (author of A Vindication of the Rights of Woman). Wollstonecraft died of puerperal fever about eleven days after the birth, so Mary grew up with her mother's books rather than her mother. In 1814, at sixteen, she left England with the married poet Percy Bysshe Shelley; they married in December 1816, weeks after his first wife's suicide. She began Frankenstein at eighteen and published it at twenty. Her adult life was marked by loss: three of her four children died young, and Percy drowned in Italy in July 1822. She supported herself and her surviving son by writing, produced novels including The Last Man (1826), edited Percy's poems, and died in London on 1 February 1851.

Historical and cultural context

The novel was born in the summer of 1816, the "year without a summer," when ash from the 1815 eruption of Mount Tambora in Indonesia chilled and darkened Europe. Mary, Percy, her stepsister Claire Clairmont, Lord Byron and Byron's physician John Polidori were kept indoors near Lake Geneva, and Byron proposed that each write a ghost story. The science in the air was electricity and life: Luigi Galvani had made dissected frogs' legs twitch with current, and in 1803 his nephew Giovanni Aldini publicly applied current to the corpse of an executed man in London. The book also belongs to Romanticism, a movement that prized feeling, nature and the solitary genius, and that was fascinated by Prometheus, the Titan who stole fire for humankind and was punished for it; the novel's subtitle is The Modern Prometheus. Behind it, too, is Mary's inheritance from her parents' arguments about education, injustice and how society makes people what they are.

Publication and reception, then and now

Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus appeared anonymously in three volumes on 1 January 1818 (London: Lackington, Hughes, Harding, Mavor and Jones), in an edition of about 500 copies, with a preface by Percy Shelley and a dedication to William Godwin. A second edition (1823), arranged by Godwin, named Mary as author after a stage version, Richard Brinsley Peake's Presumption, became a hit. In 1831 she revised the text heavily for Colburn and Bentley's Standard Novels and added the Introduction that tells the story of its origin; that 1831 text is the one we read.

Then: Early reviews were split. Walter Scott, in Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine (March 1818), praised its "original genius" and assumed Percy Shelley was the author; John Wilson Croker in the Quarterly Review called it "a tissue of horrible and disgusting absurdity." Many reviewers were uneasy with a story that seemed to question God and moral order, and with an anonymous author linked to Godwin's radicals.

Now: Today Frankenstein is one of the most taught novels in English. Brian Aldiss (Billion Year Spree, 1973) called it the origin of science fiction; feminist critics beginning with Ellen Moers (Literary Women, 1976) read it as a "birth myth" shaped by Mary's experience of pregnancy and infant death; others read it through politics,

race, disability and bioethics. Its title has become shorthand in debates about genetic engineering and artificial intelligence, and 2018 brought bicentenary editions and projects worldwide.

Overview (spoiler-free)

A ship's captain, Robert Walton, sailing toward the North Pole, writes letters to his sister. In the ice he rescues a dying stranger, Victor Frankenstein, who tells him how, as a young student, he discovered the secret of life and built a living being. What happens to Victor, his family and his creation is told in three nested voices: Walton's, Victor's and, at the center, the creature's own. The book asks what we owe the things we make and the people we reject.

Main themes

- creation and responsibility: what a maker owes what it makes; watch how often the creature asks to be cared for and how Victor answers.
- ambition and knowledge: the hunger to discover, shared by Walton and Victor; ask whether the book condemns curiosity or something more specific.
- isolation and companionship: almost every character is cut off from someone; notice who is allowed to belong and why.
- nature and nurture: is anyone born a monster, or are monsters made by how they are treated?
- the sublime: mountains, ice and storms that awe and dwarf human beings.

Why it matters

Frankenstein is the founding story for every argument about technology that outruns responsibility, from gene editing to artificial intelligence, and its creature still speaks for anyone judged by appearance before being heard. It also shows students that a teenager wrote one of the most influential books in the world.

Spoilers · teacher only

Victor abandons the creature the moment it wakes. Rejected by every human it meets, the creature kills Victor's brother William (and frames Justine, who is executed), demands a mate, and, when Victor destroys the half-made female, kills Clerval and then Elizabeth on her wedding night. Victor pursues the creature to the Arctic and dies on Walton's ship; the creature mourns him and vanishes into the dark to die.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
>
> *Before we open Frankenstein: Should scientists be allowed to do anything they are able to do? Write for five minutes and give an example.*
> **Prompt:** Before we open Frankenstein: Should scientists be allowed to do anything they are able to do? Write for five minutes and give an example.

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)

Romanticism (art valuing emotion, nature and the individual); the sublime (awe mixed with terror before vast nature); galvanism (electricity applied to living or dead tissue); Prometheus (the Titan who gave fire to humans); frame narrative (a story inside a story); epistolary (told in letters).

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)

About the author. Mary Wollstonecraft Godwin was born in London on 30 August 1797, the daughter of two of the most famous radical writers of the 1790s: the philosopher William Godwin (author of Political Justice) and the feminist Mary Wollstonecraft (author of A Vindication of the Rights of Woman). Wollstonecraft died of puerperal fever about eleven days after the birth, so Mary grew up with her mother's books rather than her mother. In 1814, at sixteen, she left England with the married poet Percy Bysshe Shelley; they married in December 1816, weeks after his first wife's suicide. She began Frankenstein at eighteen and published it at twenty. Her adult life was marked by loss: three of her four children died young, and Percy drowned in Italy in July 1822. She supported herself and her surviving son by writing, produced novels including The Last Man (1826), edited Percy's poems, and died in London on 1 February 1851. The world of the book. The novel was born in the summer of 1816, the "year without a summer," when ash from the 1815 eruption of Mount Tambora in Indonesia chilled and darkened Europe. Mary, Percy, her stepsister Claire Clairmont, Lord Byron and Byron's physician John Polidori were kept indoors near Lake Geneva, and Byron proposed that each write a ghost story. The science in the air was electricity and life: Luigi Galvani had made dissected frogs' legs twitch with current, and in 1803 his nephew Giovanni Aldini publicly applied current to the corpse of an executed man in London. The book also belongs to Romanticism, a movement that prized feeling, nature and the solitary genius, and that was fascinated by Prometheus, the Titan who stole fire for humankind and was punished for it; the novel's subtitle is The Modern Prometheus. Behind it, too, is Mary's inheritance from her parents' arguments about education, injustice and how society makes people what they are. Publication and reception. Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus appeared anonymously in three volumes on 1 January 1818 (London: Lackington, Hughes, Harding, Mavor and Jones), in an edition of about 500 copies, with a preface by Percy Shelley and a dedication to William Godwin. A second edition (1823), arranged by Godwin, named Mary as author after a stage version, Richard Brinsley Peake's Presumption, became a hit. In 1831 she revised the text heavily for Colburn and Bentley's Standard Novels and added the Introduction that tells the story of its origin; that 1831 text is the one we read. Then: Early reviews were split. Walter Scott, in Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine (March 1818), praised its "original genius" and assumed Percy Shelley was the author; John Wilson Croker in the Quarterly Review called it "a tissue of horrible and disgusting absurdity." Many reviewers were uneasy with a story that seemed to question God and moral order, and with an anonymous author linked to Godwin's radicals. Now: Today Frankenstein is one of the most taught novels in English. Brian Aldiss (Billion Year Spree, 1973) called it the origin of science fiction; feminist critics beginning with Ellen Moers (Literary Women, 1976) read it as a "birth myth" shaped by Mary's experience of pregnancy and infant death; others read it through politics, race, disability and bioethics. Its title has become shorthand in debates about genetic engineering and artificial intelligence, and 2018 brought bicentenary editions and projects worldwide.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)

"I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together" (Introduction, paragraph 11). Shelley's 1831 account of the waking vision that became the novel. Note "unhallowed" (unholy) and "thing": before we have read a page, the creator is a student and the creation is not yet a person.

> *I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together* *(Introduction, paragraph 11)*

Think-aloud: "I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together" (Introduction, paragraph 11). Shelley's 1831 account of the waking vision that became the novel. Note "unhallowed" (unholy) and "thing": before we have read a page, the creator is a student and the creation is not yet a person.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)

What the book is about (no spoilers): A ship's captain, Robert Walton, sailing toward the North Pole, writes letters to his sister. In the ice he rescues a dying stranger, Victor Frankenstein, who tells him how, as a young student, he discovered the secret of life and built a living being. What happens to Victor, his family and his creation is told in three nested voices: Walton's, Victor's and, at the center, the creature's own. The book asks what we owe the things we make and the people we reject. Themes to track: creation and responsibility: what a maker owes what it makes; watch how often the creature asks to be cared for and how Victor answers. ambition and knowledge: the hunger to discover, shared by Walton and Victor; ask whether the book condemns curiosity or something more specific. isolation and companionship: almost every character is cut off from someone; notice who is allowed to belong and why. nature and nurture: is anyone born a monster, or are monsters made by how they are treated? the sublime: mountains, ice and storms that awe and dwarf human beings.

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)

Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Theme page "creation and responsibility": Prediction: Victor will regret what he makes. Question: will he ever take care of it?
Task: Set up a reading journal for Frankenstein: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Theme page "creation and responsibility": Prediction: Victor will regret what he makes. Question: will he ever take care of it?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Why does Frankenstein still matter? Frankenstein is the founding story for every argument about technology that outruns responsibility, from gene editing to artificial intelligence, and its creature still speaks for anyone judged by appearance before being heard. It also shows students that a teenager wrote one of the most influential books in the world.
Anchor question: Why might Frankenstein still be taught today?
Facilitation: Frankenstein is the founding story for every argument about technology that outruns responsibility, from gene editing to artificial intelligence, and its creature still speaks for anyone judged by appearance before being heard. It also shows students that a teenager wrote one of the most influential books in the world.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)

Name one fact about Mary Shelley's life or the summer of 1816 that you expect to matter in the novel, and explain why. Answer: Examples: her mother died after giving birth to her (the novel is about a creator who abandons what he brings to life); the ghost-story contest (the book began as a tale of terror); galvanism (Victor's science echoes real experiments).
Exit ticket: Name one fact about Mary Shelley's life or the summer of 1816 that you expect to matter in the novel, and explain why.
Answer: Examples: her mother died after giving birth to her (the novel is about a creator who abandons what he brings to life); the ghost-story contest (the book began as a tale of terror); galvanism (Victor's science echoes real experiments).

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)

Tomorrow we begin reading: Introduction.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/Mary-Wollstonecraft-Shelley); Mary Shelley, Introduction to the 1831 edition (in this reading text); British Library, "Frankenstein: the 1818 first edition" (https://www.bl.uk/collection-items/frankenstein-first-edition); Walter Scott, review in Blackwood's Edinburgh Magazine 2 (March 1818); John Wilson Croker, Quarterly Review 18 (January 1818) (https://romantic-circles.org/reference/chronologies/mschronology/reviews.html); Brian Aldiss, Billion Year Spree (1973); Ellen Moers, Literary Women (1976) (https://www.worldcat.org/); Library of Congress/NEH Frankenstein bicentennial resources (https://www.neh.gov/humanities/2018/winter/feature/the-strange-and-twisted-life-frankenstein)

Flags (verify before teaching):

- The exact night of the ghost-story proposal and of Mary's waking dream is uncertain: her 1831 account compresses events, and Polidori's diary points to mid-June 1816. Present the 1831 story as her own later recollection.
- The extent of Percy Shelley's edits to the 1818 manuscript is debated (Charles E. Robinson's 2008 edition marks his contributions). He wrote the 1818 Preface; the novel is Mary's.
- The first-edition print run is usually given as about 500 copies; treat it as approximate.

Lesson 2: Introduction

Focus: the origin of the novel and the idea of creation

Teacher only · spoilers

Writing in 1831, Shelley explains how the novel began: a rainy summer near Geneva in 1816, a ghost-story contest with Byron and Percy Shelley, conversations about galvanism, and a waking vision of a 'pale student of unhallowed arts' kneeling beside the thing he had put together. She calls the book her 'hideous progeny.'

Background: The 1816 'year without a summer' followed the eruption of Mount Tambora. Galvani's experiments making frog legs twitch with electricity fed public speculation about reanimation.

Significance: The Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....
Prompt: Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: platitude — dullness; a lack of freshness or originality; invocations — calls or appeals for help or inspiration; retrospection — looking back on the past; galvanism — electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles; beatings — beats; throbs (of the heart). "galvanism": Named after Luigi Galvani (1737–1798), the Bologna anatomist who made dead frogs' legs twitch with electric current; galvanism meant electricity produced by chemical action.
Words: platitude: dullness; a lack of freshness or originality · invocations: calls or appeals for help or inspiration · retrospection: looking back on the past · galvanism: electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles · beatings: beats; throbs (of the heart)

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The 1816 'year without a summer' followed the eruption of Mount Tambora. Galvani's experiments making frog legs twitch with electricity fed public speculation about reanimation. The Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making. Point of view: Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan. Allusion: The Introduction is thick with real names (Byron, Percy Shelley, Dr. Darwin, galvanism). Each one ties the fiction to real science and real literary rivalry, which is why the story felt possible to its first readers. Imagery: The vision is told in sharp visual details: the kneeling student, the "hideous phantasm," the yellow, watery eyes. Students will meet these images again in Chapter V; flag them now. Watch for the dream: Dreams recur through the novel (Victor's nightmare after the creation). Here the dream is creative; later it becomes a punishment.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together" (Introduction, paragraph 11). "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. That is point of view at work: Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan.

> *I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together (Introduction, paragraph 11)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together" (Introduction, paragraph 11). "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. That is point of view at work: Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Hideous" admits the book is frightening; "progeny" (offspring) makes her its mother; "prosper" is a parent's blessing. Link: Victor makes a creature but never blesses it, so the line sets up the theme of responsibility. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. (Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.)

> *And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper* (Introduction, paragraph 15)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Hideous" admits the book is frightening; "progeny" (offspring) makes her its mother; "prosper" is a parent's blessing. Link: Victor makes a creature but never blesses it, so the line sets up the theme of responsibility.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. (Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for point of view, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Introduction develops the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. When the text says "And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper" (Introduction, paragraph 15), it shows this directly. By calling the book her "hideous progeny" she uses the language of parenthood; wishing it to "prosper" is exactly the blessing the creature never receives, so the frame sets up the novel's test of what makers owe what they make.

Task: Annotate the chapter for point of view, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Introduction develops the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. When the text says "And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper" (Introduction, paragraph 15), it shows this directly. By calling the book her "hideous progeny" she uses the language of parenthood; wishing it to "prosper" is exactly the blessing the creature never receives, so the frame sets up the novel's test of what makers owe what they make.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor? If students say the Introduction "is just background," ask why Shelley added it in 1831: how does knowing a nineteen-year-old dreamed this change how we read the book? Expect a split on whether the dream story is literally true. Use the teacher-notes flag: it is her later recollection, and that is itself a choice.

Anchor question: Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor?

Facilitation: If students say the Introduction "is just background," ask why Shelley added it in 1831: how does knowing a nineteen-year-old dreamed this change how we read the book? · Expect a split on whether the dream story is literally true. Use the teacher-notes flag: it is her later recollection, and that is itself a choice.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. ("And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper", Introduction, paragraph 15). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. ("And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper", Introduction, paragraph 15). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Key takeaway: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan.
- **Allusion:** The Introduction is thick with real names (Byron, Percy Shelley, Dr. Darwin, galvanism). Each one ties the fiction to real science and real literary rivalry, which is why the story felt possible to its first readers.
- **Imagery:** The vision is told in sharp visual details: the kneeling student, the "hideous phantasm," the yellow, watery eyes. Students will meet these images again in Chapter V; flag them now.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give.

Symbols and motifs

- **the dream:** Dreams recur through the novel (Victor's nightmare after the creation). Here the dream is creative; later it becomes a punishment.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together" (Introduction, paragraph 11) "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image.
- "And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper" (Introduction, paragraph 15) Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.
- "Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos" (Introduction, paragraph 9) Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care.
Evidence: "And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper" (Introduction, paragraph 15)
Reasoning: By calling the book her "hideous progeny" she uses the language of parenthood; wishing it to "prosper" is exactly the blessing the creature never receives, so the frame sets up the novel's test of what makers owe what they make.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
platitude (noun)	dullness; a lack of freshness or originality	*The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
invocations (noun)	calls or appeals for help or inspiration	*I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
retrospection (noun)	looking back on the past	*Blank and dreary on retrospection I call them; they were not so to me then.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
galvanism (noun)	electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles	*Perhaps a corpse would be reanimated; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth.*	"galvanism": Named after Luigi Galvani (1737–1798), the Bologna anatomist who made dead frogs' legs twitch with electric current; galvanism meant electricity produced by chemical action. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/galvanism)
			Student look-up (not yet verified)

beatings (noun)	beats; throbs (of the heart)	*One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the beatings of the heart.*	
reanimated (verb)	brought back to life or strength; revived	*Perhaps a corpse would be reanimated; galvanism had given token of such things: perhaps the component parts of a creature might be manufactured, brought together, and endued with vital warmth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
appertain (verb)	to belong to or be connected with	*In all matters of discovery and invention, even of those that appertain to the imagination, we are continually reminded of the story of Columbus and his egg.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cradled (verb)	held gently, as in a cradle	*The shape was lost beneath the shadow of the castle walls; but soon a gate swung back, a step was heard, the door of the chamber opened, and he advanced to the couch of the blooming youths, cradled in healthy sleep.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inciting (verb)	give an incentive for action	*He was forever inciting me to obtain literary reputation, which even on my own part I cared for then, though since I have become infinitely indifferent to it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
parquet (noun)	a wooden floor laid in a pattern	*I see them still; the very room, the dark parquet, the closed shutters, with the moonlight struggling through, and the sense I had that the glassy lake and white high Alps were beyond.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where was Shelley staying when the ghost-story contest began? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Near Geneva, Switzerland
2. Who proposed that each guest write a ghost story? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lord Byron
3. What scientific topic did the group discuss that influenced the idea? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Galvanism and the principle of life
4. How did the central image of the novel come to Shelley? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed
5. What does Shelley call her book? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Her hideous progeny
6. Retell the three most important events of "Introduction" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Writing in 1831, Shelley explains how the novel began: a rainy summer near Geneva in 1816, a ghost-story contest with Byron and Percy Shelley, conversations about galvanism, and a waking vision of a 'pale student of unhallowed arts' kneeling beside the thing he had put together. She calls the book her 'hideous progeny.'
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Introduction"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Introduction" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task." What does "platitude" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: platitude: dullness; a lack of freshness or originality.
10. Reread: "I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations." What does "invocations" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: invocations: calls or appeals for help or inspiration.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Introduction" suggest about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The

Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making.

2. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the allusion in this chapter shape what we understand about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.9] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11): "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. On allusion: The Introduction is thick with real names (Byron, Percy Shelley, Dr. Darwin, galvanism). Each one ties the fiction to real science and real literary rivalry, which is why the story felt possible to its first readers. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “I busied myself to think of a story—a story to rival those which had excited us to this task.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Introduction”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Writing in 1831, Shelley explains how the novel began: a rainy summer near Geneva in 1816, a ghost-story contest with Byron and Percy Shelley, conversations about galvanism, and a waking vision of a 'pale student of unhallowed arts' kneeling beside the thing he had put together. She calls the book…
6. As the opening chapter, what does “Introduction” set up that the rest of Frankenstein will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15): Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9): Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models

the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Shelley calls her book her 'hideous progeny.' How does that phrase connect the author to Victor?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11): "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. On imagery: The vision is told in sharp visual details: the kneeling student, the "hideous phantasm," the yellow, watery eyes. Students will meet these images again in Chapter V; flag them now. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The 1816 'year without a summer' followed the eruption of Mount Tambora. Galvani's experiments making frog legs twitch with electricity fed public speculation about reanimation. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15): Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The Introduction is one of the most famous origin stories in literature and frames the novel as both a dream and a deliberate artistic creation, mirroring Victor's own act of making.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9): Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11): "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Introduction” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15): Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it. On point of view: Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Introduction”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9): Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11): "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper."

The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15): Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it. On point of view: Shelley speaks in her own voice, thirteen years later, as an author looking back. She shapes a legend about herself: a shy young woman among famous poets who cannot think of a story until a vision comes. Ask students what she gains by presenting the book as a dream rather than a plan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Introduction” treats the origin of the novel and the idea of creation with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9): Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Preface” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “I saw the pale student of unhallowed arts kneeling beside the thing he had put together” (Introduction, paragraph 11): "Unhallowed" means unholy, and "thing" refuses the creation a name. Students can use this to argue that the novel judges the act of creation as a transgression from its first image. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “And now, once again, I bid my hideous progeny go forth and prosper” (Introduction, paragraph 15): Shelley presents herself as a parent of the book. Use this to connect author and character: both make something "hideous," but only one blesses it.

Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Shelley frames her novel as a creation that, unlike Victor's, is accepted and sent out with care. Useful evidence: “Invention, it must be humbly admitted, does not consist in creating out of void, but out of chaos” (Introduction, paragraph 9): Shelley's theory of creativity: you build from existing materials, as Victor builds from old bones. Good evidence for a claim about the novel's self-awareness. Theme link: Shelley calls the book her "hideous progeny" and sends it out into the world, as Victor does his creature; but unlike Victor she wishes it to "prosper." The author models the care the character fails to give. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Allusion**: references to other books, myths, history or religion
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz

1. Where was Shelley staying when the ghost-story contest began?
   A. In London
   B. In Venice
   C. On a ship to the Arctic
   D. Near Geneva, Switzerland
2. Who proposed that each guest write a ghost story?
   A. Lord Byron
   B. Victor Frankenstein
   C. Shelley's father
   D. Robert Walton
3. What scientific topic did the group discuss that influenced the idea?
   A. Galvanism and the principle of life
   B. Astronomy
   C. Steam engines
   D. Botany
4. How did the central image of the novel come to Shelley?
   A. While reading a play
   B. In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed

C. In a letter from a friend

D. From a newspaper story

5. What does Shelley call her book?

A. Her little ghost

B. Her Prometheus

C. Her summer diary

D. Her hideous progeny

6. In the line “The illustrious poets also, annoyed by the platitude of prose, speedily relinquished their uncongenial task.”, what does “platitude” most nearly mean?

A. looking back on the past

B. calls or appeals for help or inspiration

C. electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles

D. dullness; a lack of freshness or originality

7. In the line “I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations.”, what does “invocations” most nearly mean?

A. electricity produced by chemical action, used in early experiments on muscles

B. calls or appeals for help or inspiration

C. looking back on the past

D. dullness; a lack of freshness or originality

Answer key: 1. D (Near Geneva, Switzerland); 2. A (Lord Byron); 3. A (Galvanism and the principle of life); 4. B (In a vivid waking vision as she lay in bed); 5. D (Her hideous progeny); 6. D (dullness; a lack of freshness or originality); 7. B (calls or appeals for help or inspiration)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Introduction,” how does Shelley show the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Introduction, how does Shelley develop the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Introduction develops the idea of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and allusion shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Introduction (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of the

origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Introduction suggests about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and allusion), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Introduction to complicate the reader's understanding of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Introduction within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Introduction alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Introduction and its treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and allusion, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Introduction as evidence for a larger claim about the origin of the novel and the idea of creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Introduction as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the origin of the novel and the idea of creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Blank and dreary on retrospection I call them; they were not so to me then.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “retrospection” most nearly mean?

   A. give an incentive for action

   B. a wooden floor laid in a pattern

   C. looking back on the past

D. held gently, as in a cradle

2. *I busied myself to think of a story—a story to rival those which had excited us to this task. One which would speak to the mysterious fears of our nature, and awaken thrilling horror—one to make the reader dread to look round, to curdle the blood, and quicken the beatings of the heart. If I did not accomplish these things, my ghost story would be unworthy of its name. I thought and pondered—vainly. I felt that blank incapability of invention which is the greatest misery of authorship, when dull Nothing replies to our anxious invocations. Have you thought of a story? I was asked each morning, and each morning I was forced to reply with a mortifying negative.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Introduction"?

A. Language, knowledge and sorrow

B. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

C. Loss and leaving home

D. The meeting of two ambitious men

SAT key: 1. C (looking back on the past); 2. B (The origin of the novel and the idea of creation)

Lesson 3: Preface

Focus: the author's stated purpose

Teacher only · spoilers

The 1818 Preface (written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice) claims the central event is not impossible according to some physiologists, insists the story aims to show 'the amiableness of domestic affection,' and recalls the ghost-story origin.

Background: Prefaces in the period often defended novels against charges of immorality or absurdity. Erasmus Darwin, mentioned here, was a well-known physician and poet who speculated about life.

Significance: The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....
Prompt: Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: innovate — to make changes; to introduce something new; scrupled — hesitated because of a moral doubt; spectres — ghosts; environs — the area in which something exists or lives; disadvantages — the quality of having an inferior or less favorable position. “scrupled”: From Latin scrupulus "small sharp stone; uneasiness," the image of a pebble in one's shoe; the verb means "to hesitate on grounds of conscience."
Words: innovate: to make changes; to introduce something new · scrupled: hesitated because of a moral doubt · spectres: ghosts · environs: the area in which something exists or lives · disadvantages: the quality of having an inferior or less favorable position

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Prefaces in the period often defended novels against charges of immorality or absurdity. Erasmus Darwin, mentioned here, was a well-known physician and poet who speculated about life. The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work. Tone / mood: The 1818 Preface is defensive and reasonable. It insists the event is "not of impossible occurrence" and that the book is moral. The tone tells us what readers of 1818 might object to: impiety and absurdity. Allusion: "Dr. Darwin" is Erasmus Darwin, physician and poet (Charles Darwin's grandfather), whose speculations about life were well known. Citing him borrows scientific authority. Point of view: The Preface was written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice. Students can discuss how a "frame" around a book tells readers how to read it. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "and in the evenings we crowded around a blazing wood fire, and occasionally amused ourselves with some German stories of ghosts, which" (Preface, paragraph 4).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue" (Preface, paragraph 3). The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. That is tone / mood at work: The 1818 Preface is defensive and reasonable. It insists the event is "not of impossible occurrence" and that the book is moral. The tone tells us what readers of 1818 might object to: impiety and absurdity.

> *the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue (Preface, paragraph 3)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue" (Preface, paragraph 3). The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. That is tone / mood at work: The 1818 Preface is defensive and reasonable. It insists the event is "not of impossible occurrence" and that the book is moral. The tone tells us what readers of 1818 might object to: impiety and absurdity.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Not of impossible occurrence" is a cautious double negative: the writer claims only that science does not rule it out. This shows the book defending itself, which tells us how daring the idea was in 1818. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. (A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.)

> *The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence (Preface, paragraph 1)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Not of impossible occurrence" is a cautious double negative: the writer claims only that science does not rule it out. This shows the book defending itself, which tells us how daring the idea was in 1818.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. (A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for tone / mood, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the author's stated purpose? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Preface develops the idea of the author's stated purpose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. When the text says "The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence" (Preface, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. By citing Dr. Darwin and German physiologists it claims the event is "not of impossible occurrence," and by naming domestic affection and virtue as its aims it answers the charge that a horror story is immoral.

Task: Annotate the chapter for tone / mood, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the author's stated purpose? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Preface develops the idea of the author's stated purpose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. When the text says “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. By citing Dr. Darwin and German physiologists it claims the event is "not of impossible occurrence," and by naming domestic affection and virtue as its aims it answers the charge that a horror story is immoral.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins? Ask whether a book needs to defend itself. What would a reader in 1818 have found offensive in a man creating life?

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Facilitation: Ask whether a book needs to defend itself. What would a reader in 1818 have found offensive in a man creating life?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the author's stated purpose? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. ("The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence", Preface, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the author's stated purpose? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. ("The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence", Preface, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how tone / mood shapes the author's stated purpose. Key takeaway: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Tone / mood:** The 1818 Preface is defensive and reasonable. It insists the event is "not of impossible occurrence" and that the book is moral. The tone tells us what readers of 1818 might object to: impiety and absurdity.
- **Allusion:** "Dr. Darwin" is Erasmus Darwin, physician and poet (Charles Darwin's grandfather), whose speculations about life were well known. Citing him borrows scientific authority.
- **Point of view:** The Preface was written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice. Students can discuss how a "frame" around a book tells readers how to read it.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "and in the evenings we crowded around a blazing wood fire, and occasionally amused ourselves with some German stories of ghosts, which" (Preface, paragraph 4).

- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “my two friends left me on a journey among the Alps, and lost, in the magnificent scenes which they present, all memory” (Preface, paragraph 5).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1) A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science.
- “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3) The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld.
- “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4) Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality.
Evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1)
Reasoning: By citing Dr. Darwin and German physiologists it claims the event is "not of impossible occurrence," and by naming domestic affection and virtue as its aims it answers the charge that a horror story is immoral.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
innovate (verb)	to make changes; to introduce something new	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
scrupled (verb)	hesitated because of a moral doubt	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	“scrupled”: From Latin scrupulus "small sharp stone; uneasiness," the image of a pebble in one's shoe; the verb means "to hesitate on grounds of conscience." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/scruple)
spectres (noun)	ghosts	*The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

environs (noun)	the area in which something exists or lives	*I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disadvantages (noun)	the quality of having an inferior or less favorable position	*The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
elementary (adjective)	basic; fundamental	*I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ghostly (adjective)	resembling or characteristic of a phantom	*The weather, however, suddenly became serene; and my two friends left me on a journey among the Alps, and lost, in the magnificent scenes which they present, all memory of their ghostly visions.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
weaving (verb)	interlace by or as if by weaving	*I shall not be supposed as according the remotest degree of serious faith to such an imagination; yet, in assuming it as the basis of a work of fancy, I have not considered myself as merely weaving a series of supernatural terrors.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
occurrence (noun)	an event that happens	*Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence.*	“occurrence”: From Latin occurrere "to run to meet," from ob- "toward" + currere "to run." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/occurrence)
expedient (noun)	a means to an end; not necessarily a principled or ethical one	*It was commenced partly as a source of amusement, and partly as an expedient for exercising any untried resources of mind.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins?
2. Where does tone / mood appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which scientist does the Preface mention as having supposed the event possible? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Dr. Darwin
2. According to the Preface, what value does the story hope to display? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The amiableness of domestic affection
3. What kind of writing does the Preface compare the work to? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Great works such as the Iliad and Shakespeare's plays
4. What is the tone of the Preface? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Measured and defensive of the book's seriousness
5. What season and weather does the Preface recall? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A cold, rainy summer
6. Retell the three most important events of “Preface” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The 1818 Preface (written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice) claims the central event is not impossible according to some physiologists, insists the story aims to show 'the amiableness of domestic affection,' and recalls the ghost-story origin.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Preface”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Preface” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.” What does “innovate” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: innovate: to make changes; to introduce something new.
10. Reread: “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.” What does “scrupled” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: scrupled: hesitated because of a moral doubt.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Preface” suggest about the author's stated purpose? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work.

2. Find one example of tone / mood in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about the author's stated purpose? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1): A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Preface”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: The 1818 Preface (written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice) claims the central event is not impossible according to some physiologists, insists the story aims to show 'the amiableness of domestic affection,' and recalls the ghost-story origin.
6. How does “Preface” build on “Introduction”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3): The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4): Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might an author defend the 'possibility' of a fantastic event before the story begins?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed

your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

9. Where does allusion appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.9] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1): A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science. On allusion: "Dr. Darwin" is Erasmus Darwin, physician and poet (Charles Darwin's grandfather), whose speculations about life were well known. Citing him borrows scientific authority. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Prefaces in the period often defended novels against charges of immorality or absurdity. Erasmus Darwin, mentioned here, was a well-known physician and poet who speculated about life. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3): The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The Preface sets up the tension between scientific plausibility and moral fable that runs through the whole work.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4): Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible

occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1): A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Preface” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the author's stated purpose? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3): The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. On point of view: The Preface was written by Percy Shelley in Mary's voice. Students can discuss how a "frame" around a book tells readers how to read it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Preface”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4): Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1): A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the tone / mood in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3): The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. On tone / mood:

The 1818 Preface is defensive and reasonable. It insists the event is "not of impossible occurrence" and that the book is moral. The tone tells us what readers of 1818 might object to: impiety and absurdity. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Preface” treats the author's stated purpose with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4): Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Letter I” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence” (Preface, paragraph 1): A careful double negative: not "possible," only "not impossible." Evidence that the book presents itself as grounded in real science. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the author's stated purpose? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “the amiableness of domestic affection, and the excellence of universal virtue” (Preface, paragraph 3): The stated moral purpose. Students can test whether the plot actually shows this, or shows what happens when domestic affection is withheld. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The Preface tries to make a shocking story respectable by grounding it in science and morality. Useful evidence: “I passed the summer of 1816 in the environs of Geneva” (Preface, paragraph 4): Places the book in real time and place; compare with the 1831 Introduction's fuller account. Theme link: The Preface claims the story shows "the amiableness of domestic affection"; keep this phrase on the board. The novel will test it: domestic love is shown, then destroyed.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Allusion**: references to other books, myths, history or religion

Chapter quiz

1. Which scientist does the Preface mention as having supposed the event possible?
   A. Isaac Newton
   B. Galileo
   C. Humphry Davy
   D. Dr. Darwin
2. According to the Preface, what value does the story hope to display?
   A. The wealth of nations
   B. The glory of war
   C. The beauty of cities
   D. The amiableness of domestic affection
3. What kind of writing does the Preface compare the work to?
   A. Great works such as the Iliad and Shakespeare's plays
   B. Cookbooks
   C. Newspaper reports
   D. Sermons
4. What is the tone of the Preface?
   A. Angry and accusatory
   B. Measured and defensive of the book's seriousness
   C. Comic and mocking
   D. Romantic and lovesick
5. What season and weather does the Preface recall?
   A. A cold, rainy summer
   B. An autumn harvest
   C. A snowy winter in London
   D. A hot spring in Italy
6. In the line “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.”, what does “innovate” most nearly mean?
   A. to make changes; to introduce something new
   B. hesitated because of a moral doubt

C. the area in which something exists or lives

D. ghosts

7. In the line “I have thus endeavoured to preserve the truth of the elementary principles of human nature, while I have not scrupled to innovate upon their combinations.”, what does “scrupled” most nearly mean?

A. to make changes; to introduce something new

B. ghosts

C. the area in which something exists or lives

D. hesitated because of a moral doubt

Answer key: 1. D (Dr. Darwin); 2. D (The amiableness of domestic affection); 3. A (Great works such as the Iliad and Shakespeare's plays); 4. B (Measured and defensive of the book's seriousness); 5. A (A cold, rainy summer); 6. A (to make changes; to introduce something new); 7. D (hesitated because of a moral doubt)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Preface,” how does Shelley show the author's stated purpose? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Preface, how does Shelley develop the idea of the author's stated purpose? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the tone / mood in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Preface develops the idea of the author's stated purpose. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Preface (where it begins, turns and ends) and its tone / mood shape the reader's understanding of the author's stated purpose. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Preface suggests about the author's stated purpose. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's tone / mood and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses tone / mood in Preface to complicate the reader's understanding of the author's stated purpose. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Preface within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the author's stated purpose

responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Preface alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the author's stated purpose follows or bends those conventions, using the tone / mood as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Preface and its treatment of the author's stated purpose. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's tone / mood and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Preface as evidence for a larger claim about the author's stated purpose in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Preface as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the author's stated purpose. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “spectres” most nearly mean?

   A. interlace by or as if by weaving

   B. ghosts

   C. a means to an end; not necessarily a principled or ethical one

   D. an event that happens

2. *The event on which this fiction is founded, has been supposed, by Dr. Darwin, and some of the physiological writers of Germany, as not of impossible occurrence. I shall not be supposed as according the remotest degree of serious faith to such an imagination; yet, in assuming it as the basis of a work of fancy, I have not considered myself as merely weaving a series of supernatural terrors. The event on which the interest of the story depends is exempt from the disadvantages of a mere tale of spectres or enchantment. It was recommended by the novelty of the situations which it develops; and, however impossible as a physical fact, affords a point of view to the imagination for the delineating of human passions more comprehensive and commanding than any which the ordinary relations of existing events can yield.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Preface”?

   A. A privileged childhood and family love

   B. The first spark of obsession

C. Confrontation between creator and creation

D. The author's stated purpose

SAT key: 1. B (ghosts); 2. D (The author's stated purpose)

Lesson 4: Letter I

Focus: ambition and the hunger for discovery

Teacher only · spoilers

Robert Walton writes to his sister Margaret Saville from St. Petersburg. He is about to sail toward the North Pole, eager to discover a passage and the secret of the magnet, and he describes his self-education and longing for glory.

Background: Arctic exploration and the search for a Northwest Passage were major public dreams in the early 1800s. Letters were a popular novel form (the epistolary novel).

Significance: Walton is Victor's double: an ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because....
Prompt: What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: enticement — something that tempts or attracts; fluctuate — to rise and fall; to change often; effusions — an unrestrained expression of emotion; satiate — fill to satisfaction; foretaste — an early limited awareness of something yet to occur. “fluctuate”: From Latin fluctuare "to move in waves," from fluctus "a wave," from fluere "to flow."
Words: enticement: something that tempts or attracts · fluctuate: to rise and fall; to change often · effusions: an unrestrained expression of emotion · satiate: fill to satisfaction · foretaste: an early limited awareness of something yet to occur

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)

Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).

Arctic exploration and the search for a Northwest Passage were major public dreams in the early 1800s. Letters were a popular novel form (the epistolary novel). Walton is Victor's double: an ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor. Point of view: The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story. Characterization: Walton is ardent, self-educated and lonely; his ambition is described in the same glowing language Victor will use. Mark his superlatives. Setting: St. Petersburg and the far North: the cold, unknown pole stands for the limits of human knowledge. Watch for light and the pole: Walton imagines the pole as a land of light and warmth; the novel will reverse this into darkness and ice.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)

Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.

I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings" (Letter I, paragraph 1). The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. That is point of view at work: The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story.

> *You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings (Letter I, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings" (Letter I, paragraph 1). The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. That is point of view at work: The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Satiate" makes curiosity sound like hunger; "ardent" means burning. Together they suggest an appetite that could consume him, linking to the theme of ambition. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. ("Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.)

> *I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited (Letter I, paragraph 2)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Satiate" makes curiosity sound like hunger; "ardent" means burning. Together they suggest an appetite that could consume him, linking to the theme of ambition.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. ("Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for point of view, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about ambition and the hunger for discovery? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter I develops the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. When the text says "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. His dream of a land "never before visited" and his heart that glows with enthusiasm use the same fevered vocabulary Victor will use about creating life, which invites readers to compare the two men.
Task: Annotate the chapter for point of view, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about ambition and the hunger for discovery? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter I develops the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. When the text says "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. His dream of a land "never before visited" and his heart that glows with enthusiasm use the same fevered vocabulary Victor will use about creating life, which invites readers to compare the two men.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character? Some students will admire Walton. Let them; then ask what his sister's "evil forebodings" are for.
Anchor question: What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character?
Facilitation: Some students will admire Walton. Let them; then ask what his sister's "evil forebodings" are for.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about ambition and the hunger for discovery? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. ("I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited", Letter I, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about ambition and the hunger for discovery? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. ("I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited", Letter I, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how point of view shapes ambition and the hunger for discovery. Key takeaway: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story.
- **Characterization:** Walton is ardent, self-educated and lonely; his ambition is described in the same glowing language Victor will use. Mark his superlatives.
- **Setting:** St. Petersburg and the far North: the cold, unknown pole stands for the limits of human knowledge.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and the pole:** Walton imagines the pole as a land of light and warmth; the novel will reverse this into darkness and ice.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings" (Letter I, paragraph 1) The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing.
- "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2) "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity.
- "I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven" (Letter I, paragraph 3) Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears.
Evidence: "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2)
Reasoning: His dream of a land "never before visited" and his heart that glows with enthusiasm use the same fevered vocabulary Victor will use about creating life, which invites readers to compare the two men.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
enticement (noun)	something that tempts or attracts	*My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
fluctuate (verb)	to rise and fall; to change often	*My courage and my resolution is firm; but my hopes fluctuate, and my spirits are often depressed.*	"fluctuate": From Latin fluctuare "to move in waves," from fluctus "a wave," from fluere "to flow." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/fluctuate)
effusions (noun)	an unrestrained expression of emotion	*These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
satiate (verb)	fill to satisfaction	*I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited, and may tread a*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		land never before imprinted by the foot of man.	
foretaste (noun)	an early limited awareness of something yet to occur	*This breeze, which has travelled from the regions towards which I am advancing, gives me a foretaste of those icy climes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
entranced (verb)	attract; cause to be enamored	*These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
diffusing (verb)	spreading out	*There, Margaret, the sun is forever visible; its broad disk just skirting the horizon, and diffusing a perpetual splendour.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sledges (noun)	a vehicle mounted on runners and pulled by horses or dogs; for transportation over snow	*They fly quickly over the snow in their sledges; the motion is pleasant, and, in my opinion, far more agreeable than that of an English stagecoach.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
seafaring (adjective)	used on the high seas	*These volumes were my study day and night, and my familiarity with them increased that regret which I had felt, as a child, on learning that my father's dying injunction had forbidden my uncle to allow me to embark in a seafaring life.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
forebodings (noun)	a feeling of evil to come	*You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19,

20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. To whom is Walton writing? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His sister, Margaret Saville
2. Where is Walton when he writes the first letter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: St. Petersburg
3. What does Walton hope to discover? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A passage near the pole and the secret of the magnet
4. How did Walton educate himself as a boy? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Reading his uncle's library of voyages
5. What does Walton's ambition foreshadow? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Victor's own dangerous pursuit of knowledge
6. Retell the three most important events of "Letter I" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Robert Walton writes to his sister Margaret Saville from St. Petersburg. He is about to sail toward the North Pole, eager to discover a passage and the secret of the magnet, and he describes his self-education and longing for glory.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Letter I"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Letter I" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path." What does "enticement" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: enticement: something that tempts or attracts.
10. Reread: "My courage and my resolution is firm; but my hopes fluctuate, and my spirits are often depressed." What does "fluctuate" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: fluctuate: to rise and fall; to change often.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Letter I" suggest about ambition and the hunger for discovery? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Walton is Victor's double: an ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor.
2. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the foreshadowing in this chapter shape what we understand about ambition and the hunger for discovery? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings” (Letter I, paragraph 1): The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Letter I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Robert Walton writes to his sister Margaret Saville from St. Petersburg. He is about to sail toward the North Pole, eager to discover a passage and the secret of the magnet, and he describes his self-education and longing for glory.
6. How does “Letter I” build on “Preface”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited” (Letter I, paragraph 2): "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven” (Letter I, paragraph 3): Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture. On characterization: Walton is ardent, self-educated and lonely; his ambition is described in the same glowing language Victor will use. Mark his superlatives. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What do Walton's dreams of the North Pole reveal about his character?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “You will rejoice to hear

that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings" (Letter I, paragraph 1): The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. On characterization: Walton is ardent, self-educated and lonely; his ambition is described in the same glowing language Victor will use. Mark his superlatives. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Arctic exploration and the search for a Northwest Passage were major public dreams in the early 1800s. Letters were a popular novel form (the epistolary novel). How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: "I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited" (Letter I, paragraph 2): "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity. On setting: St. Petersburg and the far North: the cold, unknown pole stands for the limits of human knowledge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "Walton is Victor's double: an ambitious man willing to risk others for discovery. The frame narrative invites readers to judge whether he will learn from Victor." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: "I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven" (Letter I, paragraph 3): Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: "You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings" (Letter I, paragraph 1): The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. On characterization: Walton is ardent, self-educated and lonely; his ambition is described in the same glowing language Victor will use. Mark his superlatives. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of "Letter I" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about ambition and the hunger for discovery? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited” (Letter I, paragraph 2): "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity. On point of view: The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Letter I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven” (Letter I, paragraph 3): Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings” (Letter I, paragraph 1): The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited” (Letter I, paragraph 2): "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity. On point of view: The novel opens in letters from Robert Walton to his sister Margaret Saville. The epistolary form makes us readers of private letters and puts a listener (Margaret, and us) at the edge of the story. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Letter I” treats ambition and the hunger for discovery with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the

novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven” (Letter I, paragraph 3): Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Letter II” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings” (Letter I, paragraph 1): The first sentence already contains a warning (his sister's "evil forebodings"). Strong evidence for foreshadowing. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about ambition and the hunger for discovery? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I shall satiate my ardent curiosity with the sight of a part of the world never before visited” (Letter I, paragraph 2): "Satiate" (fully satisfy) and "ardent" reveal appetite-like ambition. Use for a claim about the dangers of curiosity. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton is introduced as a mirror for Victor, so the novel's warning about ambition begins before Victor appears. Useful evidence: “I feel my heart glow with an enthusiasm which elevates me to heaven” (Letter I, paragraph 3): Religious, heightened language for exploration; compare later with Victor's rapture. Theme link: Walton dreams of "a part of the world never before visited." The novel begins with a second Victor before we meet the first. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. To whom is Walton writing?
   A. His sister, Margaret Saville
   B. Victor Frankenstein
   C. A ship's captain
   D. His father
2. Where is Walton when he writes the first letter?
   A. Archangel
   B. London
   C. Geneva
   D. St. Petersburg
3. What does Walton hope to discover?
   A. A cure for disease
   B. Gold in Siberia
   C. A lost city
   D. A passage near the pole and the secret of the magnet
4. How did Walton educate himself as a boy?
   A. Attending university in Paris
   B. Working in a laboratory
   C. Reading his uncle's library of voyages
   D. Studying law
5. What does Walton's ambition foreshadow?
   A. A war with Russia
   B. Victor's own dangerous pursuit of knowledge
   C. A happy marriage
   D. His return home rich
6. In the line “My life might have been passed in ease and luxury; but I preferred glory to every enticement that wealth placed in my path.”, what does “enticement” most nearly mean?
   A. something that tempts or attracts
   B. an unrestrained expression of emotion
   C. to rise and fall; to change often
   D. fill to satisfaction
7. In the line “My courage and my resolution is firm; but my hopes fluctuate, and my spirits are often depressed.”, what does “fluctuate” most nearly mean?
   A. an unrestrained expression of emotion
   B. fill to satisfaction
   C. to rise and fall; to change often
   D. something that tempts or attracts

Answer key: 1. A (His sister, Margaret Saville); 2. D (St. Petersburg); 3. D (A passage near the pole and the secret of the magnet); 4. C (Reading his uncle's library of voyages); 5. B (Victor's own dangerous pursuit of knowledge); 6. A (something that tempts or attracts); 7. C (to rise and fall; to change often)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Letter I,” how does Shelley show ambition and the hunger for discovery? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Letter I, how does Shelley develop the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Letter I develops the idea of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter I suggests about ambition and the hunger for discovery. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Letter I to complicate the reader's understanding of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Letter I within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Letter I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of ambition and the hunger for discovery follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter I and its treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter I as evidence for a larger claim about ambition and the hunger for discovery in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter I as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of ambition and the hunger for discovery. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *These visions faded when I perused, for the first time, those poets whose effusions entranced my soul, and lifted it to heaven.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “effusions” most nearly mean?

   A. a vehicle mounted on runners and pulled by horses or dogs; for transportation over snow

   B. used on the high seas

   C. a feeling of evil to come

   D. an unrestrained expression of emotion

2. *You will rejoice to hear that no disaster has accompanied the commencement of an enterprise which you have regarded with such evil forebodings. I arrived here yesterday; and my first task is to assure my dear sister of my welfare, and increasing confidence in the success of my undertaking.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter I”?

   A. The first death and growing guilt

   B. Confidence before danger

   C. Destroying the companion

   D. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

SAT key: 1. D (an unrestrained expression of emotion); 2. D (Ambition and the hunger for discovery)

Lesson 5: Letter II

Focus: loneliness and the desire for a friend

Teacher only · spoilers

From Archangel, Walton hires a ship and crew but confesses that he has no friend who shares his enthusiasm. He describes his master and lieutenant and promises Margaret, “I shall kill no albatross.”

Background: Coleridge's 'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner' (1798), alluded to here, was hugely popular; Mary Shelley heard Coleridge recite it as a child.

Significance: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because....
Prompt: Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: albatross — a very large seabird of the southern oceans; embarkation — going on board a ship to start a voyage; amassed — gathered or collected a large amount of; unemployed — not engaged in a gainful occupation; endowments — natural abilities or qualities.
Words: albatross: a very large seabird of the southern oceans · embarkation: going on board a ship to start a voyage · amassed: gathered or collected a large amount of · unemployed: not engaged in a gainful occupation · endowments: natural abilities or qualities

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Coleridge's 'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner' (1798), alluded to here, was hugely popular; Mary Shelley heard Coleridge recite it as a child. Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature. Characterization: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced. Allusion: "the land of mist and snow" and the albatross come from Coleridge's The Rime of the Ancient Mariner, a poem about a man who commits a crime against nature and must tell his story. Walton's joke sets up Victor as a mariner-like teller. Foreshadowing: Walton's wish for a friend whose eyes reply to his will be granted, terribly, in Victor. Watch for isolation: Almost every narrator ends up alone; solitude is both the cost of ambition and the creature's suffering. In this chapter: "me very desirous to engage him. A youth passed in solitude, my best years spent under your gentle and feminine fosterage, has" (Letter II, paragraph 4).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I have no friend, Margaret" (Letter II, paragraph 2). Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. That is characterization at work: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced.

> *I have no friend, Margaret* (Letter II, paragraph 2)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I have no friend, Margaret" (Letter II, paragraph 2). Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. That is characterization at work: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Whose eyes would reply to mine" pictures friendship as mutual recognition. It connects to isolation: the creature will be rejected precisely because people cannot bear to look at him. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: The desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. (The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.)

> *I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine* (Letter II, paragraph 2)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Whose eyes would reply to mine" pictures friendship as mutual recognition. It connects to isolation: the creature will be rejected precisely because people cannot bear to look at him.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: The desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. (The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about loneliness and the desire for a friend? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter II develops the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. When the text says “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. His wish for someone whose "eyes would reply to mine" names the sympathy every major character lacks, so the novel ties ambition to isolation from its first pages.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about loneliness and the desire for a friend? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter II develops the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. When the text says “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. His wish for someone whose "eyes would reply to mine" names the sympathy every major character lacks, so the novel ties ambition to isolation from its first pages.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want? Ask: is Walton lonely because he is ambitious, or ambitious because he is lonely? Push for a line from the letter.

Anchor question: Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want?

Facilitation: Ask: is Walton lonely because he is ambitious, or ambitious because he is lonely? Push for a line from the letter.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about loneliness and the desire for a friend? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. ("I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine", Letter II, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about loneliness and the desire for a friend? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. ("I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine", Letter II, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how characterization shapes loneliness and the desire for a friend. Key takeaway: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced.
- **Allusion:** "the land of mist and snow" and the albatross come from Coleridge's The Rime of the Ancient Mariner, a poem about a man who commits a crime against nature and must tell his story. Walton's joke sets up Victor as a mariner-like teller.
- **Foreshadowing:** Walton's wish for a friend whose eyes reply to his will be granted, terribly, in Victor.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature.

Symbols and motifs

- **isolation:** Almost every narrator ends up alone; solitude is both the cost of ambition and the creature's suffering. In this chapter: "me very desirous to engage him. A youth passed in solitude, my best years spent under your gentle and feminine fosterage, has" (Letter II, paragraph 4).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I have no friend, Margaret" (Letter II, paragraph 2) Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter.
- "I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine" (Letter II, paragraph 2) The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.
- "I shall kill no albatross" (Letter II, paragraph 6) An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully.
Evidence: "I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine" (Letter II, paragraph 2)
Reasoning: His wish for someone whose "eyes would reply to mine" names the sympathy every major character lacks, so the novel ties ambition to isolation from its first pages.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
albatross (noun)	a very large seabird of the southern oceans	*I am going to unexplored regions, to "the land of mist and snow"; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the "Ancient Mariner."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
embarkation (noun)	going on board a ship to start a voyage	*Those are as fixed as fate; and my voyage is only now delayed until the weather shall permit my embarkation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
amassed (verb)	gathered or collected a large amount of	*Some years ago, he loved a young Russian lady, of moderate fortune; and having amassed a considerable sum in prize-money, the father of the girl consented to the match.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unemployed (adjective)	not engaged in a gainful occupation	*I first became acquainted with him on board a whale vessel: finding that he was unemployed in this city, I easily engaged him to assist in my enterprise.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
endowments (noun)	natural abilities or qualities	*He is an Englishman, and in the midst of national and professional prejudices, unsoftened by cultivation, retains some of the noblest endowments of humanity.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
illiterate (adjective)	poorly educated; unable to read well	*Now I am twenty-eight, and am in reality more illiterate than many schoolboys of fifteen.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
	surrounded		

encompassed (verb)		*How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
retains (verb)	keeps	*He is an Englishman, and in the midst of national and professional prejudices, unsoftened by cultivation, retains some of the noblest endowments of humanity.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mildness (noun)	gentleness	*The master is a person of an excellent disposition, and is remarkable in the ship for his gentleness and the mildness of his discipline.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
voyages (noun)	an act of traveling by water	*But it is a still greater evil to me that I am self-educated: for the first fourteen years of my life I ran wild on a common, and read nothing but our uncle Thomas's books of voyages.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Walton say he lacks most? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A friend who shares his feelings
2. Which poem does Walton allude to? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The Rime of the Ancient Mariner
3. From what port does Walton write this letter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Archangel
4. What theme is introduced by his longing? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The need for companionship
5. How does Walton describe his crew's master? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Kind and gentle, remarkable for mildness
6. Retell the three most important events of "Letter II" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: From Archangel, Walton hires a ship and crew but confesses that he has no friend who shares his enthusiasm. He describes his master and lieutenant and promises Margaret, "I shall kill no albatross."

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Letter II”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Letter II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “I am going to unexplored regions, to “the land of mist and snow”; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the “Ancient Mariner.”” What does “albatross” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: albatross: a very large seabird of the southern oceans.
10. Reread: “Those are as fixed as fate; and my voyage is only now delayed until the weather shall permit my embarkation.” What does “embarkation” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: embarkation: going on board a ship to start a voyage.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Letter II” suggest about loneliness and the desire for a friend? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about loneliness and the desire for a friend? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2): Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Letter II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: From Archangel, Walton hires a ship and crew but confesses that he has no friend who shares his enthusiasm. He describes his master and lieutenant and promises Margaret, “I shall kill no albatross.”
6. How does “Letter II” build on “Letter I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2): The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel.

Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I shall kill no albatross” (Letter II, paragraph 6): An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger. On characterization: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Walton feel he needs a friend, and what kind of friend does he want?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2): Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Coleridge's 'The Rime of the Ancient Mariner' (1798), alluded to here, was hugely popular; Mary Shelley heard Coleridge recite it as a child. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2): The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central need: companionship. The albatross allusion warns of punishment for violating nature.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I shall kill no albatross”

(Letter II, paragraph 6): An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2): Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. On characterization: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Letter II” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about loneliness and the desire for a friend? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2): The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Letter II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I shall kill no albatross” (Letter II, paragraph 6): An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2): Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria

and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2): The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel. On characterization: Walton confesses loneliness: he has "no friend." His self-education (from his uncle's travel books) makes him intense but unbalanced. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Letter II” treats loneliness and the desire for a friend with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I shall kill no albatross” (Letter II, paragraph 6): An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Letter III” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I have no friend, Margaret” (Letter II, paragraph 2): Short and plain amid his long sentences: the emotional core of the letter. On foreshadowing: Walton's wish for a friend whose eyes reply to his will be granted, terribly, in Victor. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about loneliness and the desire for a friend? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I desire the company of a man who could sympathise with me; whose eyes would reply to mine” (Letter II, paragraph 2): The creature will ask for exactly this. Evidence that the need for companionship is universal in the novel. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton, Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's loneliness introduces the novel's central human need, which the creature will later voice most powerfully. Useful evidence: “I shall kill no albatross” (Letter II, paragraph 6): An allusion that promises he will not offend against nature; readers who know Coleridge sense danger. Theme link: the desire for a sympathetic friend is the thread connecting Walton,

Victor and the creature. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What does Walton say he lacks most?
   A. A friend who shares his feelings
   B. A ship
   C. Money for the voyage
   D. Maps of the Arctic
2. Which poem does Walton allude to?
   A. The Iliad
   B. The Rime of the Ancient Mariner
   C. Hamlet
   D. Paradise Lost
3. From what port does Walton write this letter?
   A. Geneva
   B. Lisbon
   C. Archangel
   D. Ingolstadt
4. What theme is introduced by his longing?
   A. The love of money
   B. The evils of travel
   C. The joy of solitude
   D. The need for companionship
5. How does Walton describe his crew's master?
   A. A former pirate
   B. Kind and gentle, remarkable for mildness
   C. Lazy and drunk
   D. Cruel and violent
6. In the line “I am going to unexplored regions, to “the land of mist and snow”; but I shall kill no albatross, therefore do not be alarmed for my safety, or if I should come back to you as worn and woeful as the “Ancient Mariner.””, what does “albatross” most nearly mean?
   A. gathered or collected a large amount of

B. not engaged in a gainful occupation

C. going on board a ship to start a voyage

D. a very large seabird of the southern oceans

7. In the line “Those are as fixed as fate; and my voyage is only now delayed until the weather shall permit my embarkation.”, what does “embarkation” most nearly mean?

A. gathered or collected a large amount of

B. going on board a ship to start a voyage

C. a very large seabird of the southern oceans

D. not engaged in a gainful occupation

Answer key: 1. A (A friend who shares his feelings); 2. B (The Rime of the Ancient Mariner); 3. C (Archangel); 4. D (The need for companionship); 5. B (Kind and gentle, remarkable for mildness); 6. D (a very large seabird of the southern oceans); 7. B (going on board a ship to start a voyage)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Letter II,” how does Shelley show loneliness and the desire for a friend? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Letter II, how does Shelley develop the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Letter II develops the idea of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter II suggests about loneliness and the desire for a friend. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Letter II to complicate the reader's understanding of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Letter II within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Letter II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of loneliness and the desire for a friend follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter II and its treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter II as evidence for a larger claim about loneliness and the desire for a friend in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter II as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of loneliness and the desire for a friend. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Some years ago, he loved a young Russian lady, of moderate fortune; and having amassed a considerable sum in prize-money, the father of the girl consented to the match.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “amassed” most nearly mean?

   A. gentleness

   B. an act of traveling by water

   C. keeps

   D. gathered or collected a large amount of

2. *How slowly the time passes here, encompassed as I am by frost and snow; yet a second step is taken towards my enterprise. I have hired a vessel, and am occupied in collecting my sailors; those whom I have already engaged, appear to be men on whom I can depend, and are certainly possessed of dauntless courage.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter II”?

   A. First experiences of the senses

   B. Isolation in the north

   C. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   D. A letter, a secret and the wedding

SAT key: 1. D (gathered or collected a large amount of); 2. C (Loneliness and the desire for a friend)

Lesson 6: Letter III

Focus: confidence before danger

Teacher only · spoilers

A brief letter: Walton reports that he is safe and well advanced on his voyage. He is full of confidence and determination despite floating ice.

Background: Short letters between long ones create pacing and suspense, a technique common in epistolary fiction.

Significance: Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because....
Prompt: Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: pathless — without paths; untraveled; tracing — following the course of; marking out; indicating — showing; pointing to; homeward — oriented toward home; incidents — a single distinct event.
Words: pathless: without paths; untraveled · tracing: following the course of; marking out · indicating: showing; pointing to · homeward: oriented toward home · incidents: a single distinct event

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Short letters between long ones create pacing and suspense, a technique common in epistolary fiction. Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic. Tone / mood: Brief and confident; exclamations replace doubt. The shortness itself contrasts with the dangers implied. Foreshadowing: His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning. Characterization: Walton writes that his "swelling heart" pours itself out: he is excitable and self-dramatizing. Watch for sublime nature: Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: "apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards" (Letter III, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4). "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. That is tone / mood at work: Brief and confident; exclamations replace doubt. The shortness itself contrasts with the dangers implied.

> *success shall crown my endeavours* *(Letter III, paragraph 4)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4). "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. That is tone / mood at work: Brief and confident; exclamations replace doubt. The shortness itself contrasts with the dangers implied.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Look at the craft: His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: The "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. (A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.)

> *What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man* *(Letter III, paragraph 4)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Look at the craft: His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: The "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. (A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for tone / mood, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about confidence before danger? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter III develops the idea of confidence before danger. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. When the text says "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man" (Letter III, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Asking "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man?" assumes nothing can; the rest of the book, beginning with the ice that traps his ship, shows that something always does.

Task: Annotate the chapter for tone / mood, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about confidence before danger? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter III develops the idea of confidence before danger. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. When the text says "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man" (Letter III, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Asking "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man?" assumes nothing can; the rest of the book, beginning with the ice that traps his ship, shows that something always does.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here? Have students answer Walton's question as Victor might at the end of the book.

Anchor question: Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here?

Facilitation: Have students answer Walton's question as Victor might at the end of the book.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about confidence before danger? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. ("What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man", Letter III, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about confidence before danger? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. ("What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man", Letter III, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how tone / mood shapes confidence before danger. Key takeaway: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Tone / mood:** Brief and confident; exclamations replace doubt. The shortness itself contrasts with the dangers implied.
- **Foreshadowing:** His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning.
- **Characterization:** Walton writes that his "swelling heart" pours itself out: he is excitable and self-dramatizing.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates.

Symbols and motifs

- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards” (Letter III, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4) "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris.
- “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4) A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can.
- “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5) Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will.
Evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4)
Reasoning: Asking "What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man?" assumes nothing can; the rest of the book, beginning with the ice that traps his ship, shows that something always does.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pathless (adjective)	without paths; untraveled	*Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tracing (verb)	following the course of; marking out	*Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
indicating (verb)	showing; pointing to	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
homeward (adjective)	oriented toward home	*This letter will reach England by a merchantman now on its homeward voyage from Archangel; more fortunate than I, who may not see my native land, perhaps, for many years.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
incidents (noun)	a single distinct event	*No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
accidents (noun)	an unfortunate mishap; especially one causing damage or injury	*One or two stiff gales, and the springing of a leak, are accidents which experienced navigators scarcely remember to record; and I shall be well content if nothing worse happen to us during our voyage.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
obedient (adjective)	dutifully complying with the commands or instructions of those in authority	*Why not still proceed over the untamed yet obedient element?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
floating (adjective)	drifting on water	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
prudent (adjective)	careful and sensible; marked by sound judgment	*I will be cool, persevering, and prudent.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
advancing (verb)	move forward, also in the metaphorical sense	*I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here?
2. Where does tone / mood appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does Walton feel in Letter III? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Confident and determined
2. What danger does he mention seeing? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Floating sheets of ice
3. What is the main purpose of this letter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To reassure Margaret he is safe
4. What does Walton's confidence create for the reader? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Dramatic irony and suspense
5. Which word best describes Walton's attitude? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Resolute
6. Retell the three most important events of “Letter III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A brief letter: Walton reports that he is safe and well advanced on his voyage. He is full of confidence and determination despite floating ice.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Letter III”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Letter III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.” What does “pathless” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: pathless: without paths; untraveled.
10. Reread: “Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.” What does “tracing” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: tracing: following the course of; marking out.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Letter III” suggest about confidence before danger? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic.
2. Find one example of tone / mood in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
3. How does the foreshadowing in this chapter shape what we understand about confidence before danger? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4): "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. On foreshadowing: His confidence ("Success shall crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Letter III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A brief letter: Walton reports that he is safe and well advanced on his voyage. He is full of confidence and determination despite floating ice.
6. How does “Letter III” build on “Letter II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4): A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5): Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor. On characterization: Walton writes that his "swelling heart" pours itself out: he is excitable and self-dramatizing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might Shelley include such a short, cheerful letter here?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

9. Where does setting appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4): "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Short letters between long ones create pacing and suspense, a technique common in epistolary fiction. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4): A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Walton's optimism makes the coming crisis feel more dramatic and ironic.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5): Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4): "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. On characterization: Walton writes that his "swelling heart" pours itself out: he is excitable and self-dramatizing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Letter III” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about confidence before danger? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4): A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit

any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Letter III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5): Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4): "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the tone / mood in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4): A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. On tone / mood: Brief and confident; exclamations replace doubt. The shortness itself contrasts with the dangers implied. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Letter III” treats confidence before danger with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5): Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Letter IV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “success shall crown my endeavours” (Letter III, paragraph 4): "Crown" suggests royal triumph; the promise reads as hubris. On foreshadowing: His confidence ("Success shall

crown my endeavours") is dramatic irony in a novel framed as a warning. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about confidence before danger? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “What can stop the determined heart and resolved will of man” (Letter III, paragraph 4): A rhetorical question the novel answers: nature, death and conscience can. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Walton's certainty sets up the novel's warning about human will. Useful evidence: “My swelling heart involuntarily pours itself out thus” (Letter III, paragraph 5): Walton admits his feelings run away with him, a trait he shares with Victor. Theme link: the "determined heart and resolved will of man" sounds heroic but is the attitude the novel interrogates. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Tone / mood:** look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling

Chapter quiz

1. How does Walton feel in Letter III?
   A. Ill and weak
   B. Confident and determined
   C. Ready to turn back
   D. Terrified
2. What danger does he mention seeing?
   A. Floating sheets of ice
   B. A pirate ship
   C. A whale attack
   D. A volcano
3. What is the main purpose of this letter?
   A. To announce his marriage
   B. To ask for money

C. To reassure Margaret he is safe

D. To describe Victor

4. What does Walton's confidence create for the reader?

A. Dramatic irony and suspense

B. Boredom

C. Comedy

D. Certainty of success

5. Which word best describes Walton's attitude?

A. Defeated

B. Resolute

C. Regretful

D. Indifferent

6. In the line “Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.”, what does “pathless” most nearly mean?

A. showing; pointing to

B. oriented toward home

C. following the course of; marking out

D. without paths; untraveled

7. In the line “Thus far I have gone, tracing a secure way over the pathless seas: the very stars themselves being witnesses and testimonies of my triumph.”, what does “tracing” most nearly mean?

A. following the course of; marking out

B. without paths; untraveled

C. oriented toward home

D. showing; pointing to

Answer key: 1. B (Confident and determined); 2. A (Floating sheets of ice); 3. C (To reassure Margaret he is safe); 4. A (Dramatic irony and suspense); 5. B (Resolute); 6. D (without paths; untraveled); 7. A (following the course of; marking out)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Letter III,” how does Shelley show confidence before danger? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the tone / mood you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Letter III, how does Shelley develop the idea of confidence before danger? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the tone / mood in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Letter III develops the idea of confidence before danger. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of tone / mood and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its tone / mood shape the reader's understanding of confidence before danger. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter III suggests about confidence before danger. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's tone / mood and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses tone / mood in Letter III to complicate the reader's understanding of confidence before danger. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Letter III within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of confidence before danger responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Letter III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of confidence before danger follows or bends those conventions, using the tone / mood as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter III and its treatment of confidence before danger. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's tone / mood and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter III as evidence for a larger claim about confidence before danger in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter III as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of confidence before danger. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I am, however, in good spirits: my men are bold, and apparently firm of purpose; nor do the floating sheets of ice that continually pass us, indicating the dangers of the region towards which we are advancing, appear to dismay them.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "indicating" most nearly mean?

   A. showing; pointing to
   B. drifting on water
   C. careful and sensible; marked by sound judgment
   D. move forward, also in the metaphorical sense

2. *No incidents have hitherto befallen us that would make a figure in a letter. One or two stiff gales, and the springing of a leak, are accidents which experienced navigators scarcely remember to record; and I shall be well content if nothing worse happen to us during our voyage.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Letter III"?

   A. Loss and leaving home
   B. Isolation in the north
   C. Injustice and the burden of silence
   D. Confidence before danger

SAT key: 1. A (showing; pointing to); 2. D (Confidence before danger)

Lesson 7: Letter IV

Focus: the meeting of two ambitious men

Teacher only · spoilers

Trapped in ice, Walton's crew sees a giant figure on a dog sled, and the next morning rescues a frozen, exhausted stranger: Victor Frankenstein. Victor recovers slowly, becomes Walton's friend, and, hearing of Walton's ambition, agrees to tell his own story as a warning.

Background: The frame (Walton) now opens into Victor's narrative, a 'story within a story' structure called a nested or frame narrative.

Significance: Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

> **0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)**
> Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
> *Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because....*
> **Prompt:** Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict?
> **Sentence starters:** I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
> **Strong response:** A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit.

> **8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)**
> Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
> *Today's words: capitulated — gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety); tutored — taught; educated; telescopes — instruments that make distant objects look closer; rawness — cold, damp harshness; eventual — expected to follow in the indefinite future from causes already operating. "capitulated": From Medieval Latin capitulare "to draw up under headings," from capitulum "little head, chapter," from caput "head"; hence arranging terms, then surrendering on terms.*
> **Words:** capitulated: gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety) · tutored: taught; educated · telescopes: instruments that make distant objects look closer · rawness: cold, damp harshness · eventual: expected to follow in the indefinite future from causes already operating

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The frame (Walton) now opens into Victor's narrative, a 'story within a story' structure called a nested or frame narrative. Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader. Structure: Letter IV turns the frame: Walton meets Victor and becomes the listener. From here the story nests: Walton tells Victor's story, which will contain the creature's. Characterization: Victor appears ruined but eloquent; Walton instantly loves him. Watch Victor's warning speech, which is a teacher's speech. Imagery: The first glimpse is of a "being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature" on a dog-sledge: we see the creature before we know him. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "In the morning, however, as soon as it was light, I went upon deck, and found all the sailors busy on" (Letter IV, paragraph 6).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature" (Letter IV, paragraph 3). Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. That is structure at work: Letter IV turns the frame: Walton meets Victor and becomes the listener. From here the story nests: Walton tells Victor's story, which will contain the creature's.

> *a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature* (Letter IV, paragraph 3)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature" (Letter IV, paragraph 3). Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. That is structure at work: Letter IV turns the frame: Walton meets Victor and becomes the listener. From here the story nests: Walton tells Victor's story, which will contain the creature's.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The serpent recalls Genesis, where knowledge leads to the Fall; "sting" makes knowledge poisonous. This is the novel's central warning about ambition and knowledge. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. (The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim.)

> *You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been* (Letter IV, paragraph 32)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The serpent recalls Genesis, where knowledge leads to the Fall; "sting" makes knowledge poisonous. This is the novel's central warning about ambition and knowledge.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. (The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the meeting of two ambitious men? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter IV develops the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. When the text says "You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been" (Letter IV, paragraph 32), it shows this directly. By calling Walton's desire an "intoxicating draught" and hoping it will not be "a serpent to sting you," Victor links the pursuit of knowledge to addiction and to the biblical Fall, so everything he tells next is offered as a lesson.
Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the meeting of two ambitious men? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Letter IV develops the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict? Ask whether we should trust Victor as a narrator. He is telling the story to make a point; what might he leave out?
Anchor question: Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict?
Facilitation: Ask whether we should trust Victor as a narrator. He is telling the story to make a point; what might he leave out?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the meeting of two ambitious men? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. ("You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been", Letter IV, paragraph 32). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the meeting of two ambitious men? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. ("You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been", Letter IV, paragraph 32). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes the meeting of two ambitious men. Key takeaway: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** Letter IV turns the frame: Walton meets Victor and becomes the listener. From here the story nests: Walton tells Victor's story, which will contain the creature's.
- **Characterization:** Victor appears ruined but eloquent; Walton instantly loves him. Watch Victor's warning speech, which is a teacher's speech.
- **Imagery:** The first glimpse is of a "being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature" on a dog-sledge: we see the creature before we know him.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “In the morning, however, as soon as it was light, I went upon deck, and found all the sailors busy on” (Letter IV, paragraph 6).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “Last Monday (July 31st), we were nearly surrounded by ice, which closed in the ship on all sides, scarcely leaving her” (Letter IV, paragraph 2).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3) Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance.
- “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25) (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity.
- “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32) The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows.
Evidence: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32)
Reasoning: By calling Walton's desire an "intoxicating draught" and hoping it will not be "a serpent to sting you," Victor links the pursuit of knowledge to addiction and to the biblical Fall, so everything he tells next is offered as a lesson.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
capitulated (verb)	gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety)	*Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless.*	“capitulated”: From Medieval Latin capitulare "to draw up under headings," from capitulum "little head, chapter," from caput "head"; hence arranging terms, then surrendering on terms. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/capitulate)
tutored (verb)	taught; educated	*You have been tutored and refined by books and retirement from the world, and you are, therefore, somewhat fastidious; but this only*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		renders you the more fit to appreciate the extraordinary merits of this wonderful man.	
telescopes (noun)	instruments that make distant objects look closer	*We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
rawness (noun)	cold, damp harshness	*He manifested the greatest eagerness to be upon deck, to watch for the sledge which had before appeared; but I have persuaded him to remain in the cabin, for he is far too weak to sustain the rawness of the atmosphere.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
eventual (adjective)	expected to follow in the indefinite future from causes already operating	*He entered attentively into all my arguments in favour of my eventual success, and into every minute detail of the measures I had taken to secure it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
irradiated (verb)	lit up	*Even now, as I commence my task, his full-toned voice swells in my ears; his lustrous eyes dwell on me with all their melancholy sweetness; I see his thin hand raised in animation, while the lineaments of his face are irradiated by the soul within.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
benevolently (adverb)	in a kind, well-meaning way	*"And yet you rescued me from a strange and perilous situation; you have benevolently restored me to life."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conciliating (adjective)	friendly and trying to win good will	*Yet his manners are so conciliating and gentle, that the sailors are all interested in him, although they have had very little communication with him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
oppresses (verb)	come down on or keep down by unjust use of one's authority	*But he is generally melancholy and despairing; and sometimes he gnashes his teeth, as if impatient of the weight of woes that oppresses him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
trickle (verb)	to flow in drops	*At first I perceived that he tried to suppress his emotion; he placed his hands before his eyes; and my voice*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		quivered and failed me, as I beheld tears trickle fast from between his fingers—a groan burst from his heaving breast.	

Discussion questions

1. Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the crew first see on the ice? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A gigantic figure on a dog sled
2. Who is rescued from the ice? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Victor Frankenstein
3. Why does Victor decide to tell his story? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To warn Walton about dangerous ambition
4. How does Walton feel toward the stranger? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He admires and loves him like a brother
5. What narrative structure begins here? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A frame narrative with a story within a story
6. Retell the three most important events of "Letter IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Trapped in ice, Walton's crew sees a giant figure on a dog sled, and the next morning rescues a frozen, exhausted stranger: Victor Frankenstein. Victor recovers slowly, becomes Walton's friend, and, hearing of Walton's ambition, agrees to tell his own story as a warning.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Letter IV"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Letter IV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless." What does "capitulated" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: capitulated: gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety).

10. Reread: “You have been tutored and refined by books and retirement from the world, and you are, therefore, somewhat fastidious; but this only renders you the more fit to appreciate the extraordinary merits of this wonderful man.” What does “tutored” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: tutored: taught; educated.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Letter IV” suggest about the meeting of two ambitious men? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the meeting of two ambitious men? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3): Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. On characterization: Victor appears ruined but eloquent; Walton instantly loves him. Watch Victor's warning speech, which is a teacher's speech. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “About two o’clock the mist cleared away, and we beheld, stretched out in every direction, vast and irregular plains of ice, which seemed to have no end.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Letter IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Trapped in ice, Walton's crew sees a giant figure on a dog sled, and the next morning rescues a frozen, exhausted stranger: Victor Frankenstein. Victor recovers slowly, becomes Walton's friend, and, hearing of Walton's ambition, agrees to tell his own story as a warning.
6. How does “Letter IV” build on “Letter III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25): (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity. On structure: Letter IV turns the frame: Walton meets Victor and becomes the listener. From here the story nests: Walton tells Victor's story, which will contain the creature's. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I

ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been" (Letter IV, paragraph 32): The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim. On characterization: Victor appears ruined but eloquent; Walton instantly loves him. Watch Victor's warning speech, which is a teacher's speech. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: "Victor says he will tell his story so Walton may learn from it. What lesson do you predict?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does point of view appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: "a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature" (Letter IV, paragraph 3): Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The frame (Walton) now opens into Victor's narrative, a 'story within a story' structure called a nested or frame narrative. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: "Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught" (Letter IV, paragraph 25): (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "Victor's warning, 'Learn from me,' makes the whole novel a cautionary tale addressed to Walton and to the reader." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: "You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been" (Letter IV, paragraph 32): The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and

evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3): Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. On characterization: Victor appears ruined but eloquent; Walton instantly loves him. Watch Victor's warning speech, which is a teacher's speech. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Letter IV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the meeting of two ambitious men? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25): (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Letter IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32): The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3): Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25): (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive

curiosity. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Letter IV” treats the meeting of two ambitious men with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32): The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter I” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature” (Letter IV, paragraph 3): Ambiguity ("shape of a man") makes the creature's humanity a question from his first appearance. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the meeting of two ambitious men? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “Unhappy man! Do you share my madness? Have you drank also of the intoxicating draught” (Letter IV, paragraph 25): (The 1831 text prints "drank.") Victor calls ambition a drug ("intoxicating draught") and madness. Evidence for the novel's view of obsessive curiosity. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor frames his whole story as a warning against the kind of ambition Walton shows. Useful evidence: “You seek for knowledge and wisdom, as I once did; and I ardently hope that the gratification of your wishes may not be a serpent to sting you, as mine has been” (Letter IV, paragraph 32): The serpent alludes to Eden: knowledge as temptation and fall. Strong for a theme claim. Theme link: Victor recognizes himself in Walton and warns him; the story becomes a cautionary tale told for a listener's benefit. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Point of view**: who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know

Chapter quiz

1. What does the crew first see on the ice?
   A. A polar bear
   B. A lost ship
   C. A gigantic figure on a dog sled
   D. A fire
2. Who is rescued from the ice?
   A. A Russian sailor
   B. Victor Frankenstein
   C. The creature
   D. Henry Clerval
3. Why does Victor decide to tell his story?
   A. To earn passage home
   B. Because he is dying of fever
   C. To confess a theft
   D. To warn Walton about dangerous ambition
4. How does Walton feel toward the stranger?
   A. He admires and loves him like a brother
   B. He fears him
   C. He distrusts him
   D. He ignores him
5. What narrative structure begins here?
   A. A single third-person narrator
   B. A frame narrative with a story within a story
   C. A play
   D. A diary only
6. In the line “Margaret, if you had seen the man who thus capitulated for his safety, your surprise would have been boundless.”, what does “capitulated” most nearly mean?
   A. taught; educated
   B. instruments that make distant objects look closer
   C. gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety)
   D. cold, damp harshness

7. In the line “You have been tutored and refined by books and retirement from the world, and you are, therefore, somewhat fastidious; but this only renders you the more fit to appreciate the extraordinary merits of this wonderful man.”, what does “tutored” most nearly mean?

   A. cold, damp harshness

   B. taught; educated

   C. instruments that make distant objects look closer

   D. gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety)

Answer key: 1. C (A gigantic figure on a dog sled); 2. B (Victor Frankenstein); 3. D (To warn Walton about dangerous ambition); 4. A (He admires and loves him like a brother); 5. B (A frame narrative with a story within a story); 6. C (gave in; agreed to terms (here, bargained for his safety)); 7. B (taught; educated)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Letter IV,” how does Shelley show the meeting of two ambitious men? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Letter IV, how does Shelley develop the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Letter IV develops the idea of the meeting of two ambitious men. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Letter IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the meeting of two ambitious men. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Letter IV suggests about the meeting of two ambitious men. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Letter IV to complicate the reader's understanding of the meeting of two ambitious men. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Letter IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the meeting of two

ambitious men responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Letter IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the meeting of two ambitious men follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Letter IV and its treatment of the meeting of two ambitious men. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Letter IV as evidence for a larger claim about the meeting of two ambitious men in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Letter IV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the meeting of two ambitious men. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “telescopes” most nearly mean?

   A. come down on or keep down by unjust use of one's authority

   B. instruments that make distant objects look closer

   C. to flow in drops

   D. friendly and trying to win good will

2. *About two o’clock the mist cleared away, and we beheld, stretched out in every direction, vast and irregular plains of ice, which seemed to have no end. Some of my comrades groaned, and my own mind began to grow watchful with anxious thoughts, when a strange sight suddenly attracted our attention, and diverted our solicitude from our own situation. We perceived a low carriage, fixed on a sledge and drawn by dogs, pass on towards the north, at the distance of half a mile: a being which had the shape of a man, but apparently of gigantic stature, sat in the sledge, and guided the dogs. We watched the rapid progress of the traveller with our telescopes, until he was lost among the distant inequalities of the ice.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Letter IV”?

   A. A privileged childhood and family love

   B. Grief, prison and return

   C. Destroying the companion

D. The meeting of two ambitious men

SAT key: 1. B (instruments that make distant objects look closer); 2. D (The meeting of two ambitious men)

Lesson 8: Chapter I

Focus: a privileged childhood and family love

Content note (gender and ownership): Elizabeth is given to Victor as a "pretty present"; name the language of possession and discuss how the novel treats women as objects of exchange.
Student preview: This chapter describes a girl being 'given' to a boy as a present. We will look critically at that language.
Suggested language: "What does it tell us that Elizabeth is described as a gift? Whose point of view is that?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor describes his Genevese family: his father Alphonse, his mother Caroline (rescued from poverty), and Elizabeth Lavenza, the orphaned daughter of a Milanese nobleman, found living with poor peasants near Lake Como and adopted by his mother, whom his mother gives him as a 'present.' His childhood is loving and protected.

Background: Geneva was an independent republic known for Calvinism and civic pride; Rousseau, a Genevan, influenced ideas of education and nature.

Significance: Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because.... Content note before we start: This chapter describes a girl being 'given' to a boy as a present. We will look critically at that language.
Prompt: How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: foldings — folds or hollows (here, in the hills); vagrants — homeless wanderers; decreasing — becoming smaller or less; chamois — a small, agile mountain goat; dungeons — dark underground prison cells.
Words: foldings: folds or hollows (here, in the hills) · vagrants: homeless wanderers · decreasing: becoming smaller or less · chamois: a small, agile mountain goat · dungeons: dark underground prison cells

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Geneva was an independent republic known for Calvinism and civic pride; Rousseau, a Genevan, influenced ideas of education and nature. Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question. Characterization: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring. Irony: He says his parents felt they owed him duties as their child; he will owe the same duties and refuse them. Setting: Geneva, a republic and a respectable family, creates a picture of order. Watch for Elizabeth as gift: Elizabeth is introduced as a "pretty present"; she is treated as a possession, a point students can examine.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic" (Chapter I, paragraph 1). Opens with pride in lineage and status. That is characterization at work: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring.

> *I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic (Chapter I, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic" (Chapter I, paragraph 1). Opens with pride in lineage and status. That is characterization at work: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Pretty present" makes Elizabeth an object given to Victor, and "mine" shows possessiveness. This links to responsibility: Victor receives care and possession but gives little. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. (Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.)

> *I have a pretty present for my Victor (Chapter I, paragraph 11)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Pretty present" makes Elizabeth an object given to Victor, and "mine" shows possessiveness. This links to responsibility: Victor receives care and possession but gives little.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. (Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a privileged childhood and family love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of a privileged childhood and family love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. When the text says "I have a pretty present for my Victor" (Chapter I, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. He describes himself as the center of his parents' devotion and treats Elizabeth as his "present," showing that he received care as his due; when he refuses any care to his own creation, the contrast exposes his failure.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a privileged childhood and family love? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of a privileged childhood and family love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. When the text says "I have a pretty present for my Victor" (Chapter I, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. He describes himself as the center of his parents' devotion and treats Elizabeth as his "present," showing that he received care as his due; when he refuses any care to his own creation, the contrast exposes his failure.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need? If students call Victor's childhood "perfect," ask what it taught him about being responsible for others.

Anchor question: How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need?

Facilitation: If students call Victor's childhood "perfect," ask what it taught him about being responsible for others.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a privileged childhood and family love? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. ("I have a pretty present for my Victor", Chapter I, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a privileged childhood and family love? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. ("I have a pretty present for my Victor", Chapter I, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes a privileged childhood and family love. Key takeaway: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring.
- **Irony:** He says his parents felt they owed him duties as their child; he will owe the same duties and refuse them.
- **Setting:** Geneva, a republic and a respectable family, creates a picture of order.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty.

Symbols and motifs

- **Elizabeth as gift:** Elizabeth is introduced as a "pretty present"; she is treated as a possession, a point students can examine.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1) Opens with pride in lineage and status.
- “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11) Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel.
- “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11) Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature.
Evidence: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11)
Reasoning: He describes himself as the center of his parents' devotion and treats Elizabeth as his "present," showing that he received care as his due; when he refuses any care to his own creation, the contrast exposes his failure.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	Word history

	Definition (in this sentence)		
foldings (noun)	folds or hollows (here, in the hills)	*During one of their walks a poor cot in the foldings of a vale attracted their notice, as being singularly disconsolate, while the number of half-clothed children gathered about it, spoke of penury in its worst shape.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vagrants (noun)	homeless wanderers	*The four others were dark-eyed, hardy little vagrants; this child was thin, and very fair.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
decreasing (verb)	becoming smaller or less	*His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chamois (noun)	a small, agile mountain goat	*When my father returned from Milan, he found playing with me in the hall of our villa, a child fairer than pictured cherub—a creature who seemed to shed radiance from her looks, and whose form and motions were lighter than the chamois of the hills.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dungeons (noun)	dark underground prison cells	*Whether he had died, or still lingered in the dungeons of Austria, was not known.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
rambles (noun)	an aimless amble on a winding course	*I, their eldest child, was born at Naples, and as an infant accompanied them in their rambles.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
interment (noun)	the ritual placing of a corpse in a grave	*He came like a protecting spirit to the poor girl, who committed herself to his care; and after the interment of his friend, he conducted her to Geneva, and placed her under the protection of a relation.*	"interment": From Old French enterrement "burial," from enterrer "to put in the earth" (Latin terra "earth"). (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/interment)
pittance (noun)	an inadequate payment	*She procured plain work; she plaited straw; and by various means contrived to earn a pittance scarcely sufficient to support life.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
confiscated (verb)	take temporary possession of as a security, by legal authority	*His property was confiscated, his child became an orphan and a beggar.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

deplored (verb)	express strong disapproval of	*He bitterly deplored the false pride which led his friend to a conduct so little worthy of the affection that united them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where is Victor's family from? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Geneva
2. How does Elizabeth join the family? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: An orphaned nobleman's daughter raised by poor peasants, she is adopted by Victor's mother
3. How does Victor's mother describe Elizabeth to him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: As a pretty present for him
4. What kind of childhood does Victor have? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Loving and sheltered
5. Why is this childhood important to the novel? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It contrasts with the creature's abandonment
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter I” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Victor describes his Genevese family: his father Alphonse, his mother Caroline (rescued from poverty), and Elizabeth Lavenza, the orphaned daughter of a Milanese nobleman, found living with poor peasants near Lake Como and adopted by his mother, whom his mother gives him as a 'present.' His childhood is loving and protected.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter I”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter I” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “During one of their walks a poor cot in the foldings of a vale attracted their notice, as being singularly disconsolate, while the number of half-clothed children gathered about it, spoke of penury in its worst shape.” What does “foldings” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: foldings: folds or hollows (here, in the hills).

10. Reread: “The four others were dark-eyed, hardy little vagrants; this child was thin, and very fair.” What does “vagrants” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: vagrants: homeless wanderers.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter I” suggest about a privileged childhood and family love? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about a privileged childhood and family love? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): Opens with pride in lineage and status. On setting: Geneva, a republic and a respectable family, creates a picture of order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter I”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Victor describes his Genevese family: his father Alphonse, his mother Caroline (rescued from poverty), and Elizabeth Lavenza, the orphaned daughter of a Milanese nobleman, found living with poor peasants near Lake Como and adopted by his mother, whom his mother gives him as a 'present.' His…
6. How does “Chapter I” build on “Letter IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness. On characterization: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his

creation glaring. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does Victor's childhood compare with what a newly created being might need?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): Opens with pride in lineage and status. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Geneva was an independent republic known for Calvinism and civic pride; Rousseau, a Genevan, influenced ideas of education and nature. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel. On setting: Geneva, a republic and a respectable family, creates a picture of order. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Victor's ideal upbringing contrasts sharply with the creature's abandonment, raising the nature-versus-nurture question.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): Opens with pride in lineage and status. On characterization: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted

sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter I” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a privileged childhood and family love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter I”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): Opens with pride in lineage and status. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel. On characterization: Victor describes an idyllic, privileged childhood: devoted parents, a beloved adopted sister. He stresses that he was given every care, which makes his later neglect of his creation glaring. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter I” treats a privileged childhood and family love with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter II” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I am by birth a Genevese; and my family is one of the most distinguished of that republic” (Chapter I, paragraph 1): Opens with pride in lineage and status. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a privileged childhood and family love? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “I have a pretty present for my Victor” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Elizabeth is presented as a gift; useful for discussions of how women are treated in the novel. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's loving upbringing sets the standard of care he later denies his creature. Useful evidence: “looked upon Elizabeth as mine—mine to protect, love, and cherish” (Chapter I, paragraph 11): Possessive language; evidence for a claim about Victor's self-centeredness. Theme link: The parents' "deep consciousness of what they owed towards the being to which they had given life" is the novel's standard of parental duty. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz

1. Where is Victor's family from?

   A. Paris

B. Naples

C. London

D. Geneva

2. How does Elizabeth join the family?

A. An orphaned nobleman's daughter raised by poor peasants, she is adopted by Victor's mother

B. She is a cousin from England

C. She is a servant

D. She is Victor's sister by birth

3. How does Victor's mother describe Elizabeth to him?

A. As a pretty present for him

B. As a burden

C. As his teacher

D. As a dangerous stranger

4. What kind of childhood does Victor have?

A. Spent at sea

B. Cruel and poor

C. Lonely and neglected

D. Loving and sheltered

5. Why is this childhood important to the novel?

A. It contrasts with the creature's abandonment

B. It shows Victor's poverty

C. It explains Walton's voyage

D. It introduces the North Pole

6. In the line “During one of their walks a poor cot in the foldings of a vale attracted their notice, as being singularly disconsolate, while the number of half-clothed children gathered about it, spoke of penury in its worst shape.”, what does “foldings” most nearly mean?

A. becoming smaller or less

B. homeless wanderers

C. folds or hollows (here, in the hills)

D. a small, agile mountain goat

7. In the line “The four others were dark-eyed, hardy little vagrants; this child was thin, and very fair.”, what does “vagrants” most nearly mean?

A. folds or hollows (here, in the hills)

B. homeless wanderers

C. becoming smaller or less

D. a small, agile mountain goat

Answer key: 1. D (Geneva); 2. A (An orphaned nobleman's daughter raised by poor peasants, she is adopted by Victor's mother); 3. A (As a pretty present for him); 4. D (Loving and sheltered); 5. A (It contrasts with the creature's abandonment); 6. C (folds or hollows (here, in the hills)); 7. B (homeless wanderers)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter I,” how does Shelley show a privileged childhood and family love? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter I, how does Shelley develop the idea of a privileged childhood and family love? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter I develops the idea of a privileged childhood and family love. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter I (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of a privileged childhood and family love. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter I suggests about a privileged childhood and family love. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Chapter I to complicate the reader's understanding of a privileged childhood and family love. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter I within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of a privileged childhood and family love responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter I alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of a privileged childhood and family love follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter I and its treatment of a privileged childhood and family love. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter I as evidence for a larger claim about a privileged childhood and family love in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter I as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of a privileged childhood and family love. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “decreasing” most nearly mean?

   A. becoming smaller or less

   B. take temporary possession of as a security, by legal authority

   C. an inadequate payment

   D. express strong disapproval of

2. *His daughter attended him with the greatest tenderness; but she saw with despair that their little fund was rapidly decreasing, and that there was no other prospect of support. But Caroline Beaufort possessed a mind of an uncommon mould; and her courage rose to support her in her adversity. She procured plain work; she plaited straw; and by various means contrived to earn a pittance scarcely sufficient to support life.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter I”?

   A. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

   B. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   C. The wedding night and its catastrophe

   D. A privileged childhood and family love

SAT key: 1. A (becoming smaller or less); 2. D (A privileged childhood and family love)

Lesson 9: Chapter II

Focus: the first spark of obsession

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor recalls his friend Henry Clerval and his own early fascination with the alchemists Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus and Albertus Magnus. A lightning strike that destroys an oak tree introduces him to electricity, and he briefly turns to mathematics before 'destiny' pulls him back.

Background: Agrippa and Paracelsus were Renaissance figures who mixed early science with magic. Lightning and electricity fascinated Enlightenment scientists like Benjamin Franklin.

Significance: Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices—a key point for discussion.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because....
Prompt: Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: ligaments — ties or bonds that hold things together; disunion — disagreement; being divided; loudness — the quality of being loud; preceptors — teachers; dissect — to cut apart in order to examine closely.
Words: ligaments: ties or bonds that hold things together · disunion: disagreement; being divided · loudness: the quality of being loud · preceptors: teachers · dissect: to cut apart in order to examine closely

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Agrippa and Paracelsus were Renaissance figures who mixed early science with magic. Lightning and electricity fascinated Enlightenment scientists like Benjamin Franklin. Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices—a key point for discussion. Foreshadowing: Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin. Characterization: Curious and solitary, he reads outdated alchemists (Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus, Albertus Magnus) and is not corrected well: his father calls Agrippa "sad trash" without explaining why. Diction / vocabulary: Words like "divine," "secrets" and "fate" make science sound like a religion. Watch for the blasted oak: the tree destroyed by lightning foreshadows Victor's destruction by the power he studies.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1). "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. That is foreshadowing at work: Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin.

> *The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine* (Chapter II, paragraph 1)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1). "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. That is foreshadowing at work: Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Sad trash" dismisses without teaching. Victor blames this moment, which shows he looks for causes outside himself and connects to the theme of responsibility. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: The desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. (Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.)

> *My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash* (Chapter II, paragraph 7)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Sad trash" dismisses without teaching. Victor blames this moment, which shows he looks for causes outside himself and connects to the theme of responsibility.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: The desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. (Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for foreshadowing, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the first spark of obsession? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the first spark of obsession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. When the text says "Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate" (Chapter II, paragraph 7), it shows this directly. Calling natural philosophy "the genius that has regulated my fate" makes science an outside force, and he blames his father's careless "sad trash" for not stopping him; readers can see a man explaining away his own will.

Task: Annotate the chapter for foreshadowing, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the first spark of obsession? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the first spark of obsession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. When the text says "Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate" (Chapter II, paragraph 7), it shows this directly. Calling natural philosophy "the genius that has regulated my fate" makes science an outside force, and he blames his father's careless "sad trash" for not stopping him; readers can see a man explaining away his own will.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose? Ask: how much of Victor's fate is chosen? Have students list choices he makes in this chapter.

Anchor question: Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose?

Facilitation: Ask: how much of Victor's fate is chosen? Have students list choices he makes in this chapter.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the first spark of obsession? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. ("Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate", Chapter II, paragraph 7). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the first spark of obsession? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. ("Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate", Chapter II, paragraph 7). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how foreshadowing shapes the first spark of obsession. Key takeaway: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Foreshadowing:** Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin.
- **Characterization:** Curious and solitary, he reads outdated alchemists (Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus, Albertus Magnus) and is not corrected well: his father calls Agrippa "sad trash" without explaining why.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Words like "divine," "secrets" and "fate" make science sound like a religion.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession.

Symbols and motifs

- **the blasted oak:** the tree destroyed by lightning foreshadows Victor's destruction by the power he studies.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1) "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power.
- “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7) Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this.
- “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7) Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices.
Evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7)
Reasoning: Calling natural philosophy "the genius that has regulated my fate" makes science an outside force, and he blames his father's careless "sad trash" for not stopping him; readers can see a man explaining away his own will.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

ligaments (noun)	ties or bonds that hold things together	*Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disunion (noun)	disagreement; being divided	*I need not say that we were strangers to any species of disunion or dispute.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
loudness (noun)	the quality of being loud	*It advanced from behind the mountains of Jura; and the thunder burst at once with frightful loudness from various quarters of the heavens.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
preceptors (noun)	teachers	*Under the guidance of my new preceptors, I entered with the greatest diligence into the search of the philosopher's stone and the elixir of life; but the latter soon obtained my undivided attention.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dissect (verb)	to cut apart in order to examine closely	*He might dissect, anatomise, and give names; but, not to speak of a final cause, causes in their secondary and tertiary grades were utterly unknown to him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
relinquishing (verb)	part with a possession or right	*Her victory was announced by an unusual tranquillity and gladness of soul, which followed the relinquishing of my ancient and latterly tormenting studies.*	"relinquishing": From Latin relinquere "to leave behind," from re- "back" + linquere "to leave." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/relinquish)
unveiled (verb)	remove the veil from	*He had partially unveiled the face of Nature, but her immortal lineaments were still a wonder and a mystery.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
invulnerable (adjective)	immune to attack; impregnable	*Wealth was an inferior object; but what glory would attend the discovery, if I could banish disease from the human frame, and render man invulnerable to any but a violent death!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
splintered (verb)	broken into sharp pieces	*It was not splintered by the shock, but entirely reduced to thin ribbons of wood.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
predilection (noun)	a predisposition in favor of something	*Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate; I desire, therefore, in this narration, to state*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

		those facts which led to my predilection for that science.	

Discussion questions

1. Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which author first fascinates Victor? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Cornelius Agrippa
2. What does Victor's father call Agrippa's work? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Sad trash
3. What event introduces Victor to electricity? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Lightning destroying an oak tree
4. Who is Victor's closest childhood friend? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Henry Clerval
5. What does Victor say governed his life? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Destiny
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter II” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Victor recalls his friend Henry Clerval and his own early fascination with the alchemists Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus and Albertus Magnus. A lightning strike that destroys an oak tree introduces him to electricity, and he briefly turns to mathematics before 'destiny' pulls him back.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter II”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter II” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin.” What does “ligaments” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: ligaments: ties or bonds that hold things together.

10. Reread: “I need not say that we were strangers to any species of disunion or dispute.” What does “disunion” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: disunion: disagreement; being divided.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter II” suggest about the first spark of obsession? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices—a key point for discussion.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the first spark of obsession? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. On characterization: Curious and solitary, he reads outdated alchemists (Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus, Albertus Magnus) and is not corrected well: his father calls Agrippa "sad trash" without explaining why. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “The untaught peasant beheld the elements around him, and was acquainted with their practical uses.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter II”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Victor recalls his friend Henry Clerval and his own early fascination with the alchemists Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus and Albertus Magnus. A lightning strike that destroys an oak tree introduces him to electricity, and he briefly turns to mathematics before 'destiny' pulls him back.
6. How does “Chapter II” build on “Chapter I”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility. On

characterization: Curious and solitary, he reads outdated alchemists (Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus, Albertus Magnus) and is not corrected well: his father calls Agrippa "sad trash" without explaining why. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Victor blames 'destiny' for his fate. Do you agree, or did he choose?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does symbolism appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Agrippa and Paracelsus were Renaissance figures who mixed early science with magic. Lightning and electricity fascinated Enlightenment scientists like Benjamin Franklin. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Victor frames his life as fated, shifting responsibility away from his choices—a key point for discussion.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine”

(Chapter II, paragraph 1): "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. On characterization: Curious and solitary, he reads outdated alchemists (Cornelius Agrippa, Paracelsus, Albertus Magnus) and is not corrected well: his father calls Agrippa "sad trash" without explaining why. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter II” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the first spark of obsession? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter II”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this. On foreshadowing: Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter II” treats the first spark of obsession with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s

· RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter III” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “The world was to me a secret which I desired to divine” (Chapter II, paragraph 1): "Divine" means to discover by intuition and also suggests godlike power. On foreshadowing: Victor repeatedly calls natural philosophy his "fate" and narrates with hindsight; the lightning-blasted oak predicts his ruin. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the first spark of obsession? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “My dear Victor, do not waste your time upon this; it is sad trash” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Dismissal without explanation; Victor later blames this. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor describes his obsession as fate, which lets him avoid blame for his choices. Useful evidence: “Natural philosophy is the genius that has regulated my fate” (Chapter II, paragraph 7): Victor treats science as a spirit controlling him, shifting responsibility. Theme link: the desire to learn "the secrets of heaven and earth" begins as wonder and becomes obsession. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Symbolism**: objects, places or actions that stand for larger ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Which author first fascinates Victor?
   A. Cornelius Agrippa
   B. Homer
   C. Isaac Newton
   D. Shakespeare
2. What does Victor's father call Agrippa's work?
   A. Brilliant science
   B. A great adventure
   C. Holy truth
   D. Sad trash
3. What event introduces Victor to electricity?
   A. A fire in the house
   B. A storm at sea
   C. A shock from a machine
   D. Lightning destroying an oak tree
4. Who is Victor's closest childhood friend?
   A. Henry Clerval
   B. Robert Walton
   C. Felix De Lacey
   D. M. Krempe
5. What does Victor say governed his life?
   A. Religion
   B. Destiny
   C. Money
   D. His mother
6. In the line “Thus strangely are our souls constructed, and by such slight ligaments are we bound to prosperity or ruin.”, what does “ligaments” most nearly mean?
   A. disagreement; being divided
   B. teachers
   C. the quality of being loud
   D. ties or bonds that hold things together
7. In the line “I need not say that we were strangers to any species of disunion or dispute.”, what does “disunion” most nearly mean?
   A. the quality of being loud
   B. teachers
   C. disagreement; being divided
   D. ties or bonds that hold things together

Answer key: 1. A (Cornelius Agrippa); 2. D (Sad trash); 3. D (Lightning destroying an oak tree); 4. A (Henry Clerval); 5. B (Destiny); 6. D (ties or bonds that hold things together); 7. C (disagreement; being divided)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter II," how does Shelley show the first spark of obsession? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter II, how does Shelley develop the idea of the first spark of obsession? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter II develops the idea of the first spark of obsession. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter II (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the first spark of obsession. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter II suggests about the first spark of obsession. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter II to complicate the reader's understanding of the first spark of obsession. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter II within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the first spark of obsession responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter II alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the first spark of obsession follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter II and its treatment of the first spark of obsession. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter II as evidence for a larger claim about the first spark of obsession in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter II as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the first spark of obsession. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It advanced from behind the mountains of Jura; and the thunder burst at once with frightful loudness from various quarters of the heavens.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “loudness” most nearly mean?

   A. immune to attack; impregnable

   B. the quality of being loud

   C. broken into sharp pieces

   D. a predisposition in favor of something

2. *The untaught peasant beheld the elements around him, and was acquainted with their practical uses. The most learned philosopher knew little more. He had partially unveiled the face of Nature, but her immortal lineaments were still a wonder and a mystery. He might dissect, anatomise, and give names; but, not to speak of a final cause, causes in their secondary and tertiary grades were utterly unknown to him. I had gazed upon the fortifications and impediments that seemed to keep human beings from entering the citadel of nature, and rashly and ignorantly I had repined.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter II”?

   A. First experiences of the senses

   B. Delay and dread

   C. Isolation in the north

   D. The first spark of obsession

SAT key: 1. B (the quality of being loud); 2. D (The first spark of obsession)

Lesson 10: Chapter III

Focus: loss and leaving home

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor's mother dies of scarlet fever caught while nursing Elizabeth, and on her deathbed asks Victor and Elizabeth to marry. Victor leaves for the University of Ingolstadt, where M. Krempe scorns his alchemists and M. Waldman inspires him with modern chemistry.

Background: Ingolstadt (Bavaria) had a real university and was associated with the Illuminati, a secret society. Chemistry was rapidly changing in this era.

Significance: Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because....
Prompt: How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: prepossess — to make someone feel favorably in advance; crucible — a heat-resistant container used for melting substances; residents — people who live in a place; fatiguing — tiring; chimeras — wild, impossible dreams or fantasies. “prepossess”: pre- "before" + possess: first "to occupy beforehand," later "to fill someone beforehand with a (favorable) feeling."
Words: prepossess: to make someone feel favorably in advance · crucible: a heat-resistant container used for melting substances · residents: people who live in a place · fatiguing: tiring · chimeras: wild, impossible dreams or fantasies

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Ingolstadt (Bavaria) had a real university and was associated with the Illuminati, a secret society. Chemistry was rapidly changing in this era. Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve. Structure: The chapter turns on two losses: his mother's death and his departure for Ingolstadt. The mother's death is called "an omen." Characterization: Professors Krempe and Waldman pull him in opposite directions; Waldman's flattering vision of modern science wins him. Diction / vocabulary: The rhetoric of "pioneer," "unknown powers," "deepest mysteries of creation" shows Victor's ambition in his own voice. Watch for the mother's death: she dies nursing Elizabeth, an act of care; her loss leaves Victor to replace death with creation.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "the first misfortune of my life occurred" (Chapter III, paragraph 1). Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. That is structure at work: The chapter turns on two losses: his mother's death and his departure for Ingolstadt. The mother's death is called "an omen."

> *the first misfortune of my life occurred* (Chapter III, paragraph 1)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1). Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. That is structure at work: The chapter turns on two losses: his mother's death and his departure for Ingolstadt. The mother's death is called "an omen."

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Repeating "more" shows escalating ambition; "pioneer" makes him a hero in his own story. This connects to ambition and the hunger to surpass every limit. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. (The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.)

> *more, far more, will I achieve* (Chapter III, paragraph 17)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Repeating "more" shows escalating ambition; "pioneer" makes him a hero in his own story. This connects to ambition and the hunger to surpass every limit.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. (The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about loss and leaving home? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of loss and leaving home. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. When the text says “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. Right after his mother's death he hears Waldman praise modern science and vows "more, far more, will I achieve," showing ambition rushing to fill the space left by loss.
Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about loss and leaving home? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of loss and leaving home. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. When the text says “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17), it shows this directly. Right after his mother's death he hears Waldman praise modern science and vows "more, far more, will I achieve," showing ambition rushing to fill the space left by loss.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death? Some readers connect the mother's death with the decision to create life. Ask students whether the text supports that link.
Anchor question: How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death?
Facilitation: Some readers connect the mother's death with the decision to create life. Ask students whether the text supports that link.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about loss and leaving home? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. (“more, far more, will I achieve”, Chapter III, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about loss and leaving home? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. (“more, far more, will I achieve”, Chapter III, paragraph 17). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how structure shapes loss and leaving home. Key takeaway: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** The chapter turns on two losses: his mother's death and his departure for Ingolstadt. The mother's death is called "an omen."
- **Characterization:** Professors Krempe and Waldman pull him in opposite directions; Waldman's flattering vision of modern science wins him.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** The rhetoric of "pioneer," "unknown powers," "deepest mysteries of creation" shows Victor's ambition in his own voice.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further.

Symbols and motifs

- **the mother's death:** she dies nursing Elizabeth, an act of care; her loss leaves Victor to replace death with creation.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1) Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering.
- “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16) Waldman's contrast between old and modern science.
- “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17) The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself.
Evidence: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17)
Reasoning: Right after his mother's death he hears Waldman praise modern science and vows "more, far more, will I achieve," showing ambition rushing to fill the space left by loss.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	Word history

	Definition (in this sentence)		
prepossess (verb)	to make someone feel favorably in advance	*Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits.*	“prepossess”: pre- "before" + possess: first "to occupy beforehand," later "to fill someone beforehand with a (favorable) feeling." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/prepossess)
crucible (noun)	a heat-resistant container used for melting substances	*But these philosophers, whose hands seem only made to dabble in dirt, and their eyes to pore over the microscope or crucible, have indeed performed miracles.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
residents (noun)	people who live in a place	*Such were my reflections during the first two or three days of my residence at Ingolstadt, which were chiefly spent in becoming acquainted with the localities, and the principal residents in my new abode.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
fatiguing (adjective)	tiring	*I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
chimeras (noun)	wild, impossible dreams or fantasies	*I was required to exchange chimeras of boundless grandeur for realities of little worth.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
transmuted (verb)	changed into a different substance	*The modern masters promise very little; they know that metals cannot be transmuted, and that the elixir of life is a chimera.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
panegyric (noun)	a speech or piece of writing full of praise	*After having made a few preparatory experiments, he concluded with a panegyric upon modern chemistry, the terms of which I shall never forget:—*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
insurrection (noun)	organized opposition to authority; a conflict in which one faction tries to wrest control from another	*My internal being was in a state of insurrection and turmoil; I felt that order would thence arise, but I had no power to produce it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
			Student look-up (not yet verified)

commences (verb)	take the first step or steps in carrying out an action	*These are the reflections of the first days; but when the lapse of time proves the reality of the evil, then the actual bitterness of grief commences.*	
imbibed (verb)	take in, also metaphorically	*Good God! in what desert land have you lived, where no one was kind enough to inform you that these fancies, which you have so greedily imbibed, are a thousand years old, and as musty as they are ancient?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. How does Victor's mother die? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth
2. What is her dying wish? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: That Victor and Elizabeth marry
3. Where does Victor go to university? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Ingolstadt
4. Which professor inspires Victor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: M. Waldman
5. How does M. Krempe react to Victor's reading? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He scorns it as outdated nonsense
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter III” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Victor's mother dies of scarlet fever caught while nursing Elizabeth, and on her deathbed asks Victor and Elizabeth to marry. Victor leaves for the University of Ingolstadt, where M. Krempe scorns his alchemists and M. Waldman inspires him with modern chemistry.

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter III”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter III” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits.” What does “prepossess” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: prepossess: to make someone feel favorably in advance.
10. Reread: “But these philosophers, whose hands seem only made to dabble in dirt, and their eyes to pore over the microscope or crucible, have indeed performed miracles.” What does “crucible” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: crucible: a heat-resistant container used for melting substances.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter III” suggest about loss and leaving home? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about loss and leaving home? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. On characterization: Professors Krempe and Waldman pull him in opposite directions; Waldman's flattering vision of modern science wins him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter III”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Victor's mother dies of scarlet fever caught while nursing Elizabeth, and on her deathbed asks Victor and Elizabeth to marry. Victor leaves for the University of Ingolstadt, where M. Krempe scorns his alchemists and M. Waldman inspires him with modern chemistry.
6. How does “Chapter III” build on “Chapter II”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16): Waldman's contrast between old and modern science. On structure: The chapter turns on

two losses: his mother's death and his departure for Ingolstadt. The mother's death is called "an omen." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17): The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before. On characterization: Professors Krempe and Waldman pull him in opposite directions; Waldman's flattering vision of modern science wins him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “How might his mother's death affect Victor's desire to conquer death?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Ingolstadt (Bavaria) had a real university and was associated with the Illuminati, a secret society. Chemistry was rapidly changing in this era. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16): Waldman's contrast between old and modern science. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Grief and ambition merge; Waldman's speech about scientists who 'penetrate into the recesses of nature' ignites Victor's resolve.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17): The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate

into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. On characterization: Professors Krempe and Waldman pull him in opposite directions; Waldman's flattering vision of modern science wins him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter III” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about loss and leaving home? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16): Waldman's contrast between old and modern science. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter III”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17): The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16): Waldman's contrast between old and modern science. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter III” treats loss and leaving home with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17): The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Predict what “Chapter IV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “the first misfortune of my life occurred” (Chapter III, paragraph 1): Narrated with hindsight; sets a pattern of suffering. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about loss and leaving home? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “promised impossibilities, and performed nothing” (Chapter III, paragraph 16): Waldman's contrast between old and modern science. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Ingolstadt turns Victor's grief and curiosity into a vow to master life itself. Useful evidence: “more, far more, will I achieve” (Chapter III, paragraph 17): The heart of Victor's ambition: more than anyone before. Theme link: Waldman says modern scientists "penetrate into the recesses of nature"; Victor answers with a vow to go further. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. How does Victor's mother die?
   A. A carriage accident
   B. Drowning
   C. Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth
   D. Old age
2. What is her dying wish?
   A. That Victor become a priest
   B. That the family move
   C. That Victor stay home
   D. That Victor and Elizabeth marry
3. Where does Victor go to university?
   A. Ingolstadt
   B. Geneva
   C. Paris
   D. Oxford
4. Which professor inspires Victor?
   A. M. Krempe
   B. Dr. Darwin
   C. M. Waldman
   D. M. Clerval
5. How does M. Krempe react to Victor's reading?
   A. He scorns it as outdated nonsense
   B. He gives Victor more alchemy books
   C. He praises it
   D. He expels Victor
6. In the line “Krempe was a little squat man, with a gruff voice and a repulsive countenance; the teacher, therefore, did not prepossess me in favour of his pursuits.”, what does “prepossess” most nearly mean?
   A. tiring
   B. to make someone feel favorably in advance
   C. a heat-resistant container used for melting substances
   D. people who live in a place
7. In the line “But these philosophers, whose hands seem only made to dabble in dirt, and their eyes to pore over the microscope or crucible, have indeed performed miracles.”, what does “crucible” most nearly mean?
   A. tiring
   B. to make someone feel favorably in advance
   C. a heat-resistant container used for melting substances
   D. people who live in a place

Answer key: 1. C (Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth); 2. D (That Victor and Elizabeth marry); 3. A (Ingolstadt); 4. C (M. Waldman); 5. A (He scorns it as outdated nonsense); 6. B (to make someone feel favorably in advance); 7. C (a heat-resistant container used for melting substances)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter III," how does Shelley show loss and leaving home? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter III, how does Shelley develop the idea of loss and leaving home? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter III develops the idea of loss and leaving home. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter III (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of loss and leaving home. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter III suggests about loss and leaving home. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter III to complicate the reader's understanding of loss and leaving home. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter III within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of loss and leaving home responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter III alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of loss and leaving home follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter III and its treatment of loss and leaving home. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter III as evidence for a larger claim about loss and leaving home in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter III as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of loss and leaving home. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Such were my reflections during the first two or three days of my residence at Ingolstadt, which were chiefly spent in becoming acquainted with the localities, and the principal residents in my new abode.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “residents” most nearly mean?

   A. organized opposition to authority; a conflict in which one faction tries to wrest control from another

   B. people who live in a place

   C. take in, also metaphorically

   D. take the first step or steps in carrying out an action

2. *I had sufficient leisure for these and many other reflections during my journey to Ingolstadt, which was long and fatiguing. At length the high white steeple of the town met my eyes. I alighted, and was conducted to my solitary apartment, to spend the evening as I pleased.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter III”?

   A. The first death and growing guilt

   B. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   C. Loss and leaving home

   D. Language, knowledge and sorrow

SAT key: 1. B (people who live in a place); 2. C (Loss and leaving home)

Lesson 11: Chapter IV

Focus: obsession and the discovery of life

Content note (grave-robbing, dissection): Victor describes collecting body parts from charnel-houses and dissecting rooms. Keep the focus on ambition and ethics, not gore.
Student preview: This chapter describes Victor gathering materials from graves and dissecting rooms.
Suggested language: "What lines does Victor cross here, and does he notice them?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor works tirelessly, masters chemistry, and discovers the cause of life. Gathering materials from charnel houses and dissecting rooms, he neglects family and health for nearly two years as he builds a being of gigantic stature.

Background: Body-snatching to supply anatomy schools was a real scandal of the era. 'Natural philosophy' was the period term for science.

Significance: Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because.... Content note before we start: This chapter describes Victor gathering materials from graves and dissecting rooms.
Prompt: Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: procrastinate — to put off doing something; slaughterhouse — a building where animals are killed for meat; dissecting — used for cutting up bodies to study them; dabbled — dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid; charnel — a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited.
Words: procrastinate: to put off doing something · slaughterhouse: a building where animals are killed for meat · dissecting: used for cutting up bodies to study them · dabbled: dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid · charnel: a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Body-snatching to supply anatomy schools was a real scandal of the era. 'Natural philosophy' was the period term for science. Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution. Point of view: Victor interrupts his story to address Walton directly: "Learn from me." The older Victor judges the younger. Imagery: Charnel-houses, dissecting rooms, pale cheeks: the work is described as unhealthy and secret. Structure: Two years compressed into one chapter; seasons pass unnoticed, showing how obsession erases ordinary life. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "ardent and eager, that the stars often disappeared in the light of morning whilst I was yet engaged in my laboratory" (Chapter IV, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge" (Chapter IV, paragraph 6). The novel's warning stated outright. That is point of view at work: Victor interrupts his story to address Walton directly: "Learn from me." The older Victor judges the younger.

> *Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge (Chapter IV, paragraph 6)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge" (Chapter IV, paragraph 6). The novel's warning stated outright. That is point of view at work: Victor interrupts his story to address Walton directly: "Learn from me." The older Victor judges the younger.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Bless me" shows he wants gratitude and worship. "Creator and source" are words for God. This connects to ambition: he wants to play God without God's responsibility. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. (Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives.)

> *A new species would bless me as its creator and source (Chapter IV, paragraph 8)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Bless me" shows he wants gratitude and worship. "Creator and source" are words for God. This connects to ambition: he wants to play God without God's responsibility.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. (Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for point of view, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about obsession and the discovery of life? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of obsession and the discovery of life. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. When the text says "A new species would bless me as its creator and source" (Chapter IV, paragraph 8), it shows this directly. He imagines a new species that "would bless me as its creator," which centers his own glory; nothing in his plans considers what the being will need.

Task: Annotate the chapter for point of view, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about obsession and the discovery of life? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of obsession and the discovery of life. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important? Ask students to separate the older narrator's judgment from the younger Victor's actions in this chapter.

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Facilitation: Ask students to separate the older narrator's judgment from the younger Victor's actions in this chapter.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about obsession and the discovery of life? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. ("A new species would bless me as its creator and source", Chapter IV, paragraph 8). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about obsession and the discovery of life? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. ("A new species would bless me as its creator and source", Chapter IV, paragraph 8). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how point of view shapes obsession and the discovery of life. Key takeaway: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** Victor interrupts his story to address Walton directly: "Learn from me." The older Victor judges the younger.
- **Imagery:** Charnel-houses, dissecting rooms, pale cheeks: the work is described as unhealthy and secret.
- **Structure:** Two years compressed into one chapter; seasons pass unnoticed, showing how obsession erases ordinary life.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped.
- **isolation and companionship:** he neglects his family and friends; work cuts him off.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “ardent and eager, that the stars often disappeared in the light of morning whilst I was yet engaged in my laboratory” (Chapter IV, paragraph 1).
- **isolation:** Almost every narrator ends up alone; solitude is both the cost of ambition and the creature's suffering. In this chapter: “had directed their enquiries towards the same science, that I alone should be reserved to discover so astonishing a secret” (Chapter IV, paragraph 3).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6) The novel's warning stated outright.
- “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8) Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives.
- “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4) The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates.
> **Evidence:** “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8)

Reasoning: He imagines a new species that "would bless me as its creator," which centers his own glory; nothing in his plans considers what the being will need.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
procrastinate (verb)	to put off doing something	*I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
slaughterhouse (noun)	a building where animals are killed for meat	*The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dissecting (adjective)	used for cutting up bodies to study them	*The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dabbled (verb)	dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid	*Who shall conceive the horrors of my secret toil, as I dabbled among the unhallowed damps of the grave, or tortured the living animal to animate the lifeless clay?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
charnel (noun)	a vault or building where corpses or bones are deposited	*Now I was led to examine the cause and progress of this decay, and forced to spend days and nights in vaults and charnel-houses.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disquieted (verb)	disturb in mind or make uneasy or cause to be worried or alarmed	*I knew my silence disquieted them; and I well remembered the words of my father: "I know that while you are pleased with yourself, you will think of us with affection, and we shall hear regularly from you.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
abstruse (adjective)	difficult to penetrate; incomprehensible to one of ordinary understanding or knowledge	*In a thousand ways he smoothed for me the path of knowledge, and made the most abstruse enquiries clear and facile to my apprehension.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unguarded (adjective)	frank; careless about hiding feelings	*I will not lead you on, unguarded and ardent as I then was, to your destruction and infallible misery.*	Student look-up

			(not yet verified)
vintage (noun)	a season's yield of wine from a vineyard	*It was a most beautiful season; never did the fields bestow a more plentiful harvest, or the vines yield a more luxuriant vintage: but my eyes were insensible to the charms of nature.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
physiology (noun)	the branch of the biological sciences dealing with the functioning of organisms	*I revolved these circumstances in my mind, and determined thenceforth to apply myself more particularly to those branches of natural philosophy which relate to physiology.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Victor discover? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The cause of generation and life
2. Where does Victor gather materials? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Charnel houses and dissecting rooms
3. Why does Victor make the being gigantic? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The small parts were hard to work with
4. What happens to Victor's health and relationships? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He neglects his family and grows ill and pale
5. What does Victor refuse to share with Walton? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The secret of how he created life
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter IV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Victor works tirelessly, masters chemistry, and discovers the cause of life. Gathering materials from charnel houses and dissecting rooms, he neglects family and health for nearly two years as he builds a being of gigantic stature.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter IV"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.

8. Where and when does “Chapter IV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed.” What does “procrastinate” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: procrastinate: to put off doing something.
10. Reread: “The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I…” What does “slaughterhouse” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: slaughterhouse: a building where animals are killed for meat.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter IV” suggest about obsession and the discovery of life? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the tone / mood in this chapter shape what we understand about obsession and the discovery of life? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6): The novel's warning stated outright. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “I see by your eagerness, and the wonder and hope which your eyes express, my friend, that you expect to be informed of the secret with which I am acquainted; that cannot be:…”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter IV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Victor works tirelessly, masters chemistry, and discovers the cause of life. Gathering materials from charnel houses and dissecting rooms, he neglects family and health for nearly two years as he builds a being of gigantic stature.
6. How does “Chapter IV” build on “Chapter III”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8): Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives. On structure: Two years compressed into one chapter; seasons pass unnoticed, showing how obsession erases ordinary

life. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4): The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Victor refuses to tell Walton how he created life. Why is this choice important?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

9. Where does imagery appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6): The novel's warning stated outright. On imagery: Charnel-houses, dissecting rooms, pale cheeks: the work is described as unhealthy and secret. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Body-snatching to supply anatomy schools was a real scandal of the era. 'Natural philosophy' was the period term for science. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8): Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Victor withholds the secret from Walton, warning 'how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge'—the novel's core moral caution.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4): The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret. Theme link: he neglects his family and friends; work cuts him off. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6): The novel's warning stated outright. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter IV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about obsession and the discovery of life? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8): Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives. On point of view: Victor interrupts his story to address Walton directly: "Learn from me." The older Victor judges the younger. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter IV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4): The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6): The novel's warning stated outright. Theme link: he neglects his family and friends; work cuts him off. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “A new species would bless me as its creator and

source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8): Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter IV” treats obsession and the discovery of life with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4): The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret. Theme link: he neglects his family and friends; work cuts him off. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter V” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge” (Chapter IV, paragraph 6): The novel's warning stated outright. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about obsession and the discovery of life? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “A new species would bless me as its creator and source” (Chapter IV, paragraph 8): Desire for glory, not care; evidence of selfish motives. Theme link: he neglects his family and friends; work cuts him off. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's motive for creating life is the desire to be honored, not to care for what he creates. Useful evidence: “I became myself capable of bestowing animation upon lifeless matter” (Chapter IV, paragraph 4): The discovery itself, told without explanation; Victor withholds the secret. Theme link: Victor fantasizes that "a new species would bless me as its creator," revealing the wish to be worshipped. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)

- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create

Chapter quiz

1. What does Victor discover?
   A. A route to the pole
   B. A cure for fever
   C. A new planet
   D. The cause of generation and life
2. Where does Victor gather materials?
   A. A church garden
   B. The forest
   C. The market
   D. Charnel houses and dissecting rooms
3. Why does Victor make the being gigantic?
   A. By accident
   B. The small parts were hard to work with
   C. To frighten enemies
   D. To make it strong for labor
4. What happens to Victor's health and relationships?
   A. He becomes stronger
   B. He travels widely
   C. He neglects his family and grows ill and pale
   D. He marries
5. What does Victor refuse to share with Walton?
   A. His age
   B. His family's names
   C. The secret of how he created life
   D. The location of Geneva
6. In the line “I wished, as it were, to procrastinate all that related to my feelings of affection until the great object, which swallowed up every habit of my nature, should be completed.”, what does “procrastinate” most nearly mean?
   A. dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid
   B. used for cutting up bodies to study them
   C. a building where animals are killed for meat
   D. to put off doing something
7. In the line “The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which

perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.", what does "slaughterhouse" most nearly mean?

A. dip a foot or hand briefly into a liquid

B. a building where animals are killed for meat

C. to put off doing something

D. used for cutting up bodies to study them

Answer key: 1. D (The cause of generation and life); 2. D (Charnel houses and dissecting rooms); 3. B (The small parts were hard to work with); 4. C (He neglects his family and grows ill and pale); 5. C (The secret of how he created life); 6. D (to put off doing something); 7. B (a building where animals are killed for meat)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter IV," how does Shelley show obsession and the discovery of life? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter IV, how does Shelley develop the idea of obsession and the discovery of life? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter IV develops the idea of obsession and the discovery of life. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of obsession and the discovery of life. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IV suggests about obsession and the discovery of life. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter IV to complicate the reader's understanding of obsession and the discovery of life. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter IV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of obsession and the

discovery of life responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter IV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of obsession and the discovery of life follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IV and its treatment of obsession and the discovery of life. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IV as evidence for a larger claim about obsession and the discovery of life in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of obsession and the discovery of life. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The dissecting room and the slaughterhouse furnished many of my materials; and often did my human nature turn with loathing from my occupation, whilst, still urged on by an eagerness which perpetually increased, I brought my work near to a conclusion.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “dissecting” most nearly mean?

   A. a season's yield of wine from a vineyard

   B. frank; careless about hiding feelings

   C. the branch of the biological sciences dealing with the functioning of organisms

   D. used for cutting up bodies to study them

2. *I see by your eagerness, and the wonder and hope which your eyes express, my friend, that you expect to be informed of the secret with which I am acquainted; that cannot be: listen patiently until the end of my story, and you will easily perceive why I am reserved upon that subject. I will not lead you on, unguarded and ardent as I then was, to your destruction and infallible misery. Learn from me, if not by my precepts, at least by my example, how dangerous is the acquirement of knowledge, and how much happier that man is who believes his native town to be the world, than he who aspires to become greater than his nature will allow.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter IV”?

   A. Learning compassion by watching

   B. Reading and identity

   C. Obsession and the discovery of life

D. The origin of the novel and the idea of creation

SAT key: 1. D (used for cutting up bodies to study them); 2. C (Obsession and the discovery of life)

Lesson 12: Chapter V

Focus: horror at the moment of creation

Teacher only · spoilers

On a dreary November night, the creature opens its 'dull yellow eye.' Horrified by its appearance, Victor flees, dreams of Elizabeth turning into his mother's corpse, and wakes to see the creature reaching toward him. He runs into the street, meets Clerval, and collapses into a long fever, nursed by Henry.

Background: Gothic novels used darkness, storms and nightmares to produce dread. The quoted lines from Coleridge's 'Ancient Mariner' reinforce Victor's guilt.

Significance: The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....
Prompt: Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence.
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: agitates — upsets; disturbs; palpitated — beat fast and hard (of the heart); infusing — putting a quality or feeling into something; relapses — returns of an illness after improvement; lassitude — tiredness and lack of energy.
Words: agitates: upsets; disturbs · palpitated: beat fast and hard (of the heart) · infusing: putting a quality or feeling into something · relapses: returns of an illness after improvement · lassitude: tiredness and lack of energy

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Gothic novels used darkness, storms and nightmares to produce dread. The quoted lines from Coleridge's 'Ancient Mariner' reinforce Victor's guilt. The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat. Imagery: The creation scene: a dreary night, rain, a dying candle, a "dull yellow eye." The details are few and precise, so the horror is in the response, not the science. Irony: He chose the creature's features "as beautiful," yet the result is hideous; the dream becomes a nightmare. Characterization: Victor flees twice, from the creature at his bed and from his responsibility, and calls it "the wretch." Watch for the outstretched hand: the creature reaches for him; Victor reads it as a threat. The gesture is the novel's image of rejected need.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils" (Chapter V, paragraph 1). Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. That is imagery at work: The creation scene: a dreary night, rain, a dying candle, a "dull yellow eye." The details are few and precise, so the horror is in the response, not the science.

> *It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils* (Chapter V, paragraph 1)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils" (Chapter V, paragraph 1). Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. That is imagery at work: The creation scene: a dreary night, rain, a dying candle, a "dull yellow eye." The details are few and precise, so the horror is in the response, not the science.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Seemingly" shows Victor is guessing; "detain" means to hold back, a child-like reach. He "escaped," treating his creation as a threat. This is the core of the responsibility theme. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: The moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. (The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts.)

> *one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped* (Chapter V, paragraph 3)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Seemingly" shows Victor is guessing; "detain" means to hold back, a child-like reach. He "escaped," treating his creation as a threat. This is the core of the responsibility theme.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: The moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. (The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for imagery, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about horror at the moment of creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of horror at the moment of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. When the text says “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. The creature's "hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me," a gesture of need, and Victor simply "escaped"; the word "seemingly" shows he does not know what it wants and does not stay to find out.

Task: Annotate the chapter for imagery, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about horror at the moment of creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of horror at the moment of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. When the text says “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. The creature's "hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me," a gesture of need, and Victor simply "escaped"; the word "seemingly" shows he does not know what it wants and does not stay to find out.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence. Ask: is Victor's horror understandable? Credit sympathy for Victor, but require students to explain what a responsible creator would have done.

Anchor question: Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence.

Facilitation: Ask: is Victor's horror understandable? Credit sympathy for Victor, but require students to explain what a responsible creator would have done.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about horror at the moment of creation? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. ("one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped", Chapter V, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about horror at the moment of creation? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. ("one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped", Chapter V, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how imagery shapes horror at the moment of creation. Key takeaway: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Imagery:** The creation scene: a dreary night, rain, a dying candle, a "dull yellow eye." The details are few and precise, so the horror is in the response, not the science.
- **Irony:** He chose the creature's features "as beautiful," yet the result is hideous; the dream becomes a nightmare.
- **Characterization:** Victor flees twice, from the creature at his bed and from his responsibility, and calls it "the wretch."

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment.

Symbols and motifs

- **the outstretched hand:** the creature reaches for him; Victor reads it as a threat. The gesture is the novel's image of rejected need.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils" (Chapter V, paragraph 1) Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror.

- "the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart" (Chapter V, paragraph 3) The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence.
- "one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped" (Chapter V, paragraph 3) The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect.
Evidence: "one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped" (Chapter V, paragraph 3)
Reasoning: The creature's "hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me," a gesture of need, and Victor simply "escaped"; the word "seemingly" shows he does not know what it wants and does not stay to find out.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
agitates (verb)	upsets; disturbs	*"Compose yourself," said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, "I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
palpitated (verb)	beat fast and hard (of the heart)	*My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
infusing (verb)	putting a quality or feeling into something	*I had worked hard for nearly two years, for the sole purpose of infusing life into an inanimate body.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
relapses (noun)	returns of an illness after improvement	*By very slow degrees, and with frequent relapses, that alarmed and grieved my friend, I recovered.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
lassitude (noun)	tiredness and lack of energy	*At length lassitude succeeded to the tumult I had before endured; and I threw myself on the bed in my clothes, endeavouring to seek a few moments of forgetfulness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
convalescence (noun)	gradual healing (through rest) after sickness or injury	*It was a divine spring; and the season contributed greatly to my convalescence.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
alighting (verb)	to come to rest, settle	*"My dear Frankenstein," exclaimed he, "how glad I am to see you! how fortunate that you should be here at the very moment of my alighting!"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unbounded (adjective)	seemingly boundless in amount, number,	*But I was in reality very ill; and surely nothing but the unbounded and unremitting attentions of my friend could have restored me to life.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

	degree, or especially extent		
wildness (noun)	a feeling of extreme emotional intensity	*Clerval at first attributed my unusual spirits to joy on his arrival; but when he observed me more attentively, he saw a wildness in my eyes for which he could not account; and my loud, unrestrained, heartless laughter, frightened and astonished him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bedchamber (noun)	a room used primarily for sleeping	*Unable to endure the aspect of the being I had created, I rushed out of the room, and continued a long time traversing my bedchamber, unable to compose my mind to sleep.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence.
2. Where does imagery appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What month does the creature come to life? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: November
2. What first feature of the creature does Victor describe? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Its dull yellow eye
3. What does Victor dream after fleeing? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Elizabeth turns into his dead mother's corpse
4. Who arrives in Ingolstadt and nurses Victor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Henry Clerval
5. What is ironic about this chapter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Victor abandons the being he worked years to create
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter V” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: On a dreary November night, the creature opens its 'dull yellow eye.' Horrified by its appearance, Victor flees, dreams of Elizabeth turning into his mother's corpse, and wakes to see the creature reaching toward him. He runs into the street, meets Clerval, and collapses into a long fever, nursed by Henry.

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter V”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter V” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: ““Compose yourself,” said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, “I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting.” What does “agitates” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: agitates: upsets; disturbs.
10. Reread: “My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—” What does “palpitated” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: palpitated: beat fast and hard (of the heart).

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter V” suggest about horror at the moment of creation? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat.
2. Find one example of imagery in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.
3. How does the tone / mood in this chapter shape what we understand about horror at the moment of creation? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1): Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “I continued walking in this manner for some time, endeavouring, by bodily exercise, to ease the load that weighed upon my mind.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter V”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: On a dreary November night, the creature opens its 'dull yellow eye.' Horrified by its appearance, Victor flees, dreams of Elizabeth turning into his mother's corpse, and wakes to see the creature reaching toward him. He runs into the street, meets Clerval, and collapses into a long fever, nursed…
6. How does “Chapter V” build on “Chapter IV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The turn from

ambition to revulsion in one sentence. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts. On characterization: Victor flees twice, from the creature at his bed and from his responsibility, and calls it "the wretch." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Was the creature's first gesture threatening or loving? Use evidence.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1): Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. On irony: He chose the creature's features "as beautiful," yet the result is hideous; the dream becomes a nightmare. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Gothic novels used darkness, storms and nightmares to produce dread. The quoted lines from Coleridge's 'Ancient Mariner' reinforce Victor's guilt. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The irony is sharp: the being Victor labored to make is abandoned within minutes. The creature's outstretched hand may be a gesture of affection that Victor reads as threat.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “one hand was stretched out,

seemingly to detain me, but I escaped" (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: "It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils" (Chapter V, paragraph 1): Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. On characterization: Victor flees twice, from the creature at his bed and from his responsibility, and calls it "the wretch." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of "Chapter V" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about horror at the moment of creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: "the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart" (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about "Chapter V": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: "one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped" (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: "It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils" (Chapter V, paragraph 1): Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the imagery in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence. On imagery: The creation scene: a dreary night, rain, a dying candle, a "dull yellow eye." The details are few and precise, so the horror is in the response, not the science. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter V” treats horror at the moment of creation with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter VI” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “It was on a dreary night of November, that I beheld the accomplishment of my toils” (Chapter V, paragraph 1): Pathetic fallacy and anticlimax: "accomplishment" is followed by horror. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about horror at the moment of creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “the beauty of the dream vanished, and breathless horror and disgust filled my heart” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The turn from ambition to revulsion in one sentence. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor abandons his creation at the moment it reaches for him, so the creature's later violence begins in neglect. Useful evidence: “one hand was stretched out, seemingly to detain me, but I escaped” (Chapter V, paragraph 3): The creature's first gesture is reaching; Victor's response is flight. Key evidence that the creature is abandoned before it acts. Theme link: the moment of birth is the moment of abandonment. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Imagery:** look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. What month does the creature come to life?
   A. March
   B. December
   C. November
   D. June
2. What first feature of the creature does Victor describe?
   A. Its dull yellow eye
   B. Its smile
   C. Its voice
   D. Its hands
3. What does Victor dream after fleeing?
   A. He sails north
   B. Elizabeth turns into his dead mother's corpse
   C. He is drowning
   D. He is crowned king
4. Who arrives in Ingolstadt and nurses Victor?
   A. Walton
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Henry Clerval
   D. Alphonse
5. What is ironic about this chapter?
   A. The creature is tiny
   B. Clerval is a scientist
   C. Victor is happy
   D. Victor abandons the being he worked years to create
6. In the line ""Compose yourself," said Clerval, who observed my change of colour, "I will not mention it, if it agitates you; but your father and cousin would be very happy if they received a letter from you in your own handwriting.", what does "agitates" most nearly mean?
   A. beat fast and hard (of the heart)
   B. upsets; disturbs
   C. returns of an illness after improvement
   D. putting a quality or feeling into something

7. In the line “My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—”, what does “palpitated” most nearly mean?

   A. returns of an illness after improvement

   B. putting a quality or feeling into something

   C. beat fast and hard (of the heart)

   D. upsets; disturbs

Answer key: 1. C (November); 2. A (Its dull yellow eye); 3. B (Elizabeth turns into his dead mother's corpse); 4. C (Henry Clerval); 5. D (Victor abandons the being he worked years to create); 6. B (upsets; disturbs); 7. C (beat fast and hard (of the heart))

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.4, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter V,” how does Shelley show horror at the moment of creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the imagery you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): In Chapter V, how does Shelley develop the idea of horror at the moment of creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the imagery in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.4, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter V develops the idea of horror at the moment of creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of imagery and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter V (where it begins, turns and ends) and its imagery shape the reader's understanding of horror at the moment of creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter V suggests about horror at the moment of creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's imagery and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.4, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses imagery in Chapter V to complicate the reader's understanding of horror at the moment of creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter V within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of horror at the moment of

creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter V alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of horror at the moment of creation follows or bends those conventions, using the imagery as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter V and its treatment of horror at the moment of creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's imagery and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter V as evidence for a larger claim about horror at the moment of creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter V as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of horror at the moment of creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I had worked hard for nearly two years, for the sole purpose of infusing life into an inanimate body.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “infusing” most nearly mean?

   A. a feeling of extreme emotional intensity

   B. seemingly boundless in amount, number, degree, or especially extent

   C. a room used primarily for sleeping

   D. putting a quality or feeling into something

2. *I continued walking in this manner for some time, endeavouring, by bodily exercise, to ease the load that weighed upon my mind. I traversed the streets, without any clear conception of where I was, or what I was doing. My heart palpitated in the sickness of fear; and I hurried on with irregular steps, not daring to look about me:—*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter V”?

   A. Horror at the moment of creation

   B. Destroying the companion

   C. Despair and the sublime

   D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. D (putting a quality or feeling into something); 2. A (Horror at the moment of creation)

Lesson 13: Chapter VI

Focus: recovery and false peace

Teacher only · spoilers

Recovering, Victor reads a letter from Elizabeth telling of home and of Justine Moritz, a servant girl who became part of the family. Victor now hates natural philosophy. He and Clerval study languages and take a restorative walking tour.

Background: Romantic writers believed nature could heal the mind, a theme in Wordsworth's poetry.

Significance: The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because....
Prompt: Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: salubrious — healthy; good for the body; congratulatory — expressing congratulations; encomiums — speeches or remarks of high praise; vacillating — be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action; devolved — fallen as a duty (on someone).
Words: salubrious: healthy; good for the body · congratulatory: expressing congratulations · encomiums: speeches or remarks of high praise · vacillating: be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action · devolved: fallen as a duty (on someone)

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Romantic writers believed nature could heal the mind, a theme in Wordsworth's poetry. The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate. Characterization: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct. Irony: Victor recovers into a "false peace" while the creature is out in the world, unseen. Setting: Spring and nature restore him; Shelley uses nature as healer. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "read their writings, life appears to consist in a warm sun and a garden of roses—in the smiles and frowns of a" (Chapter VI, paragraph 18).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care" (Chapter VI, paragraph 21). Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. That is characterization at work: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct.

> *I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care (Chapter VI, paragraph 21)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care" (Chapter VI, paragraph 21). Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. That is characterization at work: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Cramped and narrowed" versus "warmed and opened": the contrast shows isolation shrinking a person and friendship restoring him, the theme of companionship. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. (Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence.)

> *A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses (Chapter VI, paragraph 21)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Cramped and narrowed" versus "warmed and opened": the contrast shows isolation shrinking a person and friendship restoring him, the theme of companionship.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. (Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about recovery and false peace? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of recovery and false peace. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. When the text says "A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses" (Chapter VI, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. Victor credits Clerval's "gentleness and affection" for curing what a "selfish pursuit" had done, so he knows what care is; he has simply not given it to his creation.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about recovery and false peace? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of recovery and false peace. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. When the text says "A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses" (Chapter VI, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. Victor credits Clerval's "gentleness and affection" for curing what a "selfish pursuit" had done, so he knows what care is; he has simply not given it to his creation.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter? Ask: what is Victor not telling Clerval, and why?

Anchor question: Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter?

Facilitation: Ask: what is Victor not telling Clerval, and why?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about recovery and false peace? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. ("A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses", Chapter VI, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about recovery and false peace? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. ("A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses", Chapter VI, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes recovery and false peace. Key takeaway: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct.
- **Irony:** Victor recovers into a "false peace" while the creature is out in the world, unseen.
- **Setting:** Spring and nature restore him; Shelley uses nature as healer.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “read their writings, life appears to consist in a warm sun and a garden of roses—in the smiles and frowns of a” (Chapter VI, paragraph 18).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “the open air, climbing the hills or rowing on the lake. I fear that he will become an idler, unless we yield” (Chapter VI, paragraph 4).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21) Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence.
- “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21) Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last.
- “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3) Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it.
Evidence: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21)

Reasoning: Victor credits Clerval's "gentleness and affection" for curing what a "selfish pursuit" had done, so he knows what care is; he has simply not given it to his creation.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
salubrious (adjective)	healthy; good for the body	*We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress, and the conversation of my friend.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
congratulatory (adjective)	expressing congratulations	*The pretty Miss Mansfield has already received the congratulatory visits on her approaching marriage with a young Englishman, John Melbourne, Esq.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
encomiums (noun)	speeches or remarks of high praise	*Krempe was not equally docile; and in my condition at that time, of almost insupportable sensitiveness, his harsh blunt encomiums gave me even more pain than the benevolent approbation of M.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vacillating (verb)	be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action	*The poor woman was very vacillating in her repentance.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
devolved (verb)	fallen as a duty (on someone)	*I figure to myself that the task of attending on your sick bed has devolved on some mercenary old nurse, who could never guess your wishes, nor minister to them with the care and affection of your poor cousin.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dialects (noun)	the usage or vocabulary that is characteristic of a specific group of people	*I did not, like him, attempt a critical knowledge of their dialects, for I did not contemplate making any other use of them than temporary amusement.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
alleging (verb)	giving as a reason	*Clerval, whose eyes and feelings were always quick in discerning the sensations of others, declined the subject, alleging, in excuse, his total ignorance; and the conversation took a more general turn.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dimples (noun)	small hollows in the cheeks, seen when smiling	*When he smiles, two little dimples appear on each cheek, which are rosy with health.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
retarded (verb)	cause to move more slowly or operate at a slower rate	*Summer passed away in these occupations, and my return to Geneva was fixed for the latter end of autumn; but being delayed by several accidents, winter*	Student look-up

		and snow arrived, the roads were deemed impassable, and my journey was retarded until the ensuing spring.	(not yet verified)
diffident (adjective)	showing modest reserve	*Young men should be diffident of themselves, you know, M.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who writes to Victor during his recovery? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Elizabeth
2. Who is Justine Moritz? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A girl who became a servant and part of the family
3. How does Victor now feel about natural philosophy? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He cannot bear it
4. What does Clerval study? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Oriental languages
5. What restores Victor's spirits? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A walking tour in nature with Clerval
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter VI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Recovering, Victor reads a letter from Elizabeth telling of home and of Justine Moritz, a servant girl who became part of the family. Victor now hates natural philosophy. He and Clerval study languages and take a restorative walking tour.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter VI"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter VI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress,

and the…" What does "salubrious" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: salubrious: healthy; good for the body.

10. Reread: "The pretty Miss Mansfield has already received the congratulatory visits on her approaching marriage with a young Englishman, John Melbourne, Esq." What does "congratulatory" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: congratulatory: expressing congratulations.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter VI" suggest about recovery and false peace? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate.
2. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
3. How does the tone / mood in this chapter shape what we understand about recovery and false peace? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: "A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses" (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ""I must say also a few words to you, my dear cousin, of little darling William.", why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in "Chapter VI", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Recovering, Victor reads a letter from Elizabeth telling of home and of Justine Moritz, a servant girl who became part of the family. Victor now hates natural philosophy. He and Clerval study languages and take a restorative walking tour.
6. How does "Chapter VI" build on "Chapter V"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: "I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care" (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it

highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3): Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim. On characterization: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Shelley introduce Justine through a cheerful letter?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence. On characterization: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Romantic writers believed nature could heal the mind, a theme in Wordsworth's poetry. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. On setting: Spring and nature restore him; Shelley uses nature as healer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The calm before tragedy: Justine's introduction sets up her later fate.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3): Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me,

until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence. On characterization: Clerval arrives and nurses Victor through months of fever: friendship as care, the opposite of Victor's conduct. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter VI” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about recovery and false peace? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter VI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3): Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. On setting: Spring and nature restore him; Shelley uses nature as healer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter VI” treats recovery and false peace with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3): Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Predict what “Chapter VII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “A selfish pursuit had cramped and narrowed me, until your gentleness and affection warmed and opened my senses” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Victor names his work "selfish": a rare admission and strong evidence. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about recovery and false peace? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “I became the same happy creature who, a few years ago, loved and beloved by all, had no sorrow or care” (Chapter VI, paragraph 21): Restoration that the reader suspects cannot last. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's nursing shows the care the novel values, and it highlights Victor's failure to give it. Useful evidence: “dear Victor” (Chapter VI, paragraph 3): Elizabeth's letter opens with domestic affection, recalling the Preface's stated aim. Theme link: Clerval shows what companionship gives: Victor says a selfish pursuit had "cramped and narrowed" him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Who writes to Victor during his recovery?
   A. Walton
   B. His mother
   C. Krempe
   D. Elizabeth
2. Who is Justine Moritz?
   A. An innkeeper
   B. A girl who became a servant and part of the family
   C. A professor
   D. Victor's sister
3. How does Victor now feel about natural philosophy?
   A. He loves it more
   B. He teaches it
   C. He is indifferent
   D. He cannot bear it
4. What does Clerval study?
   A. Medicine
   B. Chemistry
   C. Oriental languages
   D. Astronomy
5. What restores Victor's spirits?
   A. A sea voyage
   B. A party
   C. A walking tour in nature with Clerval
   D. A new experiment
6. In the line "We passed a fortnight in these perambulations: my health and spirits had long been restored, and they gained additional strength from the salubrious air I breathed, the natural incidents of our progress, and the conversation of my friend.", what does "salubrious" most nearly mean?
   A. speeches or remarks of high praise
   B. be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action
   C. expressing congratulations
   D. healthy; good for the body
7. In the line "The pretty Miss Mansfield has already received the congratulatory visits on her approaching marriage with a young Englishman, John Melbourne, Esq.", what does "congratulatory" most nearly mean?
   A. healthy; good for the body
   B. be undecided about something; waver between conflicting positions or courses of action
   C. speeches or remarks of high praise
   D. expressing congratulations

Answer key: 1. D (Elizabeth); 2. B (A girl who became a servant and part of the family); 3. D (He cannot bear it); 4. C (Oriental languages); 5. C (A walking tour in nature with Clerval); 6. D (healthy; good for the body); 7. D (expressing congratulations)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter VI," how does Shelley show recovery and false peace? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter VI, how does Shelley develop the idea of recovery and false peace? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter VI develops the idea of recovery and false peace. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of recovery and false peace. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VI suggests about recovery and false peace. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter VI to complicate the reader's understanding of recovery and false peace. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter VI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of recovery and false peace responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter VI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of recovery and false peace follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VI and its treatment of recovery and false peace. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VI as evidence for a larger claim about recovery and false peace in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of recovery and false peace. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Krempe was not equally docile; and in my condition at that time, of almost insupportable sensitiveness, his harsh blunt encomiums gave me even more pain than the benevolent approbation of M.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “encomiums” most nearly mean?

   A. speeches or remarks of high praise

   B. cause to move more slowly or operate at a slower rate

   C. showing modest reserve

   D. small hollows in the cheeks, seen when smiling

2. *“I must say also a few words to you, my dear cousin, of little darling William. I wish you could see him; he is very tall of his age, with sweet laughing blue eyes, dark eyelashes, and curling hair. When he smiles, two little dimples appear on each cheek, which are rosy with health. He has already had one or two little wives, but Louisa Biron is his favourite, a pretty little girl of five years of age.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VI”?

   A. Rejection and the turn to revenge

   B. Language, knowledge and sorrow

   C. The demand for a companion

   D. Recovery and false peace

SAT key: 1. A (speeches or remarks of high praise); 2. D (Recovery and false peace)

Lesson 14: Chapter VII

Focus: the first death and growing guilt

Content note (murder of a child): William, a young child, is found murdered. Some students may have experienced loss; allow a pass on reading aloud.
Student preview: This chapter reports the murder of a young child.
Suggested language: "How does the family's grief shape what happens next?"

Teacher only · spoilers

A letter from his father reports that Victor's youngest brother, William, has been murdered. Returning to Geneva during a storm, Victor glimpses the creature near the spot and becomes certain it is the killer. He learns that Justine has been accused because William's locket was found on her.

Background: The Alps and storms are classic sublime settings—vast nature that inspires awe and fear.

Significance: Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because.... Content note before we start: This chapter reports the murder of a young child.
Prompt: Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: cabriolet — a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse; prognosticate — to predict; to be a sign of; scaling — climbing; desolating — causing great grief or ruin; festering — infected and full of pus.
Words: cabriolet: a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse · prognosticate: to predict; to be a sign of · scaling: climbing · desolating: causing great grief or ruin · festering: infected and full of pus

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Alps and storms are classic sublime settings—vast nature that inspires awe and fear. Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit. Plot: William's murder (told in a letter), Victor's return to Geneva, the glimpse of the creature in the storm, and Justine's arrest. Setting: The thunderstorm over the Alps is sublime and reveals the creature by lightning. Irony: Victor knows who the murderer is but remains silent while Justine is accused. Watch for lightning: as in Chapter II, lightning reveals destructive power; here it shows Victor the creature.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "William is dead" (Chapter VII, paragraph 4). Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. That is plot at work: William's murder (told in a letter), Victor's return to Geneva, the glimpse of the creature in the storm, and Justine's arrest.

> *William is dead (Chapter VII, paragraph 4)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "William is dead" (Chapter VII, paragraph 4). Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. That is plot at work: William's murder (told in a letter), Victor's return to Geneva, the glimpse of the creature in the storm, and Justine's arrest.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: He assumes the killer cannot be human because of how the creature looks, judging by appearance. This connects to guilt and responsibility: he knows the truth and stays silent. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: The first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. (Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.)

> *Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child (Chapter VII, paragraph 29)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: He assumes the killer cannot be human because of how the creature looks, judging by appearance. This connects to guilt and responsibility: he knows the truth and stays silent.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: The first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. (Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for plot, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the first death and growing guilt? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the first death and growing guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. When the text says "Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29), it shows this directly. He decides that "nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child," so he is certain who did it, yet he lets Justine be accused rather than reveal his secret.

Task: Annotate the chapter for plot, setting (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the first death and growing guilt? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the first death and growing guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. When the text says "Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29), it shows this directly. He decides that "nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child," so he is certain who did it, yet he lets Justine be accused rather than reveal his secret.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent? Ask whether Victor's silence is cowardice or a reasonable fear of being thought mad. Require evidence.

Anchor question: Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent?

Facilitation: Ask whether Victor's silence is cowardice or a reasonable fear of being thought mad. Require evidence.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the first death and growing guilt? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. ("Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child", Chapter VII, paragraph 29). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the first death and growing guilt? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. ("Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child", Chapter VII, paragraph 29). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes the first death and growing guilt. Key takeaway: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** William's murder (told in a letter), Victor's return to Geneva, the glimpse of the creature in the storm, and Justine's arrest.
- **Setting:** The thunderstorm over the Alps is sublime and reveals the creature by lightning.
- **Irony:** Victor knows who the murderer is but remains silent while Justine is accused.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation.

Symbols and motifs

- **lightning:** as in Chapter II, lightning reveals destructive power; here it shows Victor the creature.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "William is dead" (Chapter VII, paragraph 4) Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter.
- "Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29) Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature.
- "I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29) Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows.
Evidence: "Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child" (Chapter VII, paragraph 29)
Reasoning: He decides that "nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child," so he is certain who did it, yet he lets Justine be accused rather than reveal his secret.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
cabriolet (noun)	a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse	*But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

prognosticate (verb)	to predict; to be a sign of	*Is this to prognosticate peace, or to mock at my unhappiness?"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
scaling (verb)	climbing	*Who could arrest a creature capable of scaling the overhanging sides of Mont Salêve?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
desolating (adjective)	causing great grief or ruin	*One sudden and desolating change had taken place; but a thousand little circumstances might have by degrees worked other alterations, which, although they were done more tranquilly, might not be the less decisive.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
festering (adjective)	infected and full of pus	*"Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
indelible (adjective)	cannot be removed or erased	*Six years had elapsed, passed as a dream but for one indelible trace, and I stood in the same place where I had last embraced my father before my departure for Ingolstadt.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
carnage (noun)	the savage and excessive killing of many people	*I had turned loose into the world a depraved wretch, whose delight was in carnage and misery; had he not murdered my brother?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
ravings (noun)	declaiming wildly	*I well knew that if any other had communicated such a relation to me, I should have looked upon it as the ravings of insanity.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
credited (verb)	believed	*Besides, the strange nature of the animal would elude all pursuit, even if I were so far credited as to persuade my relatives to commence it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
assassin (noun)	a murderer	*"Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22,

23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who has been murdered? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: William, Victor's youngest brother
2. What weather greets Victor near Geneva? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A violent thunderstorm
3. What does the lightning reveal? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The creature on the mountainside
4. Who is accused of the murder? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Justine Moritz
5. What evidence was found on the accused? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The miniature portrait (locket) William wore
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter VII” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A letter from his father reports that Victor's youngest brother, William, has been murdered. Returning to Geneva during a storm, Victor glimpses the creature near the spot and becomes certain it is the killer. He learns that Justine has been accused because William's locket was found on her.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter VII”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter VII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend.” What does “cabriolet” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: cabriolet: a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse.
10. Reread: “Is this to prognosticate peace, or to mock at my unhappiness?”” What does “prognosticate” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: prognosticate: to predict; to be a sign of.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter VII” suggest about the first death and growing guilt? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about the first death and growing guilt? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4): Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's

creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins ““Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter VII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A letter from his father reports that Victor's youngest brother, William, has been murdered. Returning to Geneva during a storm, Victor glimpses the creature near the spot and becomes certain it is the killer. He learns that Justine has been accused because William's locket was found on her.
6. How does “Chapter VII” build on “Chapter VI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Should Victor tell the authorities what he knows? Why does he stay silent?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4): Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. On irony: Victor knows who the murderer is but remains silent while Justine is accused. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The Alps and storms are classic sublime settings—vast nature that inspires awe and fear. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge

the creature. On setting: The thunderstorm over the Alps is sublime and reveals the creature by lightning. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Victor's silence begins here: he knows the truth but says nothing, making him complicit.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4): Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter VII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the first death and growing guilt? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter VII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes

him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4): Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter VII” treats the first death and growing guilt with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Atmospheric recognition scene; the creature as shadow and double. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter VIII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “William is dead” (Chapter VII, paragraph 4): Blunt, short sentence in the father's letter. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the first death and growing guilt? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “Nothing in human shape could have destroyed that fair child” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Victor concludes guilt from appearance, as others will judge the creature. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's silence after recognizing the creature makes him complicit in the injustice that follows. Useful evidence: “I perceived in the gloom a figure which stole from behind a clump of trees near me” (Chapter VII, paragraph 29): Atmospheric recognition scene; the

creature as shadow and double. Theme link: the first death caused (indirectly) by Victor's creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Who has been murdered?
   A. Alphonse
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Clerval
   D. William, Victor's youngest brother
2. What weather greets Victor near Geneva?
   A. A violent thunderstorm
   B. A heatwave
   C. Fog
   D. A blizzard
3. What does the lightning reveal?
   A. Justine
   B. The creature on the mountainside
   C. A burning house
   D. A ship
4. Who is accused of the murder?
   A. Ernest
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Justine Moritz
   D. Clerval
5. What evidence was found on the accused?
   A. The miniature portrait (locket) William wore
   B. Blood
   C. A knife
   D. A letter
6. In the line “But now, as soon as the horses arrived, I hurried into a cabriolet, and bade farewell to my friend.”, what does “cabriolet” most nearly mean?
   A. to predict; to be a sign of

B. climbing

C. a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse

D. causing great grief or ruin

7. In the line “Is this to prognosticate peace, or to mock at my unhappiness?””, what does “prognosticate” most nearly mean?

A. to predict; to be a sign of

B. causing great grief or ruin

C. climbing

D. a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse

Answer key: 1. D (William, Victor's youngest brother); 2. A (A violent thunderstorm); 3. B (The creature on the mountainside); 4. C (Justine Moritz); 5. A (The miniature portrait (locket) William wore); 6. C (a light two-wheeled carriage pulled by one horse); 7. A (to predict; to be a sign of)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter VII,” how does Shelley show the first death and growing guilt? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter VII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the first death and growing guilt? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter VII develops the idea of the first death and growing guilt. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the first death and growing guilt. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VII suggests about the first death and growing guilt. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter VII to complicate the reader's understanding of the first death and growing guilt. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter VII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the first death and growing guilt responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter VII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the first death and growing guilt follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VII and its treatment of the first death and growing guilt. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VII as evidence for a larger claim about the first death and growing guilt in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the first death and growing guilt. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Who could arrest a creature capable of scaling the overhanging sides of Mont Salêve?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “scaling” most nearly mean?

   A. a murderer

   B. climbing

   C. declaiming wildly

   D. believed

2. *“Come, Victor; not brooding thoughts of vengeance against the assassin, but with feelings of peace and gentleness, that will heal, instead of festering, the wounds of our minds. Enter the house of mourning, my friend, but with kindness and affection for those who love you, and not with hatred for your enemies.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter VII”?

   A. First experiences of the senses

   B. The final reckoning

   C. Obsession and the discovery of life

   D. The first death and growing guilt

SAT key: 1. B (climbing); 2. D (The first death and growing guilt)

Lesson 15: Chapter VIII

Focus: injustice and the burden of silence

Content note (wrongful execution, coerced confession): Justine is pressured into a false confession and executed. Frame it as injustice and discuss how institutions fail the vulnerable.
Student preview: An innocent character is pressured to confess and is executed.
Suggested language: "Why does Justine confess to something she did not do? Who is responsible?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Justine is tried. Though innocent, she confesses under pressure from her confessor, who threatened her with damnation, and is executed. Elizabeth defends her eloquently; Victor suffers privately but does not speak.

Background: Courts of the time could convict on circumstantial evidence; religious confession carried enormous social pressure.

Significance: Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because.... Content note before we start: An innocent character is pressured to confess and is executed.
Prompt: Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order.
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: tarnish — to dull or stain the brightness of; consoles — comforts in a time of sadness; unmingled — pure; not mixed with anything else; playfellow — a companion at play; gnashed — grind together, of teeth.
"consoles": From Latin consolari "to comfort," from com- (intensive) + solari "to comfort."
Words: tarnish: to dull or stain the brightness of · consoles: comforts in a time of sadness · unmingled: pure; not mixed with anything else · playfellow: a companion at play · gnashed: grind together, of teeth

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Courts of the time could convict on circumstantial evidence; religious confession carried enormous social pressure. Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free. Irony: Justine's false confession and execution: the court reaches the wrong verdict by correct procedure. Characterization: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing. Tone / mood: Bitter and self-accusing: Victor calls himself the true murderer. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "that he said I was. He threatened excommunication and hell fire in my last moments, if I continued obdurate. Dear lady, I" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I did confess; but I confessed a lie" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22). Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. That is irony at work: Justine's false confession and execution: the court reaches the wrong verdict by correct procedure.

> *I did confess; but I confessed a lie* *(Chapter VIII, paragraph 22)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I did confess; but I confessed a lie" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22). Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. That is irony at work: Justine's false confession and execution: the court reaches the wrong verdict by correct procedure.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. Look at the craft: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. (Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.)

> *The tortures of the accused did not equal mine* *(Chapter VIII, paragraph 11)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. Look at the craft: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. (Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about injustice and the burden of silence? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of injustice and the burden of silence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. When the text says "The tortures of the accused did not equal mine" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. He claims "the tortures of the accused did not equal mine," even though she is the one executed, so his remorse becomes another form of self-focus rather than action.

Task: Annotate the chapter for irony, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about injustice and the burden of silence? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of injustice and the burden of silence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. When the text says “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11), it shows this directly. He claims "the tortures of the accused did not equal mine," even though she is the one executed, so his remorse becomes another form of self-focus rather than action.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order. Expect strong reactions. Ask: what could Victor have done, and what would it have cost him?

Anchor question: Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order.

Facilitation: Expect strong reactions. Ask: what could Victor have done, and what would it have cost him?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about injustice and the burden of silence? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. (“The tortures of the accused did not equal mine”, Chapter VIII, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about injustice and the burden of silence? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. (“The tortures of the accused did not equal mine”, Chapter VIII, paragraph 11). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how irony shapes injustice and the burden of silence. Key takeaway: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Justine's false confession and execution: the court reaches the wrong verdict by correct procedure.
- **Characterization:** Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing.
- **Tone / mood:** Bitter and self-accusing: Victor calls himself the true murderer.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “that he said I was. He threatened excommunication and hell fire in my last moments, if I continued obdurate. Dear lady, I” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22).
- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: “I believed in her innocence; I knew it. Could the daemon, who had (I did not for a minute doubt) murdered my” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I did confess; but I confessed a lie” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22) Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power.
- “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11) Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness.
- “the never-dying worm alive in my bosom” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29) Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption.
Evidence: “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11)

Reasoning: He claims "the tortures of the accused did not equal mine," even though she is the one executed, so his remorse becomes another form of self-focus rather than action.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
tarnish (verb)	to dull or stain the brightness of	*Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
consoles (verb)	comforts in a time of sadness	*I soon shall see you again in heaven, where we shall all be happy; and that consoles me, going as I am to suffer ignominy and death."*	"consoles": From Latin consolari "to comfort," from com- (intensive) + solari "to comfort." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/console)
unmingled (adjective)	pure; not mixed with anything else	*I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
playfellow (noun)	a companion at play	*You shall not die!—You, my playfellow, my companion, my sister, perish on the scaffold!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
gnashed (verb)	grind together, of teeth	*I gnashed my teeth, and ground them together, uttering a groan that came from my inmost soul.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
heartrending (adjective)	causing or marked by grief or anguish	*Elizabeth's heartrending eloquence failed to move the judges from their settled conviction in the criminality of the saintly sufferer.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
removes (noun)	degree of figurative distance or separation; or	*It removes more than half my misfortune; and I feel as if I could die in peace, now that my innocence is acknowledged by you, dear lady, and your cousin."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
distrusted (verb)	regard as untrustworthy; regard with suspicion; have no faith or confidence in	*"Oh, Justine! forgive me for having for one moment distrusted you.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
			Student look-up (not yet verified)

excommunication (noun)	the state of being excommunicated	*He threatened excommunication and hell fire in my last moments, if I continued obdurate.*	
subscribed (verb)	offer to buy, as of stocks and shares	*In an evil hour I subscribed to a lie; and now only am I truly miserable."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order.
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What happens at Justine's trial? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: She is convicted and condemned
2. Why does Justine confess falsely? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Her confessor threatened her with damnation
3. Who speaks publicly for Justine? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Elizabeth
4. How does Victor respond? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He suffers in silence
5. What theme does the trial highlight? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The failure of justice
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter VIII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Justine is tried. Though innocent, she confesses under pressure from her confessor, who threatened her with damnation, and is executed. Elizabeth defends her eloquently; Victor suffers privately but does not speak.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter VIII"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter VIII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness." What does

"tarnish" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: tarnish: to dull or stain the brightness of.

10. Reread: "I soon shall see you again in heaven, where we shall all be happy; and that consoles me, going as I am to suffer ignominy and death."" What does "consoles" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: consoles: comforts in a time of sadness.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter VIII" suggest about injustice and the burden of silence? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free.
2. Find one example of irony in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about injustice and the burden of silence? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "I did confess; but I confessed a lie" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22): Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. On characterization: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness.", why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in "Chapter VIII", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Justine is tried. Though innocent, she confesses under pressure from her confessor, who threatened her with damnation, and is executed. Elizabeth defends her eloquently; Victor suffers privately but does not speak.
6. How does "Chapter VIII" build on "Chapter VII"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "The tortures of the accused did not equal mine" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "the never-dying worm alive in my bosom" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29): Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment. On characterization: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers

internally and says nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: "Who is responsible for Justine's death? Rank the characters and defend your order." Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "I did confess; but I confessed a lie" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22): Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Courts of the time could convict on circumstantial evidence; religious confession carried enormous social pressure. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "The tortures of the accused did not equal mine" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "Justice fails, showing how society punishes the vulnerable while the guilty (Victor, indirectly) remain free." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "the never-dying worm alive in my bosom" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29): Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: "I did confess; but I confessed a lie" (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22): Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. On characterization: Elizabeth defends Justine eloquently; Justine accepts death with dignity; Victor suffers internally and says nothing. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of "Chapter VIII" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about injustice and the burden of silence? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1,

RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter VIII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “the never-dying worm alive in my bosom” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29): Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “I did confess; but I confessed a lie” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 22): Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the irony in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. On irony: Justine's false confession and execution: the court reaches the wrong verdict by correct procedure. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter VIII” treats injustice and the burden of silence with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “the never-dying worm alive in my bosom” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29): Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter IX” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “I did confess; but I confessed a lie” (Chapter VIII,

paragraph 22): Justine was pressured by her confessor; evidence about injustice and power. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about injustice and the burden of silence? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “The tortures of the accused did not equal mine” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 11): Victor makes Justine's death about his suffering: a striking self-centeredness. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor turns Justine's tragedy into a story about his own pain, which shows his self-absorption. Useful evidence: “the never-dying worm alive in my bosom” (Chapter VIII, paragraph 29): Biblical image of hell (Isaiah, Mark): remorse as eternal torment. Theme link: guilt without action: Victor feels remorse but does not act. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. What happens at Justine's trial?
   A. She is freed
   B. She escapes
   C. She is convicted and condemned
   D. The trial is cancelled
2. Why does Justine confess falsely?
   A. She wanted to protect Victor
   B. She was bribed
   C. She forgot
   D. Her confessor threatened her with damnation
3. Who speaks publicly for Justine?
   A. Victor
   B. Alphonse
   C. Clerval

D. Elizabeth

4. How does Victor respond?
   A. He accuses Ernest
   B. He leaves Geneva
   C. He confesses
   D. He suffers in silence
5. What theme does the trial highlight?
   A. The love of travel
   B. The power of science
   C. The joy of law
   D. The failure of justice
6. In the line "Elizabeth also wept, and was unhappy; but hers also was the misery of innocence, which, like a cloud that passes over the fair moon, for a while hides but cannot tarnish its brightness.", what does "tarnish" most nearly mean?
   A. pure; not mixed with anything else
   B. comforts in a time of sadness
   C. a companion at play
   D. to dull or stain the brightness of
7. In the line "I soon shall see you again in heaven, where we shall all be happy; and that consoles me, going as I am to suffer ignominy and death."", what does "consoles" most nearly mean?
   A. to dull or stain the brightness of
   B. pure; not mixed with anything else
   C. comforts in a time of sadness
   D. a companion at play

Answer key: 1. C (She is convicted and condemned); 2. D (Her confessor threatened her with damnation); 3. D (Elizabeth); 4. D (He suffers in silence); 5. D (The failure of justice); 6. D (to dull or stain the brightness of); 7. C (comforts in a time of sadness)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter VIII," how does Shelley show injustice and the burden of silence? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Chapter VIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of injustice and the burden of silence? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter VIII develops the idea of injustice and the burden of silence. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual

evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter VIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of injustice and the burden of silence. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter VIII suggests about injustice and the burden of silence. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter VIII to complicate the reader's understanding of injustice and the burden of silence. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter VIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of injustice and the burden of silence responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter VIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of injustice and the burden of silence follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter VIII and its treatment of injustice and the burden of silence. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter VIII as evidence for a larger claim about injustice and the burden of silence in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter VIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of injustice and the burden of silence. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness.*

As used in the text, what does the word "unmingled" most nearly mean?

A. offer to buy, as of stocks and shares

B. the state of being excommunicated

C. pure; not mixed with anything else

D. regard as untrustworthy; regard with suspicion; have no faith or confidence in

2. *I passed a night of unmingled wretchedness. In the morning I went to the court; my lips and throat were parched. I dared not ask the fatal question; but I was known, and the officer guessed the cause of my visit. The ballots had been thrown; they were all black, and Justine was condemned.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter VIII"?

A. Horror at the moment of creation

B. Reading and identity

C. Isolation in the north

D. Injustice and the burden of silence

SAT key: 1. C (pure; not mixed with anything else); 2. D (Injustice and the burden of silence)

Lesson 16: Chapter IX

Focus: despair and the sublime

Content note (suicidal thoughts): Victor contemplates ending his life. Use the safe-messaging script; the quiz item is worded as what his despair leads him to contemplate.
Student preview: Victor feels deep despair in this chapter and thinks about ending his life. If this topic is hard for you, you can talk to me or a counselor.
Suggested language: "What pulls Victor back? How does the landscape affect his despair?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Tormented by guilt, Victor considers suicide. His family withdraws to Belrive. Victor journeys into the Alps toward Chamounix, where the majesty of mountains, glaciers and Mont Blanc offers temporary relief.

Background: The Vale of Chamounix and Mont Blanc were Romantic pilgrimage sites; Percy Shelley wrote 'Mont Blanc' (1816).

Significance: The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to the sublime because.... Content note before we start: Victor feels deep despair in this chapter and thinks about ending his life. If this topic is hard for you, you can talk to me or a counselor. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to the sublime because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: nature offers temporary relief from guilt.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: overhangs — sticks out over; hangs over; lulling — calming; making sleepy; glaciers — huge slow-moving masses of ice; perpetrate — perform an act, usually with a negative connotation; avalanche — a slide of large masses of snow and ice and mud down a mountain.
Words: overhangs: sticks out over; hangs over · lulling: calming; making sleepy · glaciers: huge slow-moving masses of ice · perpetrate: perform an act, usually with a negative connotation · avalanche: a slide of large masses of snow and ice and mud down a mountain

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Vale of Chamounix and Mont Blanc were Romantic pilgrimage sites; Percy Shelley wrote 'Mont Blanc' (1816). The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming. Setting: The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him. Tone / mood: Despair; Victor considers suicide in the lake but thinks of his family. Imagery: Glaciers, torrents, "awful and majestic" peaks dwarf human grief. Watch for sublime nature: Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: "at ten o'clock, and the impossibility of remaining on the lake after that hour, had rendered our residence within the walls of" (Chapter IX, paragraph 5).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1). Psychological insight into grief and guilt. That is setting at work: The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him.

> *Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows* *(Chapter IX, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1). Psychological insight into grief and guilt. That is setting at work: The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Elizabeth reads "despair" and "revenge" in his face: the secret he keeps is visible to those who love him. Link: guilt isolates him even at home, and the trip to Chamounix is an attempt to escape it. Ask: How does this line connect to the sublime? Expected: Nature offers temporary relief from guilt. (Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.)

> *There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble*
> *(Chapter IX, paragraph 9)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Elizabeth reads "despair" and "revenge" in his face: the secret he keeps is visible to those who love him. Link: guilt isolates him even at home, and the trip to Chamounix is an attempt to escape it.
Ask: How does this line connect to the sublime?
Expected answer: Nature offers temporary relief from guilt. (Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for setting, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about despair and the sublime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of despair and the sublime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. When the text says “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He describes "the dead calmness of inaction and certainty" as the most painful state of mind, and his remorse becomes "a hell of intense tortures"; suffering replaces confession, so guilt leads nowhere.
Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, tone / mood (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about despair and the sublime? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of despair and the sublime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. When the text says “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He describes "the dead calmness of inaction and certainty" as the most painful state of mind, and his remorse becomes "a hell of intense tortures"; suffering replaces confession, so guilt leads nowhere.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings? Connect to Romanticism: what did these writers believe nature could do for people? Does the novel agree?
Anchor question: How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings?
Facilitation: Connect to Romanticism: what did these writers believe nature could do for people? Does the novel agree?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about despair and the sublime? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. ("Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certa", Chapter IX, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about despair and the sublime? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. ("Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certa", Chapter IX, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how setting shapes despair and the sublime. Key takeaway: nature offers temporary relief from guilt.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him.
- **Tone / mood:** Despair; Victor considers suicide in the lake but thinks of his family.
- **Imagery:** Glaciers, torrents, "awful and majestic" peaks dwarf human grief.

Themes and how they develop

- **the sublime:** nature offers temporary relief from guilt.

Symbols and motifs

- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: "at ten o'clock, and the impossibility of remaining on the lake after that hour, had rendered our residence within the walls of" (Chapter IX, paragraph 5).

- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: "leave them exposed and unprotected to the malice of the fiend whom I had let loose among them" (Chapter IX, paragraph 5).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1) Psychological insight into grief and guilt.
- "There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble" (Chapter IX, paragraph 9) Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face.
- "I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1) Guilt imagined as hell.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act.
Evidence: "Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1)
Reasoning: He describes "the dead calmness of inaction and certainty" as the most painful state of mind, and his remorse becomes "a hell of intense tortures"; suffering replaces confession, so guilt leads nowhere.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
overhangs (verb)	sticks out over; hangs over	*I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
lulling (adjective)	calming; making sleepy	*The same lulling sounds acted as a lullaby to my too keen sensations: when I placed my head upon my pillow, sleep crept over me; I felt it as it came, and blessed the giver of oblivion.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
glaciers (noun)	huge slow-moving masses of ice	*Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
perpetrate (verb)	perform an act, usually with a negative connotation	*I had been the author of unalterable evils; and I lived in daily fear, lest the monster whom I had created should perpetrate some new wickedness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
	a slide of large masses of snow	*Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

avalanche (noun)	and ice and mud down a mountain	*falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*	
ephemeral (noun)	anything short-lived, as an insect that lives only for a day in its winged form	*It was during an access of this kind that I suddenly left my home, and bending my steps towards the near Alpine valleys, sought in the magnificence, the eternity of such scenes, to forget myself and my ephemeral, because human, sorrows.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
revisit (verb)	visit again	*At these moments I wept bitterly, and wished that peace would revisit my mind only that I might afford them consolation and happiness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
thirsted (verb)	longed for something strongly	*I had begun life with benevolent intentions, and thirsted for the moment when I should put them in practice, and make myself useful to my fellow-beings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
assassinated (verb)	murder; especially of socially prominent persons	*William and Justine were assassinated, and the murderer escapes; he walks about the world free, and perhaps respected.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
desponding (adjective)	losing hope; discouraged	*Elizabeth was sad and desponding; she no longer took delight in her ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed to her sacrilege toward the dead; eternal woe and tears she then thought was the just tribute she should pay to innocence so blasted and destroyed.*	“desponding”: From Latin despondere "to give up, lose heart," from de- "away" + spondere "to promise." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/despond)

Discussion questions

1. How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Victor's despair lead him to contemplate? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Ending his own life
2. Where does Victor travel for relief? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The Alps near Chamounix
3. Which mountain dominates the scenery? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Mont Blanc
4. What literary idea describes the overwhelming landscape? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The sublime
5. What effect does nature have on Victor? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It soothes him for a time
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter IX" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Tormented by guilt, Victor considers suicide. His family withdraws to Belrive. Victor journeys into the Alps toward Chamounix, where the majesty of mountains, glaciers and Mont Blanc offers temporary relief.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter IX"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter IX" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it." What does "overhangs" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: overhangs: sticks out over; hangs over.
10. Reread: "The same lulling sounds acted as a lullaby to my too keen sensations: when I placed my head upon my pillow, sleep crept over me; I felt it as it came, and blessed the giver of oblivion." What does "lulling" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: lulling: calming; making sleepy.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter IX" suggest about despair and the sublime? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming.
2. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
3. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about despair and the sublime? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty

which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Psychological insight into grief and guilt. On imagery: Glaciers, torrents, "awful and majestic" peaks dwarf human grief. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins "Our house was the house of mourning.", why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in "Chapter IX", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Tormented by guilt, Victor considers suicide. His family withdraws to Belrive. Victor journeys into the Alps toward Chamounix, where the majesty of mountains, glaciers and Mont Blanc offers temporary relief.
6. How does "Chapter IX" build on "Chapter VIII"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble" (Chapter IX, paragraph 9): Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Guilt imagined as hell. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: "How does the mountain landscape reflect Victor's feelings?" Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Psychological insight into grief and guilt. On tone / mood: Despair; Victor considers suicide in the lake but thinks of his family. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The Vale of Chamounix and Mont Blanc were Romantic pilgrimage sites; Percy Shelley wrote 'Mont Blanc' (1816). How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble" (Chapter IX, paragraph 9): Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his

guilt shows on his face. On setting: The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The sublime landscape mirrors Victor's mind: grand, cold and overwhelming.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Guilt imagined as hell. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Psychological insight into grief and guilt. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter IX” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about despair and the sublime? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble” (Chapter IX, paragraph 9): Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter IX”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures” (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Guilt imagined as hell. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: “Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the

feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Psychological insight into grief and guilt. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble" (Chapter IX, paragraph 9): Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face. On setting: The valley of Chamounix and Mont Blanc: the sublime landscape calms but cannot cure him. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how "Chapter IX" treats despair and the sublime with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me away to a hell of intense tortures" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Guilt imagined as hell. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what "Chapter X" will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "Nothing is more painful to the human mind, than, after the feelings have been worked up by a quick succession of events, the dead calmness of inaction and certainty which follows" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Psychological insight into grief and guilt. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about despair and the sublime? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "There is an expression of despair, and sometimes of revenge, in your countenance, that makes me tremble" (Chapter IX, paragraph 9): Elizabeth sees what Victor hides; his guilt shows on his face. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: After the executions, Victor's guilt paralyzes him rather than moving him to act. Useful evidence: "I was seized by remorse and the sense of guilt, which hurried me

away to a hell of intense tortures" (Chapter IX, paragraph 1): Guilt imagined as hell. Theme link: nature offers temporary relief from guilt. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. What does Victor's despair lead him to contemplate?
   A. Ending his own life
   B. Becoming a monk
   C. Marrying at once
   D. Moving to England
2. Where does Victor travel for relief?
   A. The Alps near Chamounix
   B. The coast of Italy
   C. Ingolstadt
   D. London
3. Which mountain dominates the scenery?
   A. Ben Nevis
   B. Vesuvius
   C. Mont Blanc
   D. Everest
4. What literary idea describes the overwhelming landscape?
   A. Allegory
   B. The sublime
   C. Pastoral comedy
   D. Satire
5. What effect does nature have on Victor?
   A. It makes him ill
   B. It bores him
   C. It soothes him for a time
   D. It angers him
6. In the line "I passed the bridge of Pélissier, where the ravine, which the river forms, opened before me, and I began to ascend the mountain that overhangs it.", what does "overhangs" most nearly mean?
   A. huge slow-moving masses of ice

B. perform an act, usually with a negative connotation

C. sticks out over; hangs over

D. calming; making sleepy

7. In the line “The same lulling sounds acted as a lullaby to my too keen sensations: when I placed my head upon my pillow, sleep crept over me; I felt it as it came, and blessed the giver of oblivion.”, what does “lulling” most nearly mean?

A. sticks out over; hangs over

B. huge slow-moving masses of ice

C. perform an act, usually with a negative connotation

D. calming; making sleepy

Answer key: 1. A (Ending his own life); 2. A (The Alps near Chamounix); 3. C (Mont Blanc); 4. B (The sublime); 5. C (It soothes him for a time); 6. C (sticks out over; hangs over); 7. D (calming; making sleepy)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter IX,” how does Shelley show despair and the sublime? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter IX, how does Shelley develop the idea of despair and the sublime? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter IX develops the idea of despair and the sublime. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter IX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of despair and the sublime. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter IX suggests about despair and the sublime. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter IX to complicate the reader's understanding of despair and the sublime. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter IX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of despair and the sublime responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter IX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of despair and the sublime follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter IX and its treatment of despair and the sublime. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter IX as evidence for a larger claim about despair and the sublime in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter IX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of despair and the sublime. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Immense glaciers approached the road; I heard the rumbling thunder of the falling avalanche, and marked the smoke of its passage.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “glaciers” most nearly mean?

   A. losing hope; discouraged

   B. huge slow-moving masses of ice

   C. longed for something strongly

   D. murder; especially of socially prominent persons

2. *Our house was the house of mourning. My father’s health was deeply shaken by the horror of the recent events. Elizabeth was sad and desponding; she no longer took delight in her ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed to her sacrilege toward the dead; eternal woe and tears she then thought was the just tribute she should pay to innocence so blasted and destroyed. She was no longer that happy creature, who in earlier youth wandered with me on the banks of the lake, and talked with ecstasy of our future prospects. The first of those sorrows which are sent to wean us from the earth, had visited her, and its dimming influence quenched her dearest smiles.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter IX”?

   A. A privileged childhood and family love

B. The demand for a companion

C. Rejection and the turn to revenge

D. Despair and the sublime

SAT key: 1. B (huge slow-moving masses of ice); 2. D (Despair and the sublime)

Lesson 17: Chapter X

Focus: confrontation between creator and creation

Teacher only · spoilers

On the glacier Montanvert, the creature approaches. Victor curses it; the creature answers eloquently, reminding Victor of his duties: 'I ought to be thy Adam, but I am rather the fallen angel.' He asks Victor to hear his story, and Victor follows him to a hut.

Background: Milton's Paradise Lost shapes the creature's self-understanding—God and Adam, Satan the outcast.

Significance: The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and nurture because....
Prompt: The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to nature and nurture because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: pollutes — spoils; makes impure; commiserate — to feel or show pity for; inspiriting — encouraging; filling with spirit; diabolically — as a devil; in an evil manner; overlooks — a high place affording a good view.
Words: pollutes: spoils; makes impure · commiserate: to feel or show pity for · inspiriting: encouraging; filling with spirit · diabolically: as a devil; in an evil manner · overlooks: a high place affording a good view

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Milton's Paradise Lost shapes the creature's self-understanding—God and Adam, Satan the outcast. The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies. Structure: The creature speaks: the novel's center. Victor's narrative gives way to the creature's for six chapters. Allusion: "I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel": Paradise Lost frames the creature as both Adam and Satan. Characterization: The creature is eloquent, reasoned and grieving, the opposite of what Victor and the reader expect. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “and allowed it to soar from the obscure world to light and joy. The sight of the awful and majestic in nature” (Chapter X, paragraph 2).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous" (Chapter X, paragraph 12). The nurture argument in one line. That is structure at work: The creature speaks: the novel's center. Victor's narrative gives way to the creature's for six chapters.

> *I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous (Chapter X, paragraph 12)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous" (Chapter X, paragraph 12). The nurture argument in one line. That is structure at work: The creature speaks: the novel's center. Victor's narrative gives way to the creature's for six chapters.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Adam was cherished by his creator; the fallen angel was cast out. The creature says he should be like Adam but is treated like Satan. This connects to responsibility and to nature versus nurture. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture? Expected: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. (Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.)

> *I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel (Chapter X, paragraph 12)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Adam was cherished by his creator; the fallen angel was cast out. The creature says he should be like Adam but is treated like Satan. This connects to responsibility and to nature versus nurture.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture?
Expected answer: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. (Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for structure, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about confrontation between creator and creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter X develops the idea of confrontation between creator and creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. When the text says “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12), it shows this directly. He says, "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend," placing the cause of his violence in his treatment, and asks Victor to "make me happy" so that he may be "virtuous" again.

Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about confrontation between creator and creation? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter X develops the idea of confrontation between creator and creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. When the text says “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12), it shows this directly. He says, "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend," placing the cause of his violence in his treatment, and asks Victor to "make me happy" so that he may be "virtuous" again.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him? Hold a quick four-corners: do you believe the creature's claim? Students must cite a line.

Anchor question: The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him?

Facilitation: Hold a quick four-corners: do you believe the creature's claim? Students must cite a line.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about confrontation between creator and creation? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. ("I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous", Chapter X, paragraph 12). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about confrontation between creator and creation? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. ("I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous", Chapter X, paragraph 12). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes confrontation between creator and creation. Key takeaway: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** The creature speaks: the novel's center. Victor's narrative gives way to the creature's for six chapters.
- **Allusion:** "I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel": Paradise Lost frames the creature as both Adam and Satan.
- **Characterization:** The creature is eloquent, reasoned and grieving, the opposite of what Victor and the reader expect.

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and nurture:** "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "and allowed it to soar from the obscure world to light and joy. The sight of the awful and majestic in nature" (Chapter X, paragraph 2).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: "sources of the Arveiron, which take

their rise in a glacier, that with slow pace is advancing down from the summit of" (Chapter X, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel" (Chapter X, paragraph 12) Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed.
- "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous" (Chapter X, paragraph 12) The nurture argument in one line.
- "Remember, that I am thy creature" (Chapter X, paragraph 12) Claims a relationship and a duty.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case.
Evidence: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous" (Chapter X, paragraph 12)
Reasoning: He says, "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend," placing the cause of his violence in his treatment, and asks Victor to "make me happy" so that he may be "virtuous" again.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
pollutes (verb)	spoils; makes impure	*We rise; one wand'ring thought pollutes the day.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
commiserate (verb)	to feel or show pity for	*Listen to my tale: when you have heard that, abandon or commiserate me, as you shall judge that I deserve.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inspiriting (adjective)	encouraging; filling with spirit	*All of soul-inspiriting fled with sleep, and dark melancholy clouded every thought.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
diabolically (adverb)	as a devil; in an evil manner	*Begone, vile insect! or rather, stay, that I may trample you to dust! and, oh! that I could, with the extinction of your miserable existence, restore those victims whom you have so diabolically murdered!"*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
overlooks (noun)	a high place affording a good view	*For some time I sat upon the rock that overlooks the sea of ice.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
implores (verb)	call upon in supplication; entreat	*Will no entreaties cause thee to turn a favourable eye upon thy creature, who implores thy goodness and compassion?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
illuminate (verb)	make lighter or brighter		

		The sun is yet high in the heavens; before it descends to hide itself behind yon snowy precipices, and illuminate another world, you will have heard my story, and can decide.	Student look-up (not yet verified)
barricade (verb)	to block off	*I stood beside the sources of the Arveiron, which take their rise in a glacier, that with slow pace is advancing down from the summit of the hills, to barricade the valley.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
interspersed (verb)	place at intervals in or among	*The surface is very uneven, rising like the waves of a troubled sea, descending low, and interspersed by rifts that sink deep.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
surmount (verb)	get on top of; deal with successfully	*The ascent is precipitous, but the path is cut into continual and short windings, which enable you to surmount the perpendicularity of the mountain.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him?
2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does Victor meet the creature? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: On the glacier at Montanvert
2. How does the creature speak? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Eloquently and persuasively
3. Which work does the creature allude to? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Paradise Lost
4. What does the creature ask of Victor? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To listen to his story
5. What is ironic about the creature's speech? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The 'monster' is more reasonable than his creator
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter X” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: On the glacier Montanvert, the creature approaches. Victor curses it; the creature answers eloquently, reminding Victor of his duties: 'I ought to be thy Adam, but I am rather the fallen angel.' He asks Victor to hear his story, and Victor follows him to a hut.

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter X”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter X” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “We rise; one wand’ring thought pollutes the day.” What does “pollutes” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: pollutes: spoils; makes impure.
10. Reread: “Listen to my tale: when you have heard that, abandon or commiserate me, as you shall judge that I deserve.” What does “commiserate” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: commiserate: to feel or show pity for.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter X” suggest about confrontation between creator and creation? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies.
2. Find one example of allusion in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.9] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about confrontation between creator and creation? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed. On characterization: The creature is eloquent, reasoned and grieving, the opposite of what Victor and the reader expect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “We rest; a dream has power to poison sleep.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter X”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: On the glacier Montanvert, the creature approaches. Victor curses it; the creature answers eloquently, reminding Victor of his duties: 'I ought to be thy Adam, but I am rather the fallen angel.' He asks Victor to hear his story, and Victor follows him to a hut.
6. How does “Chapter X” build on “Chapter IX”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): The nurture argument in one line. On structure: The creature speaks: the novel's center. Victor's narrative gives way to the creature's for six chapters. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Claims a relationship and a duty. On characterization: The creature is eloquent, reasoned and grieving, the opposite of what Victor and the reader expect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “The creature says, 'I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend.' Do you believe him?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Milton's Paradise Lost shapes the creature's self-understanding—God and Adam, Satan the outcast. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): The nurture argument in one line. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The creature's eloquence overturns expectations of a mindless monster and shifts our sympathies.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Claims a relationship and a duty. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and

evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed. On characterization: The creature is eloquent, reasoned and grieving, the opposite of what Victor and the reader expect. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter X” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about confrontation between creator and creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): The nurture argument in one line. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter X”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Claims a relationship and a duty. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the allusion in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.9] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): The nurture argument in one line. On allusion: "I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel": Paradise Lost frames the creature as both Adam and Satan. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter X” treats confrontation between creator and creation with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Claims a relationship and a duty. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Predict what “Chapter XI” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I ought to be thy Adam; but I am rather the fallen angel” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Milton allusion; the creature casts Victor as a God who failed. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about confrontation between creator and creation? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend. Make me happy, and I shall again be virtuous” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): The nurture argument in one line. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature argues that his evil was made, not born, and the novel gives him the eloquence to make the case. Useful evidence: “Remember, that I am thy creature” (Chapter X, paragraph 12): Claims a relationship and a duty. Theme link: "I was benevolent and good; misery made me a fiend": the novel's clearest statement of the argument. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Where does Victor meet the creature?
   A. In Geneva
   B. In a church
   C. On the glacier at Montanvert
   D. On Walton's ship
2. How does the creature speak?
   A. Not at all
   B. In grunts
   C. Only in German
   D. Eloquently and persuasively
3. Which work does the creature allude to?
   A. Robinson Crusoe
   B. The Odyssey
   C. Paradise Lost
   D. Hamlet
4. What does the creature ask of Victor?
   A. To listen to his story
   B. To give him money
   C. To leave Europe
   D. To fight him
5. What is ironic about the creature's speech?
   A. He is silent
   B. He agrees with Victor
   C. He is afraid of ice
   D. The 'monster' is more reasonable than his creator
6. In the line “We rise; one wand’ring thought pollutes the day.”, what does “pollutes” most nearly mean?
   A. to feel or show pity for
   B. encouraging; filling with spirit
   C. as a devil; in an evil manner
   D. spoils; makes impure
7. In the line “Listen to my tale: when you have heard that, abandon or commiserate me, as you shall judge that I deserve.”, what does “commiserate” most nearly mean?
   A. encouraging; filling with spirit
   B. as a devil; in an evil manner
   C. spoils; makes impure
   D. to feel or show pity for

Answer key: 1. C (On the glacier at Montanvert); 2. D (Eloquently and persuasively); 3. C (Paradise Lost); 4. A (To listen to his story); 5. D (The 'monster' is more reasonable than his creator); 6. D (spoils; makes impure); 7. D (to feel or show pity for)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter X,” how does Shelley show confrontation between creator and creation? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): In Chapter X, how does Shelley develop the idea of confrontation between creator and creation? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter X develops the idea of confrontation between creator and creation. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter X (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of confrontation between creator and creation. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter X suggests about confrontation between creator and creation. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter X to complicate the reader's understanding of confrontation between creator and creation. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter X within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of confrontation between creator and creation responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter X alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of confrontation between creator and creation follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter X and its treatment of confrontation between creator and creation. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter X as evidence for a larger claim about confrontation between creator and creation in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter X as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of confrontation between creator and creation. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *All of soul-inspiriting fled with sleep, and dark melancholy clouded every thought.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “inspiriting” most nearly mean?

   A. encouraging; filling with spirit

   B. to block off

   C. get on top of; deal with successfully

   D. place at intervals in or among

2. *We rest; a dream has power to poison sleep. We rise; one wand’ring thought pollutes the day. We feel, conceive, or reason; laugh or weep, Embrace fond woe, or cast our cares away; It is the same: for, be it joy or sorrow, The path of its departure still is free. Man’s yesterday may ne’er be like his morrow; Nought may endure but mutability!*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter X”?

   A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   B. Horror at the moment of creation

   C. Confrontation between creator and creation

   D. Obsession and the discovery of life

SAT key: 1. A (encouraging; filling with spirit); 2. C (Confrontation between creator and creation)

Lesson 18: Chapter XI

Focus: first experiences of the senses

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature narrates his first days: confusion of senses, cold, hunger, the discovery of fire, and the joy of moonlight and birdsong. Villagers attack him, and he shelters in a hovel beside a cottage.

Background: Philosophers like Locke argued that the mind begins as a 'blank slate' shaped by experience.

Significance: The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and nurture because....
Prompt: What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to nature and nurture because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: debilitated — weakened; canopied — covered overhead like a canopy; incommoded — troubled; inconvenienced; purloined — make off with belongings of others; blackbird — any bird of the family Icteridae whose male is black or predominantly black.
Words: debilitated: weakened · canopied: covered overhead like a canopy · incommoded: troubled; inconvenienced · purloined: make off with belongings of others · blackbird: any bird of the family Icteridae whose male is black or predominantly black

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Philosophers like Locke argued that the mind begins as a 'blank slate' shaped by experience. The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate. Point of view: The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold. Imagery: Sensory discovery (the moon, birdsong, fire) told with the wonder of a newborn. Irony: Fire both warms and burns; "how strange... that the same cause should produce such opposite effects!" foreshadows his own nature. Watch for fire: the Promethean gift: warmth and pain together.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being" (Chapter XI, paragraph 1). A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. That is point of view at work: The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold.

> *It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being* (Chapter XI, paragraph 1)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being" (Chapter XI, paragraph 1). A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. That is point of view at work: The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Fire warms and burns: the "same cause" with "opposite effects." It symbolizes knowledge and creation, which can help or hurt. It links to the creature's own double nature. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture? Expected: He begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. (Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.)

> *How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects* (Chapter XI, paragraph 6)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Fire warms and burns: the "same cause" with "opposite effects." It symbolizes knowledge and creation, which can help or hurt. It links to the creature's own double nature.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture?
Expected answer: He begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. (Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for point of view, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about first experiences of the senses? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XI develops the idea of first experiences of the senses. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. When the text says "It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being" (Chapter XI, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He remembers "considerable difficulty" in understanding his first sensations, a newborn's helplessness, and the villagers' response to his approach is that "some fled, some attacked me," so hostility comes from them.
Task: Annotate the chapter for point of view, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about first experiences of the senses? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XI develops the idea of first experiences of the senses. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. When the text says "It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being" (Chapter XI, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He remembers "considerable difficulty" in understanding his first sensations, a newborn's helplessness, and the villagers' response to his approach is that "some fled, some attacked me," so hostility comes from them.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful? Ask students to compare the creature's first days with Victor's childhood in Chapter I.
Anchor question: What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful?
Facilitation: Ask students to compare the creature's first days with Victor's childhood in Chapter I.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about first experiences of the senses? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. ("It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being", Chapter XI, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about first experiences of the senses? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. ("It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being", Chapter XI, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how point of view shapes first experiences of the senses. Key takeaway: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Point of view:** The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold.
- **Imagery:** Sensory discovery (the moon, birdsong, fire) told with the wonder of a newborn.
- **Irony:** Fire both warms and burns; "how strange... that the same cause should produce such opposite effects!" foreshadows his own nature.

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and nurture:** he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight.

Symbols and motifs

- **fire:** the Promethean gift: warmth and pain together.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1) A newborn's memory; invites sympathy.
- “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6) Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature.
- “some fled, some attacked me” (Chapter XI, paragraph 10) Human violence comes first.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any.
Evidence: “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1)
Reasoning: He remembers "considerable difficulty" in understanding his first sensations, a newborn's helplessness, and the villagers' response to his approach is that "some fled, some attacked me," so hostility comes from them.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
debilitated (adjective)	weakened	*He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

canopied (verb)	covered overhead like a canopy	*I began also to observe, with greater accuracy, the forms that surrounded me, and to perceive the boundaries of the radiant roof of light which canopied me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
incommoded (verb)	troubled; inconvenienced	*As she walked along, seemingly incommoded by the burden, a young man met her, whose countenance expressed a deeper despondence.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
purloined (verb)	make off with belongings of others	*I had first, however, provided for my sustenance for that day, by a loaf of coarse bread, which I purloined, and a cup with which I could drink, more conveniently than from my hand, of the pure water which flowed by my retreat.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
blackbird (noun)	any bird of the family Icteridae whose male is black or predominantly black	*I found that the sparrow uttered none but harsh notes, whilst those of the blackbird and thrush were sweet and enticing.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wearying (verb)	exhaust or get tired through overuse or great strain or stress	*The light became more and more oppressive to me; and, the heat wearying me as I walked, I sought a place where I could receive shade.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enticed (verb)	tempted; attracted	*The silver hair and benevolent countenance of the aged cottager won my reverence, while the gentle manners of the girl enticed my love.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
carpeted (verb)	covered as if with a carpet	*"Having thus arranged my dwelling, and carpeted it with clean straw, I retired; for I saw the figure of a man at a distance, and I remembered too well my treatment the night before, to trust myself in his power.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
intercepted (verb)	seize on its way	*I was delighted when I first discovered that a pleasant sound, which often saluted my ears, proceeded from the throats of the little winged animals who had often intercepted the light from my eyes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
assuage (verb)	cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of	*"Food, however, became scarce; and I often spent the whole day searching in vain for a few acorns to assuage the pangs of hunger.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23,

24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who narrates this chapter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The creature
2. What does the creature discover that both warms and burns? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Fire
3. How do villagers react to him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: They attack him
4. Where does he take shelter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A hovel attached to a cottage
5. What pleases him in nature? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Moonlight and birdsong
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The creature narrates his first days: confusion of senses, cold, hunger, the discovery of fire, and the joy of moonlight and birdsong. Villagers attack him, and he shelters in a hovel beside a cottage.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XI"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable." What does "debilitated" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: debilitated: weakened.
10. Reread: "I began also to observe, with greater accuracy, the forms that surrounded me, and to perceive the boundaries of the radiant roof of light which canopied me." What does "canopied" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: canopied: covered overhead like a canopy.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XI" suggest about first experiences of the senses? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate.
2. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the imagery in this chapter shape what we understand about first experiences of the senses? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1): A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. On imagery: Sensory discovery (the moon, birdsong, fire) told with the wonder of a newborn. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins ““The moon had disappeared from the night, and again, with a lessened form, showed itself, while I still remained in the forest.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: The creature narrates his first days: confusion of senses, cold, hunger, the discovery of fire, and the joy of moonlight and birdsong. Villagers attack him, and he shelters in a hovel beside a cottage.
6. How does “Chapter XI” build on “Chapter X”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6): Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “some fled, some attacked me” (Chapter XI, paragraph 10): Human violence comes first. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “What does the creature learn from fire—both good and painful?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1): A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Philosophers like Locke argued that the mind begins as a 'blank slate' shaped by experience. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such

opposite effects" (Chapter XI, paragraph 6): Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "The creature's innocence makes society's violence toward him shocking and central to the nature-nurture debate." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: "some fled, some attacked me" (Chapter XI, paragraph 10): Human violence comes first. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: "It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being" (Chapter XI, paragraph 1): A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of "Chapter XI" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about first experiences of the senses? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: "How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects" (Chapter XI, paragraph 6): Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature. On point of view: The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about "Chapter XI": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: "some fled, some attacked me" (Chapter XI, paragraph 10): Human violence comes first. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: "It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being" (Chapter XI, paragraph 1): A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. Theme link: he begins

innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6): Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature. On point of view: The creature narrates his first days: confused senses, light and dark, hunger and cold. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XI” treats first experiences of the senses with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “some fled, some attacked me” (Chapter XI, paragraph 10): Human violence comes first. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “It is with considerable difficulty that I remember the original era of my being” (Chapter XI, paragraph 1): A newborn's memory; invites sympathy. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about first experiences of the senses? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “How strange, I thought, that the same cause should produce such opposite effects” (Chapter XI, paragraph 6): Fire's double nature; symbol for knowledge and for the creature. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature begins as an innocent who meets violence before he commits any. Useful evidence: “some fled, some attacked me” (Chapter XI, paragraph 10): Human violence comes first. Theme link: he begins innocent; humans attack him on sight. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Imagery**: sensory details (sight, sound, cold, light) and what mood they create
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Who narrates this chapter?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. Walton
   C. The creature
   D. Victor
2. What does the creature discover that both warms and burns?
   A. Fire
   B. Iron
   C. Water
   D. Snow
3. How do villagers react to him?
   A. They ignore him
   B. They welcome him
   C. They worship him
   D. They attack him
4. Where does he take shelter?
   A. A cave in the Alps
   B. A hovel attached to a cottage
   C. A castle
   D. A church
5. What pleases him in nature?
   A. Moonlight and birdsong
   B. Machines
   C. Thunder
   D. Crowded towns
6. In the line "He turned on hearing a noise; and, perceiving me, shrieked loudly, and, quitting the hut, ran across the fields with a speed of which his debilitated form hardly appeared capable.", what does "debilitated" most nearly mean?
   A. troubled; inconvenienced
   B. make off with belongings of others
   C. weakened
   D. covered overhead like a canopy

7. In the line “I began also to observe, with greater accuracy, the forms that surrounded me, and to perceive the boundaries of the radiant roof of light which canopied me.”, what does “canopied” most nearly mean?
   A. troubled; inconvenienced
   B. weakened
   C. covered overhead like a canopy
   D. make off with belongings of others

Answer key: 1. C (The creature); 2. A (Fire); 3. D (They attack him); 4. B (A hovel attached to a cottage); 5. A (Moonlight and birdsong); 6. C (weakened); 7. C (covered overhead like a canopy)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XI,” how does Shelley show first experiences of the senses? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XI, how does Shelley develop the idea of first experiences of the senses? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XI develops the idea of first experiences of the senses. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and imagery shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of first experiences of the senses. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XI suggests about first experiences of the senses. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and imagery), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Chapter XI to complicate the reader's understanding of first experiences of the senses. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of first experiences of the senses responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of first experiences of the senses follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XI and its treatment of first experiences of the senses. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and imagery, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XI as evidence for a larger claim about first experiences of the senses in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of first experiences of the senses. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *As she walked along, seemingly incommoded by the burden, a young man met her, whose countenance expressed a deeper despondence.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “incommoded” most nearly mean?

   A. covered as if with a carpet

   B. seize on its way

   C. troubled; inconvenienced

   D. cause to be more favorably inclined; gain the good will of

2. *“The moon had disappeared from the night, and again, with a lessened form, showed itself, while I still remained in the forest. My sensations had, by this time, become distinct, and my mind received every day additional ideas. My eyes became accustomed to the light, and to perceive objects in their right forms; I distinguished the insect from the herb, and, by degrees, one herb from another. I found that the sparrow uttered none but harsh notes, whilst those of the blackbird and thrush were sweet and enticing.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XI”?

   A. Delay and dread

   B. The first spark of obsession

   C. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. C (troubled; inconvenienced); 2. D (First experiences of the senses)

Lesson 19: Chapter XII

Focus: learning compassion by watching

Teacher only · spoilers

Hidden, the creature observes the De Lacey family: the blind old father, Felix and Agatha. Seeing their poverty, he stops stealing their food and secretly gathers firewood for them. He begins to understand speech. Catching sight of his reflection in a pool, he is horrified at his own appearance.

Background: The cottage represents the domestic ideal praised in the Preface.

Significance: The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and nurture because....
Prompt: What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to nature and nurture because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: he learns virtue by watching virtue.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: exhilarated — filled with energy and excitement; arbiters — people with the power to decide; execration — cursing; expressions of hatred; endeared — made loved or liked; enhanced — increase.
Words: exhilarated: filled with energy and excitement · arbiters: people with the power to decide · execration: cursing; expressions of hatred · endeared: made loved or liked · enhanced: increase

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The cottage represents the domestic ideal praised in the Preface. The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him. Characterization: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them. Point of view: He observes without being seen, like a reader; we learn about human kindness through his eyes. Imagery: His reflection in the pool: the first time he sees himself as others do. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “The cottagers arose the next morning before the sun. The young woman arranged the cottage, and prepared the food; and” (Chapter XII, paragraph 2).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool" (Chapter XII, paragraph 13). Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. That is characterization at work: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them.

> *how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool* (Chapter XII, paragraph 13)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool" (Chapter XII, paragraph 13). Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. That is characterization at work: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: He stops stealing because it hurts them: empathy and self-control. This connects to nature versus nurture: watching good people teaches him goodness. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture? Expected: He learns virtue by watching virtue. (Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.)

> *when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained* (Chapter XII, paragraph 6)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: He stops stealing because it hurts them: empathy and self-control. This connects to nature versus nurture: watching good people teaches him goodness.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture?
Expected answer: He learns virtue by watching virtue. (Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for characterization, point of view (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about learning compassion by watching? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XII develops the idea of learning compassion by watching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. When the text says "when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained" (Chapter XII, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. When he realizes that stealing "inflicted pain on the cottagers," he "abstained," choosing others' welfare over his own hunger without being taught.
Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, point of view (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about learning compassion by watching? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XII develops the idea of learning compassion by watching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. When the text says "when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained" (Chapter XII, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. When he realizes that stealing "inflicted pain on the cottagers," he "abstained," choosing others' welfare over his own hunger without being taught.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature? Ask: why does Shelley make the creature learn language from a family rather than a book?
Anchor question: What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature?
Facilitation: Ask: why does Shelley make the creature learn language from a family rather than a book?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about learning compassion by watching? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. ("when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained", Chapter XII, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about learning compassion by watching? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. ("when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained", Chapter XII, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes learning compassion by watching. Key takeaway: he learns virtue by watching virtue.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them.
- **Point of view:** He observes without being seen, like a reader; we learn about human kindness through his eyes.
- **Imagery:** His reflection in the pool: the first time he sees himself as others do.

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and nurture:** he learns virtue by watching virtue.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “The cottagers arose the next morning before the sun. The young woman arranged the cottage, and prepared the food; and” (Chapter XII, paragraph 2).
- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: “I became fully convinced that I was in reality the monster that I am, I was filled with the bitterest sensations of” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6) Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness.
- “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13) Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty.
- “fire,’ ‘milk,’ ‘bread,’ and ‘wood” (Chapter XII, paragraph 9) The first words he learns: basic needs and the home.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for.
Evidence: “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6)

Reasoning: When he realizes that stealing "inflicted pain on the cottagers," he "abstained," choosing others' welfare over his own hunger without being taught.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
exhilarated (verb)	filled with energy and excitement	*"These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
arbiters (noun)	people with the power to decide	*I looked upon them as superior beings, who would be the arbiters of my future destiny.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
execration (noun)	cursing; expressions of hatred	*It was as the ass and the lapdog; yet surely the gentle ass whose intentions were affectionate, although his manners were rude, deserved better treatment than blows and execration.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
endeared (verb)	made loved or liked	*The gentle manners and beauty of the cottagers greatly endeared them to me: when they were unhappy, I felt depressed; when they rejoiced, I sympathised in their joys.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enhanced (verb)	increase	*I saw few human beings beside them; and if any other happened to enter the cottage, their harsh manners and rude gait only enhanced to me the superior accomplishments of my friends.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
pronunciation (noun)	the manner in which someone utters a word	*Their pronunciation was quick; and the words they uttered, not having any apparent connection with visible objects, I was unable to discover any clue by which I could unravel the mystery of their reference.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
cultivating (verb)	foster the growth of	*I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage, and cultivating the garden.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
starlight (noun)	the light of the stars	*When they had retired to rest, if there was any moon, or the night was starlight, I went into the woods, and collected my own food and fuel for the cottage.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conjectured (verb)	to believe especially on uncertain or tentative grounds	*I conjectured, therefore, that he found on the paper signs for speech which he understood, and I ardently longed to comprehend these also; but how was that possible, when I did not even understand the sounds for which they stood as signs?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
communicating (verb)	transmit information	*I found that these people possessed a method of communicating their experience and feelings to one another by articulate sounds.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature?
2. Where does characterization appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Whom does the creature observe? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The De Lacey family
2. Which family member is blind? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The old father
3. Why does the creature stop taking their food? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He realizes they are poor
4. What does the creature see in a clear pool? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His own frightening reflection
5. What does he begin to learn? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Language
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Hidden, the creature observes the De Lacey family: the blind old father, Felix and Agatha. Seeing their poverty, he stops stealing their food and secretly gathers firewood for them. He begins to understand speech. Catching sight of his reflection in a pool, he is horrified at his own appearance.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XII"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: ""These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language." What does "exhilarated" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: exhilarated: filled with energy and excitement.
10. Reread: "I looked upon them as superior beings, who would be the arbiters of my future destiny." What does "arbiters" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: arbiters: people with the power to decide.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XII” suggest about learning compassion by watching? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him.
2. Find one example of characterization in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
3. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about learning compassion by watching? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6): Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““I remember, the first time that I did this, the young woman, when she opened the door in the morning, appeared greatly astonished on seeing a great pile of wood on the outside.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Hidden, the creature observes the De Lacey family: the blind old father, Felix and Agatha. Seeing their poverty, he stops stealing their food and secretly gathers firewood for them. He begins to understand speech. Catching sight of his reflection in a pool, he is horrified at his own appearance.
6. How does “Chapter XII” build on “Chapter XI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13): Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “fire,’ ‘milk,’ ‘bread,’ and ‘wood” (Chapter XII, paragraph 9): The first words he learns: basic needs and the home. On characterization: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “What does the creature's secret help reveal about his nature?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6): Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The cottage represents the domestic ideal praised in the Preface. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13): Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The creature's kindness shows his capacity for virtue before rejection hardens him.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “fire,’ ‘milk,’ ‘bread,’ and ‘wood” (Chapter XII, paragraph 9): The first words he learns: basic needs and the home. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6): Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness. On characterization: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about learning compassion by watching? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1,

RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: "how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool" (Chapter XII, paragraph 13): Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. On point of view: He observes without being seen, like a reader; we learn about human kindness through his eyes. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about "Chapter XII": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: "fire,' 'milk,' 'bread,' and 'wood" (Chapter XII, paragraph 9): The first words he learns: basic needs and the home. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: "when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained" (Chapter XII, paragraph 6): Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the characterization in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: "how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool" (Chapter XII, paragraph 13): Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. On characterization: From the hovel, the creature watches the De Lacey family and learns sympathy: he stops stealing their food when he realizes it hurts them. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how "Chapter XII" treats learning compassion by watching with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: "fire,' 'milk,' 'bread,' and 'wood" (Chapter XII, paragraph 9): The first words he learns: basic needs and the home. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XIII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “when I found that in doing this I inflicted pain on the cottagers, I abstained” (Chapter XII, paragraph 6): Moral reasoning; strong evidence of his goodness. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about learning compassion by watching? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “how was I terrified, when I viewed myself in a transparent pool” (Chapter XII, paragraph 13): Self-horror learned from others' standards of beauty. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature develops compassion through observation, proving the capacity for goodness Victor never gave him credit for. Useful evidence: “fire,’ ‘milk,’ ‘bread,’ and ‘wood” (Chapter XII, paragraph 9): The first words he learns: basic needs and the home. Theme link: he learns virtue by watching virtue. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Characterization:** look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Whom does the creature observe?
   A. Villagers in Geneva
   B. The Frankensteins
   C. The De Lacey family
   D. Walton's crew
2. Which family member is blind?
   A. Safie
   B. Agatha

C. Felix

D. The old father

3. Why does the creature stop taking their food?

A. He gets caught

B. He realizes they are poor

C. He finds better food

D. They lock it up

4. What does the creature see in a clear pool?

A. A fish

B. The moon only

C. His own frightening reflection

D. Victor

5. What does he begin to learn?

A. Language

B. Swimming

C. Chemistry

D. Music

6. In the line ""These thoughts exhilarated me, and led me to apply with fresh ardour to the acquiring the art of language.", what does "exhilarated" most nearly mean?

A. cursing; expressions of hatred

B. made loved or liked

C. people with the power to decide

D. filled with energy and excitement

7. In the line "I looked upon them as superior beings, who would be the arbiters of my future destiny.", what does "arbiters" most nearly mean?

A. filled with energy and excitement

B. made loved or liked

C. people with the power to decide

D. cursing; expressions of hatred

Answer key: 1. C (The De Lacey family); 2. D (The old father); 3. B (He realizes they are poor); 4. C (His own frightening reflection); 5. A (Language); 6. D (filled with energy and excitement); 7. C (people with the power to decide)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter XII," how does Shelley show learning compassion by watching? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the characterization you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XII, how does Shelley develop the idea of learning compassion by watching? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the characterization in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XII develops the idea of learning compassion by watching. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of characterization and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its characterization shape the reader's understanding of learning compassion by watching. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XII suggests about learning compassion by watching. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's characterization and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses characterization in Chapter XII to complicate the reader's understanding of learning compassion by watching. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of learning compassion by watching responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of learning compassion by watching follows or bends those conventions, using the characterization as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XII and its treatment of learning compassion by watching. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's characterization and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XII as evidence for a larger claim about learning compassion by watching in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of learning compassion by watching. Position

your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It was as the ass and the lapdog; yet surely the gentle ass whose intentions were affectionate, although his manners were rude, deserved better treatment than blows and execration.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "execration" most nearly mean?

   A. transmit information

   B. the light of the stars

   C. cursing; expressions of hatred

   D. to believe especially on uncertain or tentative grounds

2. *"I remember, the first time that I did this, the young woman, when she opened the door in the morning, appeared greatly astonished on seeing a great pile of wood on the outside. She uttered some words in a loud voice, and the youth joined her, who also expressed surprise. I observed, with pleasure, that he did not go to the forest that day, but spent it in repairing the cottage, and cultivating the garden.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XII"?

   A. Reading and identity

   B. Grief, prison and return

   C. Learning compassion by watching

   D. Despair and the sublime

SAT key: 1. C (cursing; expressions of hatred); 2. C (Learning compassion by watching)

Lesson 20: Chapter XIII

Focus: language, knowledge and sorrow

Content note (Orientalist portrayal): Safie and her father ("the Turk") are portrayed through European stereotypes about Muslims and the East. Name the stereotype and ask whose view the narrative takes.
Student preview: This chapter uses stereotypes about people from the Middle East. We will look at them critically.
Suggested language: "How is Safie's father described, and by whom? What stereotype is at work?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Spring comes, and Safie, an Arabian woman beloved by Felix, arrives. As Felix teaches her using Volney's 'Ruins of Empires,' the creature learns language and history alongside her. He learns of wealth, rank and injustice, realizes he has no family, money or name, and asks, 'What was I?' Knowledge deepens his misery.

Background: Volney's 'Ruins of Empires' (1791) was a radical history critiquing tyranny and religion; debates about property and rank reflect revolutionary thought after 1789.

Significance: Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because.... Content note before we start: This chapter uses stereotypes about people from the Middle East. We will look at them critically.
Prompt: The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: narrations — stories; accounts of events; recommencing — starting again; dissipates — makes disappear; scatters; degenerating — grow worse; disowned — prevent deliberately (as by making a will) from inheriting.
Words: narrations: stories; accounts of events · recommencing: starting again · dissipates: makes disappear; scatters · degenerating: grow worse · disowned: prevent deliberately (as by making a will) from inheriting

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Volney's 'Ruins of Empires' (1791) was a radical history critiquing tyranny and religion; debates about property and rank reflect revolutionary thought after 1789. Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate. Characterization: Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name. Diction / vocabulary: Abstract nouns (property, wealth, poverty, rank) enter his vocabulary; knowledge brings grief. Structure: Safie arrives and learns French alongside him; her lessons are his. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists. Felix seemed peculiarly happy, and with smiles" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 6).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16). Political education; links to Godwin. That is characterization at work: Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name.

> *I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16). Political education; links to Godwin. That is characterization at work: Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: A lichen cannot be scraped off a rock; knowledge clings in the same way. This connects to the theme of knowledge: for Victor and the creature, knowing is irreversible and painful. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. (Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.)

> *Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: A lichen cannot be scraped off a rock; knowledge clings in the same way. This connects to the theme of knowledge: for Victor and the creature, knowing is irreversible and painful.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. (Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about language, knowledge and sorrow? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIII develops the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. When the text says "I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood" (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16), it shows this directly. Learning of "rank, descent, and noble blood" leads him straight to "And what was I?", because society's categories leave no place for him.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about language, knowledge and sorrow? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIII develops the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good? Compare with Victor: does knowledge harm everyone in this book?

Anchor question: The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good?

Facilitation: Compare with Victor: does knowledge harm everyone in this book?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about language, knowledge and sorrow? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. ("I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood", Chapter XIII, paragraph 16). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about language, knowledge and sorrow? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. ("I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood", Chapter XIII, paragraph 16). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes language, knowledge and sorrow. Key takeaway: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Abstract nouns (property, wealth, poverty, rank) enter his vocabulary; knowledge brings grief.
- **Structure:** Safie arrives and learns French alongside him; her lessons are his.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists. Felix seemed peculiarly happy, and with smiles” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 6).
- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: “and heard of none like me. Was I then a monster, a blot upon the earth, from which all men fled, and” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19) Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned.
- “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16) Political education; links to Godwin.
- “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17) A question of identity.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion.
Evidence: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16)
Reasoning: Learning of "rank, descent, and noble blood" leads him straight to "And what was I?", because society's categories leave no place for him.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
narrations (noun)	stories; accounts of events	*"These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
recommencing (verb)	starting again	*Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dissipates (verb)	makes disappear; scatters	*They made many signs which I did not comprehend; but I saw that her presence diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
degenerating (verb)	grow worse	*I heard of the slothful Asiatics; of the stupendous genius and mental activity of the Grecians; of the wars and wonderful virtue of the early Romans—of their subsequent degenerating—of the decline of that mighty empire; of chivalry, Christianity, and kings.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disowned (verb)	prevent deliberately (as by making a will) from inheriting	*Was I then a monster, a blot upon the earth, from which all men fled, and whom all men disowned?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wondrously (adverb)	extremely well	*Her hair of a shining raven black, and curiously braided; her eyes were dark, but gentle, although animated; her features of a regular proportion, and her complexion wondrously fair, each cheek tinged with a lovely pink.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hideously (adverb)	in a hideous manner	*I was, besides, endued with a figure hideously deformed and loathsome; I was not even of the same nature as man.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enraptured (verb)	hold spellbound	*The old man appeared enraptured, and said some words, which Agatha endeavoured to explain to Safie, and by which he appeared to wish to express that she bestowed on him the greatest delight by her music.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
braided (verb)	make by braiding or interlacing	*Her hair of a shining raven black, and curiously braided; her eyes were dark, but gentle, although animated; her features of a regular proportion, and her complexion wondrously fair, each cheek tinged with a lovely pink.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dismount (noun)	the act of dismounting (a horse or bike etc.)	*He assisted her to dismount, and dismissing her guide, conducted her into the cottage.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good?

2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who arrives at the cottage? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Safie
2. How does Safie's arrival help the creature? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He learns language as she is taught
3. Which book does Felix read to Safie? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Ruins of Empires
4. What question does the creature ask himself? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: What was I?
5. How does knowledge affect him? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: It increases his sorrow
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XIII” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Spring comes, and Safie, an Arabian woman beloved by Felix, arrives. As Felix teaches her using Volney's 'Ruins of Empires,' the creature learns language and history alongside her. He learns of wealth, rank and injustice, realizes he has no family, money or name, and asks, 'What was I?' Knowledge deepens his misery.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XIII”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XIII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: ““These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings.” What does “narrations” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: narrations: stories; accounts of events.
10. Reread: “Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.” What does “recommencing” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: recommencing: starting again.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XIII” suggest about language, knowledge and sorrow? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate.
2. Find one example of allusion in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.9] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.
3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about language, knowledge and sorrow? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19): Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““It was on one of these days, when my cottagers periodically rested from labour—the old man played on his guitar, and the children listened to him—that I observed the countenance…”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XIII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Spring comes, and Safie, an Arabian woman beloved by Felix, arrives. As Felix teaches her using Volney's 'Ruins of Empires,' the creature learns language and history alongside her. He learns of wealth, rank and injustice, realizes he has no family, money or name, and asks, 'What was I?' Knowledge…
6. How does “Chapter XIII” build on “Chapter XII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16): Political education; links to Godwin. On structure: Safie arrives and learns French alongside him; her lessons are his. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17): A question of identity. On characterization: Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “The creature wishes he could forget what he learned. Is knowledge always good?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19): Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Volney's 'Ruins of Empires' (1791) was a radical history critiquing tyranny and religion; debates about property and rank reflect revolutionary thought after 1789. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16): Political education; links to Godwin. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Language opens knowledge and pain together, echoing Victor's own discovery that knowledge can isolate.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17): A question of identity. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19): Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned. On characterization: Learning history and social order, the creature realizes he has no place: no money, family or name. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XIII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about language, knowledge and sorrow? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a

painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16): Political education; links to Godwin. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XIII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17): A question of identity. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19): Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the allusion in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.9] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16): Political education; links to Godwin. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XIII” treats language, knowledge and sorrow with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17): A question of identity. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XIV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a

painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “Of what a strange nature is knowledge! It clings to the mind, when it has once seized on it, like a lichen on the rock” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 19): Simile for knowledge that cannot be unlearned. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about language, knowledge and sorrow? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “I heard of the division of property, of immense wealth and squalid poverty; of rank, descent, and noble blood” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 16): Political education; links to Godwin. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: For the creature, knowledge brings not power but a painful awareness of exclusion. Useful evidence: “And what was I” (Chapter XIII, paragraph 17): A question of identity. Theme link: "Of what a strange nature is knowledge!": knowledge as a burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Who arrives at the cottage?
   A. Safie
   B. Elizabeth
   C. Clerval
   D. Justine
2. How does Safie's arrival help the creature?
   A. She befriends him
   B. He learns language as she is taught
   C. She brings him chemistry books
   D. She feeds him

3. Which book does Felix read to Safie?
   A. Ruins of Empires
   B. The Bible
   C. Paradise Lost
   D. Plutarch's Lives
4. What question does the creature ask himself?
   A. Why is it cold?
   B. What was I?
   C. Who is Walton?
   D. Where is Geneva?
5. How does knowledge affect him?
   A. It cures his loneliness
   B. It increases his sorrow
   C. It makes him rich
   D. It makes him content
6. In the line ""These wonderful narrations inspired me with strange feelings.", what does "narrations" most nearly mean?
   A. makes disappear; scatters
   B. stories; accounts of events
   C. grow worse
   D. starting again
7. In the line "Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.", what does "recommencing" most nearly mean?
   A. starting again
   B. makes disappear; scatters
   C. stories; accounts of events
   D. grow worse

Answer key: 1. A (Safie); 2. B (He learns language as she is taught); 3. A (Ruins of Empires); 4. B (What was I?); 5. B (It increases his sorrow); 6. B (stories; accounts of events); 7. A (starting again)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter XIII," how does Shelley show language, knowledge and sorrow? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XIII develops the idea of language, knowledge and sorrow. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of language, knowledge and sorrow. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIII suggests about language, knowledge and sorrow. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter XIII to complicate the reader's understanding of language, knowledge and sorrow. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of language, knowledge and sorrow responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of language, knowledge and sorrow follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIII and its treatment of language, knowledge and sorrow. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIII as evidence for a larger claim about language, knowledge and sorrow in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of language, knowledge and sorrow. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *They made many signs which I did not comprehend; but I saw that her presence diffused gladness through the cottage, dispelling their sorrow as the sun dissipates the morning mists.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "dissipates" most nearly mean?

   A. the act of dismounting (a horse or bike etc.)
   B. makes disappear; scatters
   C. make by braiding or interlacing
   D. hold spellbound

2. *"It was on one of these days, when my cottagers periodically rested from labour—the old man played on his guitar, and the children listened to him—that I observed the countenance of Felix was melancholy beyond expression; he sighed frequently; and once his father paused in his music, and I conjectured by his manner that he enquired the cause of his son's sorrow. Felix replied in a cheerful accent, and the old man was recommencing his music, when someone tapped at the door.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XIII"?

   A. Injustice and the burden of silence
   B. Isolation in the north
   C. The first spark of obsession
   D. Language, knowledge and sorrow

SAT key: 1. B (makes disappear; scatters); 2. D (Language, knowledge and sorrow)

Lesson 21: Chapter XIV

Focus: injustice and exile

Content note (Orientalist portrayal): The De Lacey story continues the stereotyped portrait of Safie's father; contrast it with Safie's own agency.
Student preview: The chapter continues stereotypes about Safie's father.
Suggested language: "Does Safie fit the stereotype the narrator applies to her father?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature learns the De Laceys' history: Felix helped Safie's father, a Turkish merchant, escape unjust execution in Paris; the merchant betrayed them, and the family lost wealth and was exiled. Safie fled to find Felix.

Background: The story reflects prejudices and politics of 18th-century France and attitudes toward the Ottoman world.

Significance: Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because.... Content note before we start: The chapter continues stereotypes about Safie's father.
Prompt: How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: facilitated — made easier; reiterating — repeating; expostulate — to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind; passports — any authorization to pass or go somewhere; noisome — causing or able to cause nausea. "expostulate": From Latin expostulare "to demand urgently, remonstrate," from ex- + postulare "to demand."
Words: facilitated: made easier · reiterating: repeating · expostulate: to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind · passports: any authorization to pass or go somewhere · noisome: causing or able to cause nausea

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The story reflects prejudices and politics of 18th-century France and attitudes toward the Ottoman world. Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common. Structure: An embedded story within the creature's story (the De Laceys and Safie), a third layer of narration. Characterization: Felix's rescue of Safie's father, the father's betrayal, and the family's exile show virtue punished. Conflict: Injustice by a state and by a self-interested man. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "the truth of my tale; but at present, as the sun is already far declined, I shall only have time to repeat" (Chapter XIV, paragraph 7).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin" (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3). Benevolence repaid with treachery. That is structure at work: An embedded story within the creature's story (the De Laceys and Safie), a third layer of narration.

> *The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin* (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin" (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3). Benevolence repaid with treachery. That is structure at work: An embedded story within the creature's story (the De Laceys and Safie), a third layer of narration.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The family is ruined by the man they helped; ingratitude and injustice. This parallels Justine's trial and prepares the creature's rejection. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: The De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. (Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial.)

> *Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court* (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The family is ruined by the man they helped; ingratitude and injustice. This parallels Justine's trial and prepares the creature's rejection.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: The De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. (Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about injustice and exile? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIV develops the idea of injustice and exile. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. When the text says "The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin" (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. The family's ruin comes from helping the man whose daughter Felix loves, since "the father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin"; goodness here is no protection.

Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about injustice and exile? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIV develops the idea of injustice and exile. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. When the text says "The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin" (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. The family's ruin comes from helping the man whose daughter Felix loves, since "the father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin"; goodness here is no protection.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation? Ask why Shelley includes a story within a story here. What does it add?

Anchor question: How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation?

Facilitation: Ask why Shelley includes a story within a story here. What does it add?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about injustice and exile? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. ("The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin", Chapter XIV, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about injustice and exile? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. ("The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin", Chapter XIV, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how structure shapes injustice and exile. Key takeaway: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** An embedded story within the creature's story (the De Laceys and Safie), a third layer of narration.
- **Characterization:** Felix's rescue of Safie's father, the father's betrayal, and the family's exile show virtue punished.
- **Conflict:** Injustice by a state and by a self-interested man.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “the truth of my tale; but at present, as the sun is already far declined, I shall only have time to repeat” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 7).
- **isolation:** Almost every narrator ends up alone; solitude is both the cost of ambition and the creature's suffering. In this chapter: “When alone, Safie resolved in her own mind the plan of conduct that” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 19).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3) Benevolence repaid with treachery.
- “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4) Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial.
- “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15) Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection.
Evidence: "The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin" (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3)
Reasoning: The family's ruin comes from helping the man whose daughter Felix loves, since "the father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin"; goodness here is no protection.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
facilitated (verb)	made easier	*His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
reiterating (verb)	repeating	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
expostulate (verb)	to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	"expostulate": From Latin expostulare "to demand urgently, remonstrate," from ex- + postulare "to demand." (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/expostulate)
passports (noun)	any authorization to pass or go somewhere	*Felix had procured passports in the name of his father, sister, and himself.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
noisome (adjective)	causing or able to cause nausea	*His blind and aged father, and his gentle sister, lay in a noisome dungeon, while he enjoyed the free air, and the society of her whom he loved.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
affluence (noun)	abundant wealth	*He was descended from a good family in France, where he had lived for many years in affluence, respected by his superiors, and beloved by his equals.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mandate (noun)	a document giving an official instruction or command	*The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

spurned (verb)	reject with contempt	*The young girl spoke in high and enthusiastic terms of her mother, who, born in freedom, spurned the bondage to which she was now reduced.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
uncontrollable (adjective)	difficult to solve or alleviate	*"Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
revolved (verb)	turn on or around an axis or a center	*He revolved a thousand plans by which he should be enabled to prolong the deceit until it might be no longer necessary, and secretly to take his daughter with him when he departed.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation?
2. Where does plot appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why were the De Laceys exiled? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape
2. Who betrayed them? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Safie's father
3. Where did these events take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Paris
4. How does Safie show courage? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: She travels alone to find Felix
5. What larger pattern does this story show? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The virtuous often suffer injustice
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XIV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The creature learns the De Laceys' history: Felix helped Safie's

father, a Turkish merchant, escape unjust execution in Paris; the merchant betrayed them, and the family lost wealth and was exiled. Safie fled to find Felix.

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XIV”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XIV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris.” What does “facilitated” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: facilitated: made easier.
10. Reread: “The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.” What does “reiterating” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: reiterating: repeating.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XIV” suggest about injustice and exile? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common.
2. Find one example of plot in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about injustice and exile? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3): Benevolence repaid with treachery. On characterization: Felix's rescue of Safie's father, the father's betrayal, and the family's exile show virtue punished. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““The name of the old man was De Lacey.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XIV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: The creature learns the De Laceys' history: Felix helped Safie's father, a Turkish merchant, escape unjust execution in Paris; the merchant betrayed them, and the family lost wealth and was exiled. Safie fled to find Felix.
6. How does “Chapter XIV” build on “Chapter XIII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4): Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial. On

structure: An embedded story within the creature's story (the De Laceys and Safie), a third layer of narration. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15): Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment. On characterization: Felix's rescue of Safie's father, the father's betrayal, and the family's exile show virtue punished. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does the De Laceys' story parallel the creature's own situation?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3): Benevolence repaid with treachery. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The story reflects prejudices and politics of 18th-century France and attitudes toward the Ottoman world. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4): Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Injustice repeats across the book; the virtuous suffer, and betrayal is common.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15): Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and

the narrative's) judgment. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3): Benevolence repaid with treachery. On characterization: Felix's rescue of Safie's father, the father's betrayal, and the family's exile show virtue punished. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XIV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about injustice and exile? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4): Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XIV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15): Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3): Benevolence repaid with treachery. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the plot in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people

suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4): Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XIV” treats injustice and exile with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15): Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “The father of Safie had been the cause of their ruin” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 3): Benevolence repaid with treachery. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about injustice and exile? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix had accidentally been present at the trial; his horror and indignation were uncontrollable, when he heard the decision of the court” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 4): Felix's sense of justice; it echoes Justine's trial. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The De Lacey history shows that even good people suffer injustice, preparing the creature, and the reader, for his own rejection. Useful evidence: “Felix soon learned that the treacherous Turk, for whom he and his family endured such unheard-of oppression” (Chapter XIV, paragraph 15): Ingratitude repays virtue; the word "treacherous" carries the creature's (and the narrative's) judgment. Theme link: the De Laceys, poor and exiled, still have each other; the creature has no one. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Plot:** look for key events and the causes linking them (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. Why were the De Laceys exiled?
   A. They were scientists
   B. They stole money
   C. Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape
   D. They insulted the king
2. Who betrayed them?
   A. Safie's father
   B. Safie
   C. Agatha
   D. Victor
3. Where did these events take place?
   A. Ingolstadt
   B. Paris
   C. Constantinople
   D. London
4. How does Safie show courage?
   A. She runs a business
   B. She travels alone to find Felix
   C. She fights soldiers
   D. She becomes a judge
5. What larger pattern does this story show?
   A. Wealth guarantees happiness
   B. Crime is always punished
   C. Travel is safe
   D. The virtuous often suffer injustice
6. In the line “His plans were facilitated by the news which arrived from Paris.”, what does “facilitated” most nearly mean?
   A. repeating
   B. made easier
   C. any authorization to pass or go somewhere
   D. to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind

7. In the line “The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.”, what does “reiterating” most nearly mean?

   A. made easier

   B. to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind

   C. any authorization to pass or go somewhere

   D. repeating

Answer key: 1. C (Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape); 2. A (Safie's father); 3. B (Paris); 4. B (She travels alone to find Felix); 5. D (The virtuous often suffer injustice); 6. B (made easier); 7. D (repeating)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XIV,” how does Shelley show injustice and exile? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the plot you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XIV, how does Shelley develop the idea of injustice and exile? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the plot in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XIV develops the idea of injustice and exile. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of plot and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XIV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its plot shape the reader's understanding of injustice and exile. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIV suggests about injustice and exile. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's plot and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses plot in Chapter XIV to complicate the reader's understanding of injustice and exile. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XIV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of injustice and exile responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XIV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of injustice and exile follows or bends those conventions, using the plot as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIV and its treatment of injustice and exile. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's plot and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIV as evidence for a larger claim about injustice and exile in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of injustice and exile. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The generous nature of Safie was outraged by this command; she attempted to expostulate with her father, but he left her angrily, reiterating his tyrannical mandate.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “expostulate” most nearly mean?

   A. reject with contempt

   B. turn on or around an axis or a center

   C. difficult to solve or alleviate

   D. to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind

2. *“The name of the old man was De Lacey. He was descended from a good family in France, where he had lived for many years in affluence, respected by his superiors, and beloved by his equals. His son was bred in the service of his country; and Agatha had ranked with ladies of the highest distinction. A few months before my arrival, they had lived in a large and luxurious city, called Paris, surrounded by friends, and possessed of every enjoyment which virtue, refinement of intellect, or taste, accompanied by a moderate fortune, could afford.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XIV”?

   A. First experiences of the senses

   B. A letter, a secret and the wedding

   C. Injustice and exile

   D. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

SAT key: 1. D (to argue earnestly with someone to change their mind); 2. C (Injustice and exile)

Lesson 22: Chapter XV

Focus: reading and identity

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature finds Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives and The Sorrows of Young Werther, and reads Victor's laboratory journal, which describes his creation with disgust. He reveals himself to the blind old De Lacey, who is kind, but Felix, Agatha and Safie return, and Felix strikes him and drives him away.

Background: Each book shapes him: Werther teaches feeling, Plutarch virtue and heroism, Milton his place in creation.

Significance: He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and nurture because....
Prompt: Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to nature and nurture because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: massacring — killing large numbers of people; undeceiving — showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief; instigate — to urge on; to provoke; unformed — not having form or shape; disquisitions — an elaborate analytical or explanatory essay or discussion.
Words: massacring: killing large numbers of people · undeceiving: showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief · instigate: to urge on; to provoke · unformed: not having form or shape · disquisitions: an elaborate analytical or explanatory essay or discussion

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Each book shapes him: Werther teaches feeling, Plutarch virtue and heroism, Milton his place in creation. He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage. Allusion: The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling. Characterization: He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation. Irony: Old De Lacey, blind, welcomes him; the family, seeing him, attacks. Watch for blindness: De Lacey's blindness lets him see the creature truly.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3). His education; each book shapes him. That is allusion at work: The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling.

> *Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther (Chapter XV, paragraph 3)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3). His education; each book shapes him. That is allusion at work: The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Adam had Eve and God; the creature has "no link" to anyone. The allusion intensifies isolation and connects to companionship. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture? Expected: Rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. (Isolation through allusion.)

> *Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence (Chapter XV, paragraph 7)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Adam had Eve and God; the creature has "no link" to anyone. The allusion intensifies isolation and connects to companionship.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture?
Expected answer: Rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. (Isolation through allusion.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for allusion, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about reading and identity? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XV develops the idea of reading and identity. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. When the text says "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. Old De Lacey, who is blind, responds kindly to his words, but the family sees him and attacks; the scene shows that only someone who cannot see him can judge him fairly.

Task: Annotate the chapter for allusion, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about reading and identity? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XV develops the idea of reading and identity. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. When the text says "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3), it shows this directly. Old De Lacey, who is blind, responds kindly to his words, but the family sees him and attacks; the scene shows that only someone who cannot see him can judge him fairly.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan? The blind man scene often moves students strongly. Allow emotion, then ask about Shelley's choice to make him blind.

Anchor question: Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan?

Facilitation: The blind man scene often moves students strongly. Allow emotion, then ask about Shelley's choice to make him blind.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about reading and identity? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. ("Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther", Chapter XV, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about reading and identity? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. ("Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther", Chapter XV, paragraph 3). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how allusion shapes reading and identity. Key takeaway: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Allusion:** The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling.
- **Characterization:** He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation.
- **Irony:** Old De Lacey, blind, welcomes him; the family, seeing him, attacks.

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and nurture:** rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words.

Symbols and motifs

- **blindness:** De Lacey's blindness lets him see the creature truly.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3) His education; each book shapes him.
- "Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence" (Chapter XV, paragraph 7) Isolation through allusion.

- "Hateful day when I received life" (Chapter XV, paragraph 8) The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him.
Evidence: "Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch's Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther" (Chapter XV, paragraph 3)
Reasoning: Old De Lacey, who is blind, responds kindly to his words, but the family sees him and attacks; the scene shows that only someone who cannot see him can judge him fairly.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
massacring (verb)	killing large numbers of people	*I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
undeceiving (verb)	showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief	*"The old man paused, and then continued, 'If you will unreservedly confide to me the particulars of your tale, I perhaps may be of use in undeceiving them.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
instigate (verb)	to urge on; to provoke	*" 'Heaven forbid! even if you were really criminal; for that can only drive you to desperation, and not instigate you to virtue.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unformed (adjective)	not having form or shape	*I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. 'The path of my departure was free'; and there was none to lament my annihilation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
disquisitions (noun)	an elaborate analytical or explanatory essay or discussion	*The disquisitions upon death and suicide were calculated to fill me with wonder.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
decipher (verb)	convert code into ordinary language	*At first I had neglected them; but now that I was able to decipher the characters in which they were written, I began to study them with diligence.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
persuades (verb)	win approval or support for	*I am blind, and cannot judge of your countenance, but there is something in your words, which persuades me that you are sincere.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
deprecate (verb)	express strong disapproval of; deplore	*I learned, from the views of social life which it developed, to admire their virtues, and to deprecate the vices of mankind.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
antelope (noun)	a fast, graceful animal with horns, like a deer	*I could have torn him limb from limb, as the lion rends the antelope.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

decreased (verb)	decrease in size, extent, or range	*Their happiness was not decreased by the absence of summer.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan?
2. Where does allusion appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Which book is NOT among those he finds? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Robinson Crusoe
2. What document does he discover in his clothing? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Victor's laboratory journal
3. Which character in Milton does he feel most like? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Satan, the outcast
4. Why does he choose the blind father first? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He cannot judge by appearance
5. What does Felix do when he finds the creature with his father? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Strikes him and drives him away
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XV” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The creature finds Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives and The Sorrows of Young Werther, and reads Victor's laboratory journal, which describes his creation with disgust. He reveals himself to the blind old De Lacey, who is kind, but Felix, Agatha and Safie return, and Felix strikes him and drives him away.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XV”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XV” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species.” What does “massacring” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: massacring: killing large numbers of people.
10. Reread: ““The old man paused, and then continued, ‘If you will unreservedly confide to me the particulars of your tale, I perhaps may be of use in undeceiving them.” What does “undeceiving” mean here, and what

is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: undeceiving: showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XV” suggest about reading and identity? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage.
2. Find one example of allusion in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.9] Look for: Look for references to other books, myths, history or religion.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about reading and identity? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3): His education; each book shapes him. On characterization: He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““As I read, however, I applied much personally to my own feelings and condition.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: The creature finds Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives and The Sorrows of Young Werther, and reads Victor's laboratory journal, which describes his creation with disgust. He reveals himself to the blind old De Lacey, who is kind, but Felix, Agatha and Safie return, and Felix strikes him and drives him…
6. How does “Chapter XV” build on “Chapter XIV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7): Isolation through allusion. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8): The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job. On characterization: He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does the creature compare himself to both Adam and Satan?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does theme appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3): His education; each book shapes him. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Each book shapes him: Werther teaches feeling, Plutarch virtue and heroism, Milton his place in creation. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7): Isolation through allusion. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “He identifies with both Adam and Satan; the De Laceys' rejection is the turning point from benevolence to rage.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8): The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3): His education; each book shapes him. On characterization: He identifies with both Adam and Satan, and reads Victor's journal about his own creation. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about reading and identity? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that

appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7): Isolation through allusion. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8): The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3): His education; each book shapes him. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the allusion in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.9] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7): Isolation through allusion. On allusion: The three books he finds (Paradise Lost, Plutarch's Lives, The Sorrows of Werter) give him models of a creator, of public virtue and of feeling. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XV” treats reading and identity with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8): The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XVI” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Paradise Lost, a volume of Plutarch’s Lives, and the Sorrows of Werther” (Chapter XV, paragraph 3): His education; each book shapes him. Theme

link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about reading and identity? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Like Adam, I was apparently united by no link to any other being in existence” (Chapter XV, paragraph 7): Isolation through allusion. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's rejection by the De Laceys proves that appearance, not character, condemns him. Useful evidence: “Hateful day when I received life” (Chapter XV, paragraph 8): The creature curses his own birth, echoing Job. Theme link: rejection is based on sight; the blind man alone judges him by his words. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Allusion:** look for references to other books, myths, history or religion (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas

Chapter quiz

1. Which book is NOT among those he finds?
   A. Robinson Crusoe
   B. Paradise Lost
   C. The Sorrows of Young Werther
   D. Plutarch's Lives
2. What document does he discover in his clothing?
   A. A will
   B. Victor's laboratory journal
   C. A letter from Elizabeth
   D. A map
3. Which character in Milton does he feel most like?
   A. Michael
   B. Satan, the outcast
   C. Gabriel
   D. Eve

4. Why does he choose the blind father first?
   A. He speaks German
   B. He cannot judge by appearance
   C. He is the strongest
   D. He has money
5. What does Felix do when he finds the creature with his father?
   A. Invites him to dinner
   B. Strikes him and drives him away
   C. Calls for a doctor
   D. Shakes his hand
6. In the line “I read of men concerned in public affairs, governing or massacring their species.”, what does “massacring” most nearly mean?
   A. to urge on; to provoke
   B. showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief
   C. killing large numbers of people
   D. not having form or shape
7. In the line ““The old man paused, and then continued, ‘If you will unreservedly confide to me the particulars of your tale, I perhaps may be of use in undeceiving them.”, what does “undeceiving” most nearly mean?
   A. not having form or shape
   B. showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief
   C. killing large numbers of people
   D. to urge on; to provoke

Answer key: 1. A (Robinson Crusoe); 2. B (Victor's laboratory journal); 3. B (Satan, the outcast); 4. B (He cannot judge by appearance); 5. B (Strikes him and drives him away); 6. C (killing large numbers of people); 7. B (showing someone the truth; freeing from a false belief)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XV,” how does Shelley show reading and identity? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the allusion you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XV, how does Shelley develop the idea of reading and identity? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the allusion in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.9, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XV develops the idea of reading and identity. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and

explain how the author's use of allusion and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its allusion shape the reader's understanding of reading and identity. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XV suggests about reading and identity. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's allusion and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses allusion in Chapter XV to complicate the reader's understanding of reading and identity. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of reading and identity responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of reading and identity follows or bends those conventions, using the allusion as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XV and its treatment of reading and identity. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's allusion and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XV as evidence for a larger claim about reading and identity in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of reading and identity. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *" 'Heaven forbid! even if you were really criminal; for that can only drive you to desperation, and not instigate you to virtue.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "instigate" most nearly mean?

   A. to urge on; to provoke

   B. decrease in size, extent, or range

   C. express strong disapproval of; deplore

   D. a fast, graceful animal with horns, like a deer

2. *"As I read, however, I applied much personally to my own feelings and condition. I found myself similar, yet at the same time strangely unlike to the beings concerning whom I read, and to whose conversation I was a listener. I sympathised with, and partly understood them, but I was unformed in mind; I was dependent on none, and related to none. 'The path of my departure was free'; and there was none to lament my annihilation. My person was hideous, and my stature gigantic? What did this mean? Who was I? What was I? Whence did I come? What was my destination? These questions continually recurred, but I was unable to solve them.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XV"?

   A. First experiences of the senses

   B. Rejection and the turn to revenge

   C. Reading and identity

   D. Ambition and the hunger for discovery

SAT key: 1. A (to urge on; to provoke); 2. C (Reading and identity)

Lesson 23: Chapter XVI

Focus: rejection and the turn to revenge

Content note (murder of a child): The creature recounts strangling William. Keep discussion on responsibility and rejection, not the act itself.
Student preview: The creature describes killing a child.
Suggested language: "What does the creature say led him to this point? Do you accept his account?"

Teacher only · spoilers

The De Laceys abandon the cottage. Enraged, the creature burns it and heads for Geneva, guided by Victor's journal. He saves a drowning girl but is shot. Near Geneva he meets William, learns he is a Frankenstein, kills him, and plants the portrait on the sleeping Justine.

Background: This chapter retells Chapter VII's events from the other side—a key structural mirror.

Significance: His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to nature and nurture because.... Content note before we start: The creature describes killing a child.
Prompt: Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to nature and nurture because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: imprecate — to call down (curses) on; bedewed — wet with drops, as of dew or tears; underwood — small trees and bushes growing under taller trees; sanguinary — accompanied by bloodshed; extracting — remove, usually with some force or effort; also used in an abstract sense.
Words: imprecate: to call down (curses) on · bedewed: wet with drops, as of dew or tears · underwood: small trees and bushes growing under taller trees · sanguinary: accompanied by bloodshed · extracting: remove, usually with some force or effort; also used in an abstract sense

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
This chapter retells Chapter VII's events from the other side—a key structural mirror. His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes. Characterization: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein. Allusion: "I, like the arch-fiend, bore a hell within me": Satan again. Irony: He saves a drowning girl and is shot for it. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "The sun rose; I heard the voices of men, and knew that it" (Chapter XVI, paragraph 4).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live" (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1). Anguish and accusation. That is characterization at work: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein.

> *Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live* (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live" (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1). Anguish and accusation. That is characterization at work: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The arch-fiend is Satan; the hell is within. This shows his suffering is now part of him, linking to nurture: what was done to him becomes who he is. Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture? Expected: Repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. (Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.)

> *I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me* (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The arch-fiend is Satan; the hell is within. This shows his suffering is now part of him, linking to nurture: what was done to him becomes who he is.
Ask: How does this line connect to nature and nurture?
Expected answer: Repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. (Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about rejection and the turn to revenge? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVI develops the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. When the text says “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20), it shows this directly. After he saves a girl and is shot, he asks bitterly whether "this was then the reward of my benevolence," and soon he bears "a hell within me"; the novel traces how injustice breeds hatred while still making him kill William by his own will.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, allusion (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about rejection and the turn to revenge? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVI develops the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. When the text says “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20), it shows this directly. After he saves a girl and is shot, he asks bitterly whether "this was then the reward of my benevolence," and soon he bears "a hell within me"; the novel traces how injustice breeds hatred while still making him kill William by his own will.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine? Push past "it's not his fault": does the novel excuse William's murder? How can we hold both sympathy and judgment?

Anchor question: Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine?

Facilitation: Push past "it's not his fault": does the novel excuse William's murder? How can we hold both sympathy and judgment?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about rejection and the turn to revenge? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. (“This was then the reward of my benevolence”, Chapter XVI, paragraph 20). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about rejection and the turn to revenge? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. (“This was then the reward of my benevolence”, Chapter XVI, paragraph 20). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes rejection and the turn to revenge. Key takeaway: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein.
- **Allusion:** "I, like the arch-fiend, bore a hell within me": Satan again.
- **Irony:** He saves a drowning girl and is shot for it.

Themes and how they develop

- **nature and nurture:** repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “The sun rose; I heard the voices of men, and knew that it” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 4).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “or the prospect of the sun setting behind the stupendous mountains of Jura” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 24).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1) Anguish and accusation.
- “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2) Milton's Satan: the hell is internal.
- “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20) Shot after a rescue; bitter irony.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice.
Evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20)
Reasoning: After he saves a girl and is shot, he asks bitterly whether "this was then the reward of my benevolence," and soon he bears "a hell within me"; the novel traces how injustice breeds hatred while still making him kill William by his own will.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history

imprecate (verb)	to call down (curses) on	*Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
bedewed (verb)	wet with drops, as of dew or tears	*Soft tears again bedewed my cheeks, and I even raised my humid eyes with thankfulness towards the blessed sun which bestowed such joy upon me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
underwood (noun)	small trees and bushes growing under taller trees	*Accordingly I hid myself in some thick underwood, determining to devote the ensuing hours to reflection on my situation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sanguinary (adjective)	accompanied by bloodshed	*Thanks to the lessons of Felix and the sanguinary laws of man, I had learned now to work mischief.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
extracting (verb)	remove, usually with some force or effort; also used in an abstract sense	*The ball had entered my shoulder, and I knew not whether it had remained there or passed through; at any rate I had no means of extracting it.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
epithets (noun)	a defamatory or abusive word or phrase	*"The child still struggled, and loaded me with epithets which carried despair to my heart; I grasped his throat to silence him, and in a moment he lay dead at my feet.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
obstructed (verb)	hinder or prevent the progress or accomplishment of	*I was like a wild beast that had broken the toils; destroying the objects that obstructed me, and ranging through the wood with a stag-like swiftness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
apprehending (verb)	get the meaning of something	*I trembled violently, apprehending some dreadful misfortune.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enkindled (verb)	cause to start burning	*The nearer I approached to your habitation, the more deeply did I feel the spirit of revenge enkindled in my heart.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
imparting (verb)	transmit (knowledge or skills)	*Here, I thought, is one of those whose joy-imparting smiles are bestowed on all but me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23,

24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does the creature travel after the De Laceys leave? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Toward Geneva
2. What does the family do after the encounter? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Abandon the cottage
3. What does the creature do to the cottage? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Burns it
4. What happens after he saves a drowning girl? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He is shot
5. Why does he kill William? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He learns the boy is a Frankenstein
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XVI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The De Laceys abandon the cottage. Enraged, the creature burns it and heads for Geneva, guided by Victor's journal. He saves a drowning girl but is shot. Near Geneva he meets William, learns he is a Frankenstein, kills him, and plants the portrait on the sleeping Justine.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XVI"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XVI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!" What does "imprecate" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: imprecate: to call down (curses) on.
10. Reread: "Soft tears again bedewed my cheeks, and I even raised my humid eyes with thankfulness towards the blessed sun which bestowed such joy upon me." What does "bedewed" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: bedewed: wet with drops, as of dew or tears.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XVI" suggest about rejection and the turn to revenge? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes.
2. Find one example of irony in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about rejection and the turn to revenge? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and

think, and how others react to them.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1): Anguish and accusation. On characterization: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins ““When night came, I quitted my retreat, and wandered in the wood; and now, no longer restrained by the fear of discovery, I gave vent to my anguish in fearful howlings.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XVI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: The De Laceys abandon the cottage. Enraged, the creature burns it and heads for Geneva, guided by Victor's journal. He saves a drowning girl but is shot. Near Geneva he meets William, learns he is a Frankenstein, kills him, and plants the portrait on the sleeping Justine.
6. How does “Chapter XVI” build on “Chapter XV”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2): Milton's Satan: the hell is internal. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20): Shot after a rescue; bitter irony. On characterization: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Does the creature's suffering excuse what he does to William and Justine?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1): Anguish and accusation. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: This chapter retells Chapter VII's events from the other side—a key structural mirror. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s ·

RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2): Milton's Satan: the hell is internal. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “His turn to violence complicates sympathy: rejection explains but does not excuse his crimes.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20): Shot after a rescue; bitter irony. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1): Anguish and accusation. On characterization: The creature's turn: he burns the cottage, swears war on humanity, and kills William when the boy names Frankenstein. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XVI” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about rejection and the turn to revenge? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2): Milton's Satan: the hell is internal. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XVI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20): Shot after a rescue; bitter irony. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1): Anguish and accusation. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the irony in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2): Milton's Satan: the hell is internal. On irony: He saves a drowning girl and is shot for it. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XVI” treats rejection and the turn to revenge with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20): Shot after a rescue; bitter irony. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XVII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “Cursed, cursed creator! Why did I live” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 1): Anguish and accusation. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about rejection and the turn to revenge? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 2): Milton's Satan: the hell is internal. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's violence is a response to repeated cruelty, though it is still his choice. Useful evidence: “This was then the reward of my benevolence” (Chapter XVI, paragraph 20): Shot after a rescue; bitter irony. Theme link: repeated cruelty turns his benevolence into

vengeance. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz

1. Where does the creature travel after the De Laceys leave?
   A. To Ingolstadt
   B. To London
   C. Toward Geneva
   D. To the North Pole
2. What does the family do after the encounter?
   A. Abandon the cottage
   B. Hire guards
   C. Move into Geneva
   D. Search for him to apologize
3. What does the creature do to the cottage?
   A. Sells it
   B. Repairs it
   C. Burns it
   D. Lives in it with them
4. What happens after he saves a drowning girl?
   A. He is thanked
   B. He is shot
   C. He is adopted
   D. He is hired
5. Why does he kill William?
   A. By accident
   B. He learns the boy is a Frankenstein
   C. For food
   D. William attacked him
6. In the line “Oh, earth! how often did I imprecate curses on the cause of my being!”, what does “imprecate” most nearly mean?
   A. accompanied by bloodshed
   B. small trees and bushes growing under taller trees

C. wet with drops, as of dew or tears

D. to call down (curses) on

7. In the line “Soft tears again bedewed my cheeks, and I even raised my humid eyes with thankfulness towards the blessed sun which bestowed such joy upon me.”, what does “bedewed” most nearly mean?

A. wet with drops, as of dew or tears

B. small trees and bushes growing under taller trees

C. to call down (curses) on

D. accompanied by bloodshed

Answer key: 1. C (Toward Geneva); 2. A (Abandon the cottage); 3. C (Burns it); 4. B (He is shot); 5. B (He learns the boy is a Frankenstein); 6. D (to call down (curses) on); 7. A (wet with drops, as of dew or tears)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XVI,” how does Shelley show rejection and the turn to revenge? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XVI, how does Shelley develop the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XVI develops the idea of rejection and the turn to revenge. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of rejection and the turn to revenge. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVI suggests about rejection and the turn to revenge. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter XVI to complicate the reader's understanding of rejection and the turn to revenge. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XVI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of rejection and the turn

to revenge responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XVI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of rejection and the turn to revenge follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVI and its treatment of rejection and the turn to revenge. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVI as evidence for a larger claim about rejection and the turn to revenge in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of rejection and the turn to revenge. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Accordingly I hid myself in some thick underwood, determining to devote the ensuing hours to reflection on my situation.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “underwood” most nearly mean?

   A. small trees and bushes growing under taller trees

   B. cause to start burning

   C. get the meaning of something

   D. transmit (knowledge or skills)

2. *“When night came, I quitted my retreat, and wandered in the wood; and now, no longer restrained by the fear of discovery, I gave vent to my anguish in fearful howlings. I was like a wild beast that had broken the toils; destroying the objects that obstructed me, and ranging through the wood with a stag-like swiftness. O! what a miserable night I passed! the cold stars shone in mockery, and the bare trees waved their branches above me: now and then the sweet voice of a bird burst forth amidst the universal stillness. All, save I, were at rest or in enjoyment: I, like the archfiend, bore a hell within me; and, finding myself unsympathised with, wished to tear up the trees, spread havoc and destruction around me, and then to have sat down and enjoyed the ruin.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XVI”?

   A. Rejection and the turn to revenge

   B. Obsession and the discovery of life

   C. Delay and dread

D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. A (small trees and bushes growing under taller trees); 2. A (Rejection and the turn to revenge)

Lesson 24: Chapter XVII

Focus: the demand for a companion

Teacher only · spoilers

The creature demands a female companion as wretched as himself, promising to withdraw to South America. Moved and afraid, Victor agrees.

Background: Debates on whether humans have natural rights to companionship and happiness echo Enlightenment philosophy.

Significance: This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because....
Prompt: Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: insurmountable — impossible to overcome; concede — to grant; to give; trifled — treated lightly; toyed with; protectors — a person who cares for persons or property; sickened — cause aversion in; offend the moral sense of.
Words: insurmountable: impossible to overcome · concede: to grant; to give · trifled: treated lightly; toyed with · protectors: a person who cares for persons or property · sickened: cause aversion in; offend the moral sense of

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Debates on whether humans have natural rights to companionship and happiness echo Enlightenment philosophy. This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate. Characterization: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity. Conflict: Creator versus creation, argument versus revulsion. Diction / vocabulary: "Chain of existence": he wants to belong to the social web. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "fare. We shall make our bed of dried leaves; the sun will shine on us as on man, and will ripen our" (Chapter XVII, paragraph 9).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2). "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. That is characterization at work: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity.

> *You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being* *(Chapter XVII, paragraph 2)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2). "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. That is characterization at work: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The "chain of existence" is a web of relationships; "excluded" shows he is outside it. Connects to companionship. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: The plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. (The wish to belong.)

> *I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded* *(Chapter XVII, paragraph 14)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The "chain of existence" is a web of relationships; "excluded" shows he is outside it. Connects to companionship.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: The plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. (The wish to belong.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the demand for a companion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVII develops the idea of the demand for a companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. When the text says "If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion" (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14), it shows this directly. He calls sympathy "necessary for my being" and warns that without "ties" and "affections" he must turn to "hatred and vice," linking moral life to belonging.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, conflict (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the demand for a companion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVII develops the idea of the demand for a companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. When the text says "If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion" (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14), it shows this directly. He calls sympathy "necessary for my being" and warns that without "ties" and "affections" he must turn to "hatred and vice," linking moral life to belonging.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider? Debate: should Victor agree? Require students to weigh the risks Victor names.

Anchor question: Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider?

Facilitation: Debate: should Victor agree? Require students to weigh the risks Victor names.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the demand for a companion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. ("If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion", Chapter XVII, paragraph 14). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the demand for a companion? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. ("If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion", Chapter XVII, paragraph 14). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes the demand for a companion. Key takeaway: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity.
- **Conflict:** Creator versus creation, argument versus revulsion.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** "Chain of existence": he wants to belong to the social web.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “fare. We shall make our bed of dried leaves; the sun will shine on us as on man, and will ripen our” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 9).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “any change in my sentiments. I saw him descend the mountain with greater speed than the flight of an eagle, and quickly” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 18).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2) "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food.
- “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14) The argument from isolation.
- “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14) The wish to belong.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need.
Evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14)

Reasoning: He calls sympathy "necessary for my being" and warns that without "ties" and "affections" he must turn to "hatred and vice," linking moral life to belonging.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
insurmountable (adjective)	impossible to overcome	*But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
concede (verb)	to grant; to give	*This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
trifled (verb)	treated lightly; toyed with	*I must not be trifled with: and I demand an answer.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
protectors (noun)	a person who cares for persons or property	*I thought of the promise of virtues which he had displayed on the opening of his existence, and the subsequent blight of all kindly feeling by the loathing and scorn which his protectors had manifested towards him.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sickened (verb)	cause aversion in; offend the moral sense of	*I compassionated him, and sometimes felt a wish to console him; but when I looked upon him, when I saw the filthy mass that moved and talked, my heart sickened, and my feelings were altered to those of horror and hatred.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
interchange (noun)	an exchange; a giving and receiving	*"You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
precipices (noun)	a very steep cliff	*His power and threats were not omitted in my calculations: a creature who could exist in the ice-caves of the glaciers, and hide himself from pursuit among the ridges of inaccessible precipices, was a being possessing faculties it would be vain to cope with.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
narrated (verb)	provide commentary for a film, for example	*The latter part of his tale had kindled anew in me the anger that had died away while he narrated his peaceful life among the cottagers, and, as he said this, I could no longer suppress the rage that burned within me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
barriers (noun)	a structure or object that impedes free movement	*But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
persevere (verb)	be persistent, refuse to stop	*How can you, who long for the love and sympathy of man, persevere in this exile?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider?
2. Where does theme appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does the creature demand? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A female companion
2. Where does he promise to go? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The wilds of South America
3. Why does Victor agree? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He feels compassion and fear
4. What theme does the request highlight? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The need for companionship
5. What kind of moment is this in the plot? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A turning point bargain
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XVII” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The creature demands a female companion as wretched as himself, promising to withdraw to South America. Moved and afraid, Victor agrees.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XVII”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XVII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.” What does “insurmountable” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: insurmountable: impossible to overcome.
10. Reread: “This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede.”” What does “concede” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: concede: to grant; to give.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XVII” suggest about the demand for a companion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate.
2. Find one example of theme in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.
3. How does the characterization in this chapter shape what we understand about the demand for a companion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2): "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. On characterization: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins ““You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XVII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: The creature demands a female companion as wretched as himself, promising to withdraw to South America. Moved and afraid, Victor agrees.
6. How does “Chapter XVII” build on “Chapter XVI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The argument from isolation. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The wish to belong. On characterization: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “Is the creature's request fair? What risks does Victor consider?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does conflict appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2): "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. On conflict: Creator versus creation, argument versus revulsion. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Debates on whether humans have natural rights to companionship and happiness echo Enlightenment philosophy. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The argument from isolation. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “This bargain is the hinge of the plot; Victor's later choice will decide everyone's fate.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The wish to belong. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2): "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. On characterization: The creature demands a female companion and argues like a lawyer; Victor wavers between horror and pity. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XVII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the demand for a companion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The argument from isolation. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XVII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The wish to belong. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2): "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the theme in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The argument from isolation. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XVII” treats the demand for a companion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The wish to belong. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XVIII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 2): "Necessary": sympathy as a need like food. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the demand for a companion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “If I have no ties and no affections, hatred and vice must be my portion” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The argument from isolation. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The creature's demand rests on the novel's claim that companionship is a basic need. Useful evidence: “I shall feel the affections of a sensitive being, and become linked to the chain of existence and events, from which I am now excluded” (Chapter XVII, paragraph 14): The wish to belong. Theme link: the plea for a companion is the novel's most direct statement of the need for love. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Theme:** look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them
- Also notice **Conflict**: the forces, people or desires pulling against each other

Chapter quiz

1. What does the creature demand?
    A. A female companion
    B. Victor's death
    C. To live in Geneva
    D. Money
2. Where does he promise to go?
    A. London
    B. Italy
    C. The wilds of South America
    D. The North Pole

3. Why does Victor agree?
   A. He is bribed
   B. He feels compassion and fear
   C. Elizabeth asks him
   D. He is curious
4. What theme does the request highlight?
   A. The need for companionship
   B. Wealth
   C. Love of fame
   D. Religion
5. What kind of moment is this in the plot?
   A. An ending
   B. A flashback only
   C. A turning point bargain
   D. A comic interlude
6. In the line "But that cannot be; the human senses are insurmountable barriers to our union.", what does "insurmountable" most nearly mean?
   A. treated lightly; toyed with
   B. to grant; to give
   C. a person who cares for persons or property
   D. impossible to overcome
7. In the line "This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede."", what does "concede" most nearly mean?
   A. to grant; to give
   B. treated lightly; toyed with
   C. impossible to overcome
   D. a person who cares for persons or property

Answer key: 1. A (A female companion); 2. C (The wilds of South America); 3. B (He feels compassion and fear); 4. A (The need for companionship); 5. C (A turning point bargain); 6. D (impossible to overcome); 7. A (to grant; to give)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.2, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter XVII," how does Shelley show the demand for a companion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the theme you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XVII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the demand for a companion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the theme in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.2, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XVII develops the idea of the demand for a companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of theme and characterization shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its theme shape the reader's understanding of the demand for a companion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVII suggests about the demand for a companion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's theme and characterization), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.2, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses theme in Chapter XVII to complicate the reader's understanding of the demand for a companion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XVII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the demand for a companion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XVII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the demand for a companion follows or bends those conventions, using the theme as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVII and its treatment of the demand for a companion. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's theme and characterization, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVII as evidence for a larger claim about the demand for a companion in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the demand for a companion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I must not be trifled with: and I demand an answer.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "trifled" most nearly mean?

   A. a structure or object that impedes free movement
   B. treated lightly; toyed with
   C. be persistent, refuse to stop
   D. provide commentary for a film, for example

2. *"You must create a female for me, with whom I can live in the interchange of those sympathies necessary for my being. This you alone can do; and I demand it of you as a right which you must not refuse to concede."*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XVII"?

   A. Confrontation between creator and creation
   B. The wedding night and its catastrophe
   C. The demand for a companion
   D. Isolation in the north

SAT key: 1. B (treated lightly; toyed with); 2. C (The demand for a companion)

Lesson 25: Chapter XVIII

Focus: delay and dread

Teacher only · spoilers

Back in Geneva, Victor delays. His father asks whether he loves another; Victor agrees to marry Elizabeth after a trip to England, where he will secretly do his work. He travels with Clerval through Germany and down the Rhine.

Background: The Rhine was celebrated for picturesque castles and vineyards in Romantic travel writing.

Significance: Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because....
Prompt: How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: eradicating — removing completely; enfranchised — set free; sedulous — careful and persistent; meandering — winding; following a curving course; dilatory — slow; tending to delay.
Words: eradicating: removing completely · enfranchised: set free · sedulous: careful and persistent · meandering: winding; following a curving course · dilatory: slow; tending to delay

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
The Rhine was celebrated for picturesque castles and vineyards in Romantic travel writing. Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension. Conflict: Victor delays: fear of the creature's revenge against disgust at the work, while his father presses for marriage to Elizabeth. Characterization: Clerval, a lover of nature and poetry, contrasts with Victor's misery. Tone / mood: Dread pervades even beauty. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “waves, silent and listless. But the fresh air and bright sun seldom failed to restore me to some degree of composure; and” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19). Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. That is conflict at work: Victor delays: fear of the creature's revenge against disgust at the work, while his father presses for marriage to Elizabeth.

> *the “very poetry of nature* *(Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19). Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. That is conflict at work: Victor delays: fear of the creature's revenge against disgust at the work, while his father presses for marriage to Elizabeth.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Disappointed fiend" shows he expects revenge; "repugnance" (disgust) shows why he cannot work. Link: his secret keeps him from sharing the burden, so even beside Clerval he is alone. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. (Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.)

> *I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me* *(Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Disappointed fiend" shows he expects revenge; "repugnance" (disgust) shows why he cannot work. Link: his secret keeps him from sharing the burden, so even beside Clerval he is alone.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. (Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about delay and dread? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVIII develops the idea of delay and dread. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. When the text says "I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me" (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He fears "the vengeance of the disappointed fiend" but cannot overcome his "repugnance to the task," and so he drifts; by his own admission he becomes "the slave of my creature."

Task: Annotate the chapter for conflict, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about delay and dread? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XVIII develops the idea of delay and dread. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. When the text says "I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me" (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1), it shows this directly. He fears "the vengeance of the disappointed fiend" but cannot overcome his "repugnance to the task," and so he drifts; by his own admission he becomes "the slave of my creature."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point? Compare Victor's isolation to the creature's: which is chosen?

Anchor question: How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point?

Facilitation: Compare Victor's isolation to the creature's: which is chosen?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about delay and dread? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. ("I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me", Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about delay and dread? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. ("I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me", Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how conflict shapes delay and dread. Key takeaway: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** Victor delays: fear of the creature's revenge against disgust at the work, while his father presses for marriage to Elizabeth.
- **Characterization:** Clerval, a lover of nature and poetry, contrasts with Victor's misery.
- **Tone / mood:** Dread pervades even beauty.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “waves, silent and listless. But the fresh air and bright sun seldom failed to restore me to some degree of composure; and” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “the most perfect solitude. I passed whole days on the lake alone in a little boat, watching the clouds, and listening to” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1) Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay.
- “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19) Clerval's character; he loves nature directly.
- “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13) The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him.
Evidence: “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1)

Reasoning: He fears "the vengeance of the disappointed fiend" but cannot overcome his "repugnance to the task," and so he drifts; by his own admission he becomes "the slave of my creature."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
eradicating (verb)	removing completely	*My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my melancholy, which every now and then would return by fits, and with a devouring blackness overcast the approaching sunshine.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
enfranchised (verb)	set free	*For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
sedulous (adjective)	careful and persistent	*It had been her care which provided me a companion in Clerval—and yet a man is blind to a thousand minute circumstances, which call forth a woman's sedulous attention.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
meandering (adjective)	winding; following a curving course	*In one spot you view rugged hills, ruined castles overlooking tremendous precipices, with the dark Rhine rushing beneath; and, on the sudden turn of a promontory, flourishing vineyards, with green sloping banks, and a meandering river, and populous towns occupy the scene.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
dilatory (adjective)	slow; tending to delay	*The latter method of obtaining the desired intelligence was dilatory and unsatisfactory: besides, I had an insurmountable aversion to the idea of engaging myself in my loathsome task in my father's house, while in habits of familiar intercourse with those I loved.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inhabits (verb)	inhabit or live in; be an inhabitant of	*Oh, surely, the spirit that inhabits and guards this place has a soul more in harmony with man, than those who pile the glacier, or retire to the inaccessible peaks of the mountains of our own country."*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inroads (noun)	an encroachment or intrusion	*My journey had been my own suggestion, and Elizabeth, therefore, acquiesced: but she was filled with disquiet at the idea of my suffering, away from her, the inroads of misery and grief.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
harrowing (adjective)	deeply distressing	*I was aware also that I should often lose all self-command, all capacity of hiding the harrowing sensations that would possess me during the progress of my unearthly occupation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unexampled (adjective)	never seen before; unequaled	*Pardon this gush of sorrow; these ineffectual words are but a slight tribute to the unexampled worth of Henry, but they soothe my heart, overflowing with the anguish which his remembrance creates.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

variegated (adjective)	varied in color or appearance	*This part of the Rhine, indeed, presents a singularly variegated landscape.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why does Victor travel to England? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To create the female in secret
2. Who travels with him? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Clerval
3. What river do they travel along? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The Rhine
4. What does Victor's father want to know? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Whether Victor loves someone else
5. How is Clerval described in this chapter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Joyful and alive to nature
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XVIII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Back in Geneva, Victor delays. His father asks whether he loves another; Victor agrees to marry Elizabeth after a trip to England, where he will secretly do his work. He travels with Clerval through Germany and down the Rhine.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XVIII"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XVIII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my melancholy, which every now and then would return by fits, and with a devouring blackness…" What does "eradicating" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: eradicating: removing completely.
10. Reread: "For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I

might claim…" What does "enfranchised" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: enfranchised: set free.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XVIII" suggest about delay and dread? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the setting in this chapter shape what we understand about delay and dread? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: "I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me" (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1): Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins "To England, therefore, I was bound, and it was understood that my union with Elizabeth should take place immediately on my return.", why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in "Chapter XVIII", and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Back in Geneva, Victor delays. His father asks whether he loves another; Victor agrees to marry Elizabeth after a trip to England, where he will secretly do his work. He travels with Clerval through Germany and down the Rhine.
6. How does "Chapter XVIII" build on "Chapter XVII"? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: "the "very poetry of nature" (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19): Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: "I was the slave of my creature" (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13): The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX. On characterization: Clerval, a lover of nature and poetry, contrasts with Victor's misery.

Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does Clerval's attitude toward nature differ from Victor's at this point?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1): Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay. On characterization: Clerval, a lover of nature and poetry, contrasts with Victor's misery. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: The Rhine was celebrated for picturesque castles and vineyards in Romantic travel writing. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19): Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Clerval's joy in nature contrasts with Victor's dread, heightening tension.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13): The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1): Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay. On characterization: Clerval, a lover of nature and poetry, contrasts with Victor's misery. Credit any position

that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XVIII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about delay and dread? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19): Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XVIII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13): The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1): Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19): Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XVIII” treats delay and dread with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13): The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XIX” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I feared the vengeance of the disappointed fiend, yet I was unable to overcome my repugnance to the task which was enjoined me” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 1): Fear and disgust pull against each other: the source of his delay. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about delay and dread? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “the “very poetry of nature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 19): Clerval's character; he loves nature directly. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's delay comes from a conflict between fear and revulsion, and it hands the creature power over him. Useful evidence: “I was the slave of my creature” (Chapter XVIII, paragraph 13): The master has become the slave; a reversal the creature will state aloud in Chapter XX. Theme link: Victor feels "an insurmountable barrier" between himself and others. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Why does Victor travel to England?

   A. To meet Walton

   B. To study law

   C. To create the female in secret

   D. To visit his mother

2. Who travels with him?
   A. Justine
   B. Clerval
   C. Ernest
   D. Elizabeth
3. What river do they travel along?
   A. The Seine
   B. The Rhine
   C. The Danube
   D. The Thames
4. What does Victor's father want to know?
   A. Whether he is ill
   B. Where the creature is
   C. Whether Victor loves someone else
   D. If he needs money
5. How is Clerval described in this chapter?
   A. Gloomy
   B. Angry
   C. Ill
   D. Joyful and alive to nature
6. In the line "My father saw this change with pleasure, and he turned his thoughts towards the best method of eradicating the remains of my melancholy, which every now and then would return by fits, and with a devouring blackness overcast the approaching sunshine.", what does "eradicating" most nearly mean?
   A. careful and persistent
   B. removing completely
   C. set free
   D. winding; following a curving course
7. In the line "For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.", what does "enfranchised" most nearly mean?
   A. set free
   B. careful and persistent
   C. removing completely
   D. winding; following a curving course

Answer key: 1. C (To create the female in secret); 2. B (Clerval); 3. B (The Rhine); 4. C (Whether Victor loves someone else); 5. D (Joyful and alive to nature); 6. B (removing completely); 7. A (set free)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter XVIII," how does Shelley show delay and dread? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XVIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of delay and dread? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XVIII develops the idea of delay and dread. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XVIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of delay and dread. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XVIII suggests about delay and dread. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter XVIII to complicate the reader's understanding of delay and dread. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XVIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of delay and dread responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XVIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of delay and dread follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XVIII and its treatment of delay and dread. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XVIII as evidence for a larger claim about delay and dread in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XVIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of delay and dread. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *It had been her care which provided me a companion in Clerval—and yet a man is blind to a thousand minute circumstances, which call forth a woman's sedulous attention.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "sedulous" most nearly mean?

   A. careful and persistent

   B. varied in color or appearance

   C. never seen before; unequaled

   D. deeply distressing

2. *To England, therefore, I was bound, and it was understood that my union with Elizabeth should take place immediately on my return. My father's age rendered him extremely averse to delay. For myself, there was one reward I promised myself from my detested toils—one consolation for my unparalleled sufferings; it was the prospect of that day when, enfranchised from my miserable slavery, I might claim Elizabeth, and forget the past in my union with her.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XVIII"?

   A. Confrontation between creator and creation

   B. Delay and dread

   C. Confidence before danger

   D. Reading and identity

SAT key: 1. A (careful and persistent); 2. B (Delay and dread)

Lesson 26: Chapter XIX

Focus: isolation in the north

Teacher only · spoilers

In London, Oxford and later Scotland, Victor gathers knowledge, then leaves Clerval and goes alone to a remote Orkney island to build the female creature, working in misery.

Background: Oxford's association with the English Civil War and the poet-patriot John Hampden is mentioned.

Significance: The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why does Victor choose such a desolate place? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....
Prompt: Why does Victor choose such a desolate place?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: expedite — to speed up; to hasten; roarings — loud, deep sounds; debasing — degrading; lowering in dignity; oatmeal — porridge made of rolled oats; scraggy — being very thin.
Words: expedite: to speed up; to hasten · roarings: loud, deep sounds · debasing: degrading; lowering in dignity · oatmeal: porridge made of rolled oats · scraggy: being very thin

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Oxford's association with the English Civil War and the poet-patriot John Hampden is mentioned. The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation. Setting: The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind. Imagery: "I am a blasted tree": recalling the lightning-struck oak. Characterization: Victor works with sickened heart, unable to share his burden. Watch for sublime nature: Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: "and I, although I abhorred society, wished to view again mountains and streams, and all the wondrous works with which Nature adorns" (Chapter XIX, paragraph 4).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "my heart often sickened at the work of my hands" (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21). Revulsion at his labor. That is setting at work: The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind.

> *my heart often sickened at the work of my hands* (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "my heart often sickened at the work of my hands" (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21). Revulsion at his labor. That is setting at work: The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The blasted tree was destroyed by lightning; Victor is destroyed by his discovery. Symbol from Chapter II returns. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. (Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.)

> *I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul* (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The blasted tree was destroyed by lightning; Victor is destroyed by his discovery. Symbol from Chapter II returns.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. (Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for setting, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about isolation in the north? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIX develops the idea of isolation in the north. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. When the text says “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. He says his "heart often sickened at the work of my hands," a sharp contrast to the rapture of the first creation, which shows responsibility arriving too late.

Task: Annotate the chapter for setting, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about isolation in the north? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XIX develops the idea of isolation in the north. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. When the text says “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21), it shows this directly. He says his "heart often sickened at the work of my hands," a sharp contrast to the rapture of the first creation, which shows responsibility arriving too late.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why does Victor choose such a desolate place? Ask whether Victor has changed since Chapter IV. What evidence shows growth or its lack?

Anchor question: Why does Victor choose such a desolate place?

Facilitation: Ask whether Victor has changed since Chapter IV. What evidence shows growth or its lack?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about isolation in the north? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. (“my heart often sickened at the work of my hands”, Chapter XIX, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about isolation in the north? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. (“my heart often sickened at the work of my hands”, Chapter XIX, paragraph 21). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how setting shapes isolation in the north. Key takeaway: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Setting:** The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind.
- **Imagery:** "I am a blasted tree": recalling the lightning-struck oak.
- **Characterization:** Victor works with sickened heart, unable to share his burden.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last.

Symbols and motifs

- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “and I, although I abhorred society, wished to view again mountains and streams, and all the wondrous works with which Nature adorns” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 4).
- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: “for some time, and I feared the effects of the daemon’s disappointment. He might remain in Switzerland, and wreak his vengeance on” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 13).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8) Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak.
- “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21) Revulsion at his labor.
- “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20) The isolation of work.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences.
Evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21)
Reasoning: He says his "heart often sickened at the work of my hands," a sharp contrast to the rapture of the first creation, which shows responsibility arriving too late.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
expedite (verb)	to speed up; to hasten	*Sometimes I thought that the fiend followed me, and might expedite my remissness by murdering my companion.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
roarings (noun)	loud, deep sounds	*Its fair lakes reflect a blue and gentle sky; and, when troubled by the winds, their tumult is but as the play of a lively infant, when compared to the roarings of the giant ocean.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
debasing (adjective)	degrading; lowering in dignity	*For a moment my soul was elevated from its debasing and miserable fears, to contemplate the divine ideas of liberty and self-sacrifice, of which these sights were the monuments and the remembrancers.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
oatmeal (noun)	porridge made of rolled oats	*The soil was barren, scarcely affording pasture for a few miserable cows, and oatmeal for its inhabitants, which consisted of five persons, whose gaunt and scraggy limbs gave tokens of their miserable fare.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
scraggy (adjective)	being very thin	*The soil was barren, scarcely affording pasture for a few miserable cows, and oatmeal for its inhabitants, which consisted of five persons, whose gaunt and scraggy limbs gave tokens of their miserable fare.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
engages (verb)	holds (attention)	*His feelings are forever on the stretch; and when he begins to sink into repose, he finds himself obliged to quit that on which he rests in pleasure for something new, which again engages his attention, and which also he forsakes for other novelties.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
intermixed (verb)	combine into one	*I looked towards its completion with a tremulous and eager hope, which I dared not trust myself to question, but which was intermixed with obscure forebodings of evil, that made my heart sicken in my bosom.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
highlands (noun)	hilly or mountainous country	*I packed up my chemical instruments, and the materials I had collected, resolving to finish my labours in some obscure nook in the northern highlands of Scotland.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
forsakes (verb)	gives up; abandons	*His feelings are forever on the stretch; and when he begins to sink into repose, he finds himself obliged to quit that on which he rests in pleasure for something new, which again engages his attention, and which also he forsakes for other novelties.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
remonstrate (verb)	argue in protest or opposition	*Henry wished to dissuade me; but, seeing me bent on this plan, ceased to remonstrate.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Victor choose such a desolate place?
2. Where does setting appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does Victor work on the second creature? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A remote island in the Orkneys
2. Who does he leave behind? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Clerval
3. What is Victor's mood while working? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Miserable and filled with dread
4. Which English city prompts thoughts of history? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Oxford
5. What does the desolate setting mirror? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Victor's inner isolation
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XIX" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: In London, Oxford and later Scotland, Victor gathers knowledge, then leaves Clerval and goes alone to a remote Orkney island to build the female creature, working in misery.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XIX"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XIX" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "Sometimes I thought that the fiend followed me, and might expedite my remissness by murdering my companion." What does "expedite" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: expedite: to speed up; to hasten.
10. Reread: "Its fair lakes reflect a blue and gentle sky; and, when troubled by the winds, their tumult is but as the play of a lively infant, when compared to the roarings of the giant ocean." What does "roarings" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: roarings: loud, deep sounds.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XIX" suggest about isolation in the north? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation.
2. Find one example of setting in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

3. How does the tone / mood in this chapter shape what we understand about isolation in the north? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8): Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “We had arrived in England at the beginning of October, and it was now February.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XIX”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: In London, Oxford and later Scotland, Victor gathers knowledge, then leaves Clerval and goes alone to a remote Orkney island to build the female creature, working in misery.
6. How does “Chapter XIX” build on “Chapter XVIII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21): Revulsion at his labor. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20): The isolation of work. On characterization: Victor works with sickened heart, unable to share his burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Victor choose such a desolate place?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does foreshadowing appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8): Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Oxford's association with the English Civil War and the poet-patriot John Hampden is mentioned. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21): Revulsion at his labor. On setting: The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The bleak island mirrors Victor's isolation and moral desolation.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20): The isolation of work. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8): Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak. On characterization: Victor works with sickened heart, unable to share his burden. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XIX” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about isolation in the north? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21): Revulsion at his labor. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XIX”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20): The isolation of work. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8): Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the setting in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21): Revulsion at his labor. On setting: The remote Orkneys: bleak and barren, matching his work and mind. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XIX” treats isolation in the north with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20): The isolation of work. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XX” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “I am a blasted tree; the bolt has entered my soul” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 8): Metaphor tying his ruin to the blasted oak. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about isolation in the north? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “my heart often sickened at the work of my hands” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 21): Revulsion at his labor. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's second act of creation is joyless because he now sees its consequences. Useful evidence: “In this retreat I devoted the morning to labour” (Chapter XIX, paragraph 20): The isolation of work. Theme link: making a second being makes him think about consequences, at last. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Setting:** look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events

Chapter quiz

1. Where does Victor work on the second creature?
   A. London
   B. A remote island in the Orkneys
   C. Oxford
   D. Edinburgh University
2. Who does he leave behind?
   A. Clerval
   B. His father
   C. Walton
   D. Elizabeth
3. What is Victor's mood while working?
   A. Excited
   B. Hopeful
   C. Miserable and filled with dread
   D. Peaceful
4. Which English city prompts thoughts of history?
   A. Bath
   B. Oxford
   C. Bristol
   D. Manchester
5. What does the desolate setting mirror?
   A. The creature's joy
   B. Elizabeth's beauty
   C. Victor's inner isolation
   D. Clerval's happiness

6. In the line “Sometimes I thought that the fiend followed me, and might expedite my remissness by murdering my companion.”, what does “expedite” most nearly mean?
   A. degrading; lowering in dignity
   B. porridge made of rolled oats
   C. loud, deep sounds
   D. to speed up; to hasten
7. In the line “Its fair lakes reflect a blue and gentle sky; and, when troubled by the winds, their tumult is but as the play of a lively infant, when compared to the roarings of the giant ocean.”, what does “roarings” most nearly mean?
   A. porridge made of rolled oats
   B. degrading; lowering in dignity
   C. to speed up; to hasten
   D. loud, deep sounds

Answer key: 1. B (A remote island in the Orkneys); 2. A (Clerval); 3. C (Miserable and filled with dread); 4. B (Oxford); 5. C (Victor's inner isolation); 6. D (to speed up; to hasten); 7. D (loud, deep sounds)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XIX,” how does Shelley show isolation in the north? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the setting you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XIX, how does Shelley develop the idea of isolation in the north? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the setting in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XIX develops the idea of isolation in the north. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of setting and tone / mood shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XIX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its setting shape the reader's understanding of isolation in the north. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XIX suggests about isolation in the north. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's setting and tone / mood), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses setting in Chapter XIX to complicate the reader's understanding of isolation in the north.

Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XIX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of isolation in the north responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XIX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of isolation in the north follows or bends those conventions, using the setting as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XIX and its treatment of isolation in the north. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's setting and tone / mood, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XIX as evidence for a larger claim about isolation in the north in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XIX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of isolation in the north. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *For a moment my soul was elevated from its debasing and miserable fears, to contemplate the divine ideas of liberty and self-sacrifice, of which these sights were the monuments and the remembrancers.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “debasing” most nearly mean?

   A. degrading; lowering in dignity

   B. gives up; abandons

   C. argue in protest or opposition

   D. hilly or mountainous country

2. *We had arrived in England at the beginning of October, and it was now February. We accordingly determined to commence our journey towards the north at the expiration of another month. In this expedition we did not intend to follow the great road to Edinburgh, but to visit Windsor, Oxford, Matlock, and the Cumberland lakes, resolving to arrive at the completion of this tour about the end of July. I packed up my chemical instruments, and the materials I had collected, resolving to finish my labours in some obscure nook in the northern highlands of Scotland.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XIX"?

A. Learning compassion by watching

B. Isolation in the north

C. The final reckoning

D. Despair and the sublime

SAT key: 1. A (degrading; lowering in dignity); 2. B (Isolation in the north)

Lesson 27: Chapter XX

Focus: destroying the companion

Teacher only · spoilers

Fearing a 'race of devils,' Victor tears apart the half-finished female while the creature watches. The creature vows: 'I shall be with you on your wedding-night.' Victor rows out to sea to dump the remains, drifts, and lands in Ireland, where he is arrested for a murder.

Background: Fears of uncontrolled reproduction reflect debates sparked by Malthus on population.

Significance: Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides. Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....
Prompt: Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides.
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal?

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: specked — dotted; spotted; wiliness — cunning; craftiness; slenderly — only slightly; poorly; debility — the state of being weak in health or body (especially from old age); buffeted — struck again and again.
Words: specked: dotted; spotted · wiliness: cunning; craftiness · slenderly: only slightly; poorly · debility: the state of being weak in health or body (especially from old age) · buffeted: struck again and again

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Fears of uncontrolled reproduction reflect debates sparked by Malthus on population. Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic. Conflict: Victor destroys the female in front of the creature; the creature vows revenge. Foreshadowing: "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands. Characterization: Victor reasons about future generations (a "race of devils") for the first time, and acts. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "I sat one evening in my laboratory; the sun had set, and the moon was just rising from the sea" (Chapter XX, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2). Victor's fear of consequences. That is conflict at work: Victor destroys the female in front of the creature; the creature vows revenge.

> *a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth* *(Chapter XX, paragraph 2)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2). Victor's fear of consequences. That is conflict at work: Victor destroys the female in front of the creature; the creature vows revenge.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Look at the craft: "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? (The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.)

> *I shall be with you on your wedding night* *(Chapter XX, paragraph 15)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Look at the craft: "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? (The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for conflict, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about destroying the companion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XX develops the idea of destroying the companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. When the text says “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. He fears "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth," thinking of future people, yet he does it in front of the creature, who answers "I shall be with you on your wedding-night."

Task: Annotate the chapter for conflict, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about destroying the companion? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XX develops the idea of destroying the companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. When the text says “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2), it shows this directly. He fears "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth," thinking of future people, yet he does it in front of the creature, who answers "I shall be with you on your wedding-night."

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides. Debate whether destroying the female was right. Many students switch sides; ask what changed their mind.

Anchor question: Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides.

Facilitation: Debate whether destroying the female was right. Many students switch sides; ask what changed their mind.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about destroying the companion? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. ("a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth", Chapter XX, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about destroying the companion? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. ("a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth", Chapter XX, paragraph 2). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how conflict shapes destroying the companion. Key takeaway: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal?

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Conflict:** Victor destroys the female in front of the creature; the creature vows revenge.
- **Foreshadowing:** "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands.
- **Characterization:** Victor reasons about future generations (a "race of devils") for the first time, and acts.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal?

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "I sat one evening in my laboratory; the sun had set, and the moon was just rising from the sea" (Chapter XX, paragraph 1).
- **naming the creature:** Victor never names his creation; the words he uses (wretch, daemon, fiend, monster) show his rejection and shape the reader's view. In this chapter: "was engaged in the same manner, and had created a fiend whose unparalleled barbarity had desolated my heart, and filled it forever" (Chapter XX, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth" (Chapter XX, paragraph 2) Victor's fear of consequences.
- "I shall be with you on your wedding night" (Chapter XX, paragraph 15) The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself.
- "Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension" (Chapter XX, paragraph 11) The creature reverses the master-slave relationship.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise.
Evidence: "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth" (Chapter XX, paragraph 2)
Reasoning: He fears "a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth," thinking of future people, yet he does it in front of the creature, who answers "I shall be with you on your wedding-night."

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
specked (verb)	dotted; spotted	*A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
wiliness (noun)	cunning; craftiness	*I will watch with the wiliness of a snake, that I may sting with its venom.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
slenderly (adverb)	only slightly; poorly	*I had no compass with me, and was so slenderly acquainted with the geography of this part of the world, that the sun was of little benefit to me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
debility (noun)	the state of being weak in health or body (especially from old age)	*As I was in a state of extreme debility, I resolved to sail directly towards the town, as a place where I could most easily procure nourishment.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
buffeted (verb)	struck again and again	*I might be driven into the wide Atlantic, and feel all the tortures of starvation, or be swallowed up in the immeasurable waters that roared and buffeted around me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
paddling (verb)	propel with a paddle	*I felt the silence, although I was hardly conscious of its extreme profundity, until my ear was suddenly arrested by the paddling of oars near the shore, and a person landed close to my house.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
irresolution (noun)	doubt concerning two or more possible alternatives or courses of action	*"The hour of my irresolution is past, and the period of your power is arrived.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

construed (verb)	make sense of; assign a meaning to	*I was ready to sink from fatigue and hunger; but, being surrounded by a crowd, I thought it politic to rouse all my strength, that no physical debility might be construed into apprehension or conscious guilt.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
mutable (adjective)	capable of or tending to change in form or quality or nature	*How mutable are our feelings, and how strange is that clinging love we have of life even in the excess of misery!*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
loitered (verb)	lingered; hung about	*Yes, he had followed me in my travels; he had loitered in forests, hid himself in caves, or taken refuge in wide and desert heaths; and he now came to mark my progress, and claim the fulfilment of my promise.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides.
2. Where does conflict appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Why does Victor destroy the female? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He fears a race of devils
2. What does the creature threaten? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To be with Victor on his wedding night
3. Where does Victor land after drifting at sea? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Ireland
4. What happens when he lands? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He is arrested for murder
5. How might readers view his decision? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: As courage or as another abandonment
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XX” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Fearing a 'race of devils,' Victor tears apart the half-finished female while the creature watches. The creature vows: 'I shall be with you on your wedding-night.' Victor rows out to sea to dump the remains, drifts, and lands in Ireland, where he is arrested for a murder.

7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XX”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XX” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another.” What does “specked” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: specked: dotted; spotted.
10. Reread: “I will watch with the wiliness of a snake, that I may sting with its venom.” What does “wiliness” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: wiliness: cunning; craftiness.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XX” suggest about destroying the companion? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic.
2. Find one example of conflict in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other.
3. How does the foreshadowing in this chapter shape what we understand about destroying the companion? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2): Victor's fear of consequences. On foreshadowing: "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “I trembled, and my heart failed within me; when, on looking up, I saw, by the light of the moon, the daemon at the casement.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XX”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Fearing a 'race of devils,' Victor tears apart the half-finished female while the creature watches. The creature vows: 'I shall be with you on your wedding-night.' Victor rows out to sea to dump the remains, drifts, and lands in Ireland, where he is arrested for a murder.
6. How does “Chapter XX” build on “Chapter XIX”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XX, paragraph 15): The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension” (Chapter XX, paragraph 11): The creature reverses the master-slave relationship. On characterization: Victor reasons about future generations (a "race of devils") for the first time, and acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Was destroying the female the right choice? Argue both sides.” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the costs of unchecked ambition? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2): Victor's fear of consequences. On characterization: Victor reasons about future generations (a "race of devils") for the first time, and acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Fears of uncontrolled reproduction reflect debates sparked by Malthus on population. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XX, paragraph 15): The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Victor's choice can be read as moral courage or as a second abandonment—a rich debate topic.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension” (Chapter XX, paragraph 11): The creature reverses the master-slave relationship. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks

about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2): Victor's fear of consequences. On characterization: Victor reasons about future generations (a "race of devils") for the first time, and acts. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XX” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about destroying the companion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XX, paragraph 15): The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XX”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension” (Chapter XX, paragraph 11): The creature reverses the master-slave relationship. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to creation and responsibility: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2): Victor's fear of consequences. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the conflict in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XX, paragraph 15): The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. On conflict: Victor destroys the female in front of the creature; the creature vows revenge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XX” treats destroying the companion with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension” (Chapter XX, paragraph 11): The creature

reverses the master-slave relationship. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XXI” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “a race of devils would be propagated upon the earth” (Chapter XX, paragraph 2): Victor's fear of consequences. On foreshadowing: "I shall be with you on your wedding-night" is a threat Victor misunderstands. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about destroying the companion? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XX, paragraph 15): The key threat; Victor assumes it targets himself. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Destroying the female is the first time Victor thinks about consequences, but it also breaks his promise. Useful evidence: “Slave, I before reasoned with you, but you have proved yourself unworthy of my condescension” (Chapter XX, paragraph 11): The creature reverses the master-slave relationship. Theme link: is destroying the female responsible or another betrayal? Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Conflict:** look for the forces, people or desires pulling against each other (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Foreshadowing**: hints, warnings or images that point to later events
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Why does Victor destroy the female?

   A. He runs out of materials

   B. He fears a race of devils

   C. The creature asks him

   D. She is finished and dangerous

2. What does the creature threaten?
   A. To leave forever
   B. To kill Walton
   C. To be with Victor on his wedding night
   D. To burn Geneva
3. Where does Victor land after drifting at sea?
   A. Iceland
   B. France
   C. Ireland
   D. Norway
4. What happens when he lands?
   A. He marries
   B. He is welcomed
   C. He is arrested for murder
   D. He meets Walton
5. How might readers view his decision?
   A. As accidental
   B. As courage or as another abandonment
   C. As unimportant
   D. As purely comic
6. In the line "A few fishing vessels alone specked the water, and now and then the gentle breeze wafted the sound of voices, as the fishermen called to one another.", what does "specked" most nearly mean?
   A. the state of being weak in health or body (especially from old age)
   B. dotted; spotted
   C. only slightly; poorly
   D. cunning; craftiness
7. In the line "I will watch with the wiliness of a snake, that I may sting with its venom.", what does "wiliness" most nearly mean?
   A. only slightly; poorly
   B. cunning; craftiness
   C. dotted; spotted
   D. the state of being weak in health or body (especially from old age)

Answer key: 1. B (He fears a race of devils); 2. C (To be with Victor on his wedding night); 3. C (Ireland); 4. C (He is arrested for murder); 5. B (As courage or as another abandonment); 6. B (dotted; spotted); 7. B (cunning; craftiness)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter XX," how does Shelley show destroying the companion? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two

details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the conflict you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XX, how does Shelley develop the idea of destroying the companion? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the conflict in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.3, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XX develops the idea of destroying the companion. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of conflict and foreshadowing shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XX (where it begins, turns and ends) and its conflict shape the reader's understanding of destroying the companion. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XX suggests about destroying the companion. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's conflict and foreshadowing), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.3, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses conflict in Chapter XX to complicate the reader's understanding of destroying the companion. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XX within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of destroying the companion responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XX alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of destroying the companion follows or bends those conventions, using the conflict as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XX and its treatment of destroying the companion. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's conflict and foreshadowing, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XX as evidence for a larger claim about destroying the companion in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XX as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of destroying the companion. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *I had no compass with me, and was so slenderly acquainted with the geography of this part of the world, that the sun was of little benefit to me.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “slenderly” most nearly mean?

   A. only slightly; poorly

   B. capable of or tending to change in form or quality or nature

   C. lingered; hung about

   D. make sense of; assign a meaning to

2. *I trembled, and my heart failed within me; when, on looking up, I saw, by the light of the moon, the daemon at the casement. A ghastly grin wrinkled his lips as he gazed on me, where I sat fulfilling the task which he had allotted to me. Yes, he had followed me in my travels; he had loitered in forests, hid himself in caves, or taken refuge in wide and desert heaths; and he now came to mark my progress, and claim the fulfilment of my promise.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XX”?

   A. The meeting of two ambitious men

   B. The first death and growing guilt

   C. Destroying the companion

   D. The wedding night and its catastrophe

SAT key: 1. A (only slightly; poorly); 2. C (Destroying the companion)

Lesson 28: Chapter XXI

Focus: grief, prison and return

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor discovers the murdered man is Clerval. He falls into fever in prison for two months. Mr. Kirwin, the magistrate, is kind; his father arrives; Victor is acquitted and they return home.

Background: Grand juries and assizes were standard in British and Irish courts.

Significance: Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because....
Prompt: How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor calls himself the cause.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: turnkeys — jailers who keep the keys; gaolers — jailers (British spelling); assizes — regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971); vexations — annoyances; worries; retrospect — contemplation of things past.
Words: turnkeys: jailers who keep the keys · gaolers: jailers (British spelling) · assizes: regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971) · vexations: annoyances; worries · retrospect: contemplation of things past

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Grand juries and assizes were standard in British and Irish courts. Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past. Plot: Victor lands in Ireland, is accused of murder, and sees Clerval's body. Irony: Victor is accused of a murder he did cause indirectly. Characterization: Mr. Kirwin's kindness; Victor's collapse. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "His companions came up to assist him; and, by the light of their lantern, they found that he had fallen on the" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 2).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10). Physical collapse. That is plot at work: Victor lands in Ireland, is accused of murder, and sees Clerval's body.

> *The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured* (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10). Physical collapse. That is plot at work: Victor lands in Ireland, is accused of murder, and sees Clerval's body.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Murderous machinations" means his plots; he admits causing the death. This connects to responsibility. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Victor calls himself the cause. (Self-blame.)

> *Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life* (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Murderous machinations" means his plots; he admits causing the death. This connects to responsibility.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Victor calls himself the cause. (Self-blame.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for plot, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about grief, prison and return? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXI develops the idea of grief, prison and return. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. When the text says "Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9), it shows this directly. He asks whether his "murderous machinations" have killed Henry, naming his own schemes as the cause.
Task: Annotate the chapter for plot, irony (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about grief, prison and return? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXI develops the idea of grief, prison and return. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. When the text says "Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life" (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9), it shows this directly. He asks whether his "murderous machinations" have killed Henry, naming his own schemes as the cause.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's? Ask why Shelley has Victor accused of this particular murder.
Anchor question: How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's?
Facilitation: Ask why Shelley has Victor accused of this particular murder.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about grief, prison and return? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. ("Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life", Chapter XXI, paragraph 9). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about grief, prison and return? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. ("Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life", Chapter XXI, paragraph 9). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how plot shapes grief, prison and return. Key takeaway: Victor calls himself the cause.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Victor lands in Ireland, is accused of murder, and sees Clerval's body.
- **Irony:** Victor is accused of a murder he did cause indirectly.
- **Characterization:** Mr. Kirwin's kindness; Victor's collapse.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** Victor calls himself the cause.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “His companions came up to assist him; and, by the light of their lantern, they found that he had fallen on the” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 2).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “devouring maladie du pays, to see once more the blue lake and rapid Rhône, that had been so dear to me in” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 46).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9) Self-blame.
- “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10) Physical collapse.
- “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12) Despair.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words.
Evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9)
Reasoning: He asks whether his "murderous machinations" have killed Henry, naming his own schemes as the cause.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
turnkeys (noun)	jailers who keep the keys	*But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

gaolers (noun)	jailers (British spelling)	*But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
assizes (noun)	regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)	*The season of the assizes approached.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
vexations (noun)	annoyances; worries	*My father was enraptured on finding me freed from the vexations of a criminal charge, that I was again allowed to breathe the fresh atmosphere, and permitted to return to my native country.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
retrospect (noun)	contemplation of things past	*Kirwin said this, notwithstanding the agitation I endured on this retrospect of my sufferings, I also felt considerable surprise at the knowledge he seemed to possess concerning me.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
hangman (noun)	an executioner who hangs the condemned person	*Who could be interested in the fate of a murderer, but the hangman who would gain his fee?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
liberated (verb)	set free	*The grand jury rejected the bill, on its being proved that I was on the Orkney Islands at the hour the body of my friend was found; and a fortnight after my removal I was liberated from prison.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
residing (verb)	make one's home in a particular place or community	*I repassed, in my memory, my whole life; my quiet happiness while residing with my family in Geneva, the death of my mother, and my departure for Ingolstadt.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
laudanum (noun)	narcotic consisting of an alcohol solution of opium or any preparation in which opium is the main ingredient	*Ever since my recovery from the fever, I had been in the custom of taking every night a small quantity of laudanum; for it was by means of this drug only that I was enabled to gain the rest necessary for the preservation of life.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
decides (verb)	reach, make, or come to a decision about something	*I was spared the disgrace of appearing publicly as a criminal, as the case was not brought before the court that decides on life and death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's?
2. Where does irony appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with creation and responsibility?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1,

2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who is the murdered man? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Henry Clerval
2. How long does Victor lie ill in prison? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: About two months
3. Who is kind to Victor in Ireland? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Mr. Kirwin
4. Who comes to bring Victor home? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His father
5. What is ironic about Victor being accused? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He is guilty in a sense, though innocent of the act
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XXI" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Victor discovers the murdered man is Clerval. He falls into fever in prison for two months. Mr. Kirwin, the magistrate, is kind; his father arrives; Victor is acquitted and they return home.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XXI"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XXI" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon." What does "turnkeys" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: turnkeys: jailers who keep the keys.
10. Reread: "But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon." What does "gaolers" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: gaolers: jailers (British spelling).

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XXI" suggest about grief, prison and return? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past.
2. Find one example of irony in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the plot in this chapter shape what we understand about grief, prison and return? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for key events and the causes linking them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility

in his own words. Useful evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9): Self-blame. On plot: Victor lands in Ireland, is accused of murder, and sees Clerval's body. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the…”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.

5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XXI”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Victor discovers the murdered man is Clerval. He falls into fever in prison for two months. Mr. Kirwin, the magistrate, is kind; his father arrives; Victor is acquitted and they return home.

6. How does “Chapter XXI” build on “Chapter XX”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10): Physical collapse. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12): Despair. On characterization: Mr. Kirwin's kindness; Victor's collapse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does Clerval's death affect Victor differently from William's?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

9. Where does tone / mood appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with creation and responsibility? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Look for word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9): Self-blame. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Grand juries and assizes were standard in British and Irish courts. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10): Physical collapse. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any

position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Clerval's death destroys the last emblem of Victor's healthy past.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12): Despair. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9): Self-blame. On characterization: Mr. Kirwin's kindness; Victor's collapse. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XXI” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about grief, prison and return? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10): Physical collapse. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XXI”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12): Despair. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to isolation and the need for companionship: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9): Self-blame. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the irony in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10): Physical collapse. On irony: Victor is accused of a murder he did cause indirectly. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how “Chapter XXI” treats grief, prison and return with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12): Despair. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. Predict what “Chapter XXII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Have my murderous machinations deprived you also, my dearest Henry, of life” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 9): Self-blame. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about grief, prison and return? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “The human frame could no longer support the agonies that I endured” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 10): Physical collapse. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Clerval's murder makes Victor admit his responsibility in his own words. Useful evidence: “Why did I not die” (Chapter XXI, paragraph 12): Despair. Theme link: Victor calls himself the cause. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Plot**: key events and the causes linking them
- Also notice **Tone / mood**: word choices that reveal the narrator's attitude or the scene's feeling

Chapter quiz

1. Who is the murdered man?
    A. Felix
    B. Mr. Kirwin
    C. Henry Clerval
    D. William
2. How long does Victor lie ill in prison?
    A. One week
    B. About two months
    C. One day
    D. Five years
3. Who is kind to Victor in Ireland?
    A. Safie
    B. Mr. Kirwin
    C. Felix
    D. Krempe
4. Who comes to bring Victor home?
    A. Walton
    B. Elizabeth
    C. Ernest
    D. His father
5. What is ironic about Victor being accused?
    A. He was in Geneva
    B. He is guilty in a sense, though innocent of the act
    C. He confesses
    D. He likes jail
6. In the line "But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.", what does "turnkeys" most nearly mean?
    A. jailers (British spelling)
    B. jailers who keep the keys
    C. regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)
    D. annoyances; worries
7. In the line "But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon.", what does "gaolers" most nearly mean?
    A. annoyances; worries
    B. jailers who keep the keys
    C. jailers (British spelling)

D. regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)

Answer key: 1. C (Henry Clerval); 2. B (About two months); 3. B (Mr. Kirwin); 4. D (His father); 5. B (He is guilty in a sense, though innocent of the act); 6. B (jailers who keep the keys); 7. C (jailers (British spelling))

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In "Chapter XXI," how does Shelley show grief, prison and return? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XXI, how does Shelley develop the idea of grief, prison and return? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XXI develops the idea of grief, prison and return. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and plot shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXI (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of grief, prison and return. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXI suggests about grief, prison and return. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's irony and plot), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses irony in Chapter XXI to complicate the reader's understanding of grief, prison and return. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XXI within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of grief, prison and return responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XXI alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of grief, prison and return follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXI and its treatment of grief, prison and return. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's irony and plot, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXI as evidence for a larger claim about grief, prison and return in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXI as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of grief, prison and return. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *The season of the assizes approached.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “assizes” most nearly mean?

   A. narcotic consisting of an alcohol solution of opium or any preparation in which opium is the main ingredient

   B. regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)

   C. reach, make, or come to a decision about something

   D. make one's home in a particular place or community

2. *But I was doomed to live; and, in two months, found myself as awaking from a dream, in a prison, stretched on a wretched bed, surrounded by gaolers, turnkeys, bolts, and all the miserable apparatus of a dungeon. It was morning, I remember, when I thus awoke to understanding: I had forgotten the particulars of what had happened, and only felt as if some great misfortune had suddenly overwhelmed me; but when I looked around, and saw the barred windows, and the squalidness of the room in which I was, all flashed across my memory, and I groaned bitterly.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXI”?

   A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

   B. Grief, prison and return

   C. A privileged childhood and family love

   D. Injustice and exile

SAT key: 1. B (regular court sessions held in English counties (until 1971)); 2. B (Grief, prison and return)

Lesson 29: Chapter XXII

Focus: a letter, a secret and the wedding

Teacher only · spoilers

Victor recovers in Paris with his father, who takes his claim that he murdered William, Justine and Clerval as delirium. Elizabeth writes asking whether he loves someone else; Victor answers that he has one dreadful secret, which he will confide to her the day after their marriage. Remembering the creature's threat ("I will be with you on your wedding night"), he assumes he himself is the target and carries pistols and a dagger. Back in Geneva the wedding is fixed; after the ceremony the couple sail across the lake to spend the night at Evian, and the chapter ends as they near the shore at sunset.

Background: Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; the Frankensteins regain some of Elizabeth's inheritance.

Significance: Dramatic irony: readers can see that the threat may be aimed at Elizabeth, while Victor thinks only of his own danger.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to isolation and companionship because....
Prompt: Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to isolation and companionship because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: overtaxed — strained by asking too much of; unchained — set free from chains; released; obliterate — to erase completely; amphitheatre — a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater); playmate — a companion at play.
Words: overtaxed: strained by asking too much of · unchained: set free from chains; released · obliterate: to erase completely · amphitheatre: a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater) · playmate: a companion at play

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; the Frankensteins regain some of Elizabeth's inheritance. Dramatic irony: readers can see that the threat may be aimed at Elizabeth, while Victor thinks only of his own danger. Characterization: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret." Foreshadowing: He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth. Irony: The wedding is a step toward the catastrophe. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "I am not mad," I cried energetically; "the sun and the heavens, who have viewed my operations, can bear witness" (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Do you not love another" (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14). Elizabeth's honest question. That is characterization at work: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret."

> *Do you not love another* *(Chapter XXII, paragraph 14)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "Do you not love another" (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14). Elizabeth's honest question. That is characterization at work: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret."

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Look at the craft: He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth. Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship? Expected: Secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. (Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.)

> *I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations* *(Chapter XXII, paragraph 6)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Look at the craft: He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth.
Ask: How does this line connect to isolation and companionship?
Expected answer: Secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. (Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a letter, a secret and the wedding? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXII develops the idea of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. When the text says “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6), it shows this directly. He confesses only in riddles ("I am the assassin") and fixates on the creature's threat to himself, so the one person who loves him never learns the danger she is in.

Task: Annotate the chapter for characterization, foreshadowing (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about a letter, a secret and the wedding? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXII develops the idea of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

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70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him? Ask: would telling the truth have saved Elizabeth?

Anchor question: Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him?

Facilitation: Ask: would telling the truth have saved Elizabeth?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a letter, a secret and the wedding? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. (“I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations”, Chapter XXII, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about a letter, a secret and the wedding? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. (“I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations”, Chapter XXII, paragraph 6). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how characterization shapes a letter, a secret and the wedding. Key takeaway: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Characterization:** Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret."
- **Foreshadowing:** He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth.
- **Irony:** The wedding is a step toward the catastrophe.

Themes and how they develop

- **isolation and companionship:** secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “I am not mad,” I cried energetically; “the sun and the heavens, who have viewed my operations, can bear witness” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “had ever been since my journey to the sea of ice” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 8).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14) Elizabeth's honest question.
- “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6) Confession to his father, dismissed as madness.
- “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29) Repetition of the threat.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

> **Claim:** Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable.
> **Evidence:** “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6)
> **Reasoning:** He confesses only in riddles ("I am the assassin") and fixates on the creature's threat to himself, so the one person who loves him never learns the danger she is in.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word		In context	

	Definition (in this sentence)		Word history
overtaxed (verb)	strained by asking too much of	*I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
unchained (verb)	set free from chains; released	*I had unchained an enemy among them, whose joy it was to shed their blood, and to revel in their groans.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
obliterate (verb)	to erase completely	*He wished as much as possible to obliterate the memory of the scenes that had taken place in Ireland, and never alluded to them, or suffered me to speak of my misfortunes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
amphitheatre (noun)	a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)	*The Alps here come closer to the lake, and we approached the amphitheatre of mountains which forms its eastern boundary.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
playmate (noun)	a companion at play	*Victor, be assured that your cousin and playmate has too sincere a love for you not to be made miserable by this supposition.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
centred (verb)	focused; concentrated (British spelling)	*I said, "little happiness remains for us on earth; yet all that I may one day enjoy is centred in you.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
futility (noun)	uselessness as a consequence of having no practical result	*Sometimes he thought that I felt deeply the degradation of being obliged to answer a charge of murder, and he endeavoured to prove to me the futility of pride.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
penniless (adjective)	not having enough money to pay for necessities	*Alas! what freedom? such as the peasant enjoys when his family have been massacred before his eyes, his cottage burnt, his lands laid waste, and he is turned adrift, homeless, penniless, and alone, but free.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conduce (verb)	be conducive to	*I resolved, therefore, that if my immediate union with my cousin would conduce either to hers or my father's happiness, my adversary's designs against my life should not retard it a single hour.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
menaces (noun)	something that is a source of danger	*My destruction might indeed arrive a few months sooner; but if my torturer should suspect that I postponed it, influenced by his menaces, he would surely find other, and perhaps more dreadful means of revenge.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him?
2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Who travels with Victor to Paris and cares for him there? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His father
2. What does Victor promise to tell Elizabeth the day after the wedding? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: His dreadful secret
3. Whom does Victor believe the creature will attack on the wedding night? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Himself
4. How do Victor and Elizabeth travel after the ceremony? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: By boat across the lake to Evian
5. What does Victor carry to protect himself? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Pistols and a dagger
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XXII" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Victor recovers in Paris with his father, who takes his claim that he murdered William, Justine and Clerval as delirium. Elizabeth writes asking whether he loves someone else; Victor answers that he has one dreadful secret, which he will confide to her the day after their marriage. Remembering the creature's threat ("I will be with you on your wedding night"), he assumes he himself is the target…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XXII"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XXII" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey." What does "overtaxed" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: overtaxed: strained by asking too much of.
10. Reread: "I had unchained an enemy among them, whose joy it was to shed their blood, and to revel in their groans." What does "unchained" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: unchained: set free from chains; released.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XXII" suggest about a letter, a secret and the wedding? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Dramatic irony: readers can see that the threat may be aimed at Elizabeth, while Victor thinks only of his own danger.

2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about a letter, a secret and the wedding? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14): Elizabeth's honest question. On irony: The wedding is a step toward the catastrophe. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “My father yielded at length to my desire to avoid society, and strove by various arguments to banish my despair.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XXII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Victor recovers in Paris with his father, who takes his claim that he murdered William, Justine and Clerval as delirium. Elizabeth writes asking whether he loves someone else; Victor answers that he has one dreadful secret, which he will confide to her the day after their marriage. Remembering the…
6. How does “Chapter XXII” build on “Chapter XXI”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6): Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29): Repetition of the threat. On characterization: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why does Victor misread the creature's threat, and what does that reveal about him?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with isolation and the need for companionship? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14): Elizabeth's honest question. On

characterization: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. Background: Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; the Frankensteins regain some of Elizabeth's inheritance. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6): Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “Dramatic irony: readers can see that the threat may be aimed at Elizabeth, while Victor thinks only of his own danger.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29): Repetition of the threat. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14): Elizabeth's honest question. On characterization: Elizabeth's letter asks if he loves another; Victor hints at a "dreadful secret." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XXII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a letter, a secret and the wedding? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6): Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XXII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29): Repetition of the

threat. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to nature versus nurture: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14): Elizabeth's honest question. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6): Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. On foreshadowing: He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XXII” treats a letter, a secret and the wedding with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I shall be with you on your wedding night” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29): Repetition of the threat. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XXIII” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “Do you not love another” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 14): Elizabeth's honest question. On foreshadowing: He prepares to defend himself, not Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a letter, a secret and the wedding? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful evidence: “I am the assassin of those most innocent victims; they died by my machinations” (Chapter XXII, paragraph 6): Confession to his father, dismissed as madness. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Victor's secrecy leaves Elizabeth vulnerable. Useful

evidence: "I shall be with you on your wedding night" (Chapter XXII, paragraph 29): Repetition of the threat. Theme link: secrets poison his relationship with Elizabeth. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Who travels with Victor to Paris and cares for him there?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. His father
   C. Walton
   D. Clerval
2. What does Victor promise to tell Elizabeth the day after the wedding?
   A. The name of a rival
   B. His dreadful secret
   C. Why he left Ingolstadt
   D. Where he hid the journal
3. Whom does Victor believe the creature will attack on the wedding night?
   A. Elizabeth
   B. Himself
   C. Ernest
   D. His father
4. How do Victor and Elizabeth travel after the ceremony?
   A. On foot to Chamounix
   B. By boat across the lake to Evian
   C. By coach to Paris
   D. By ship to England
5. What does Victor carry to protect himself?
   A. A letter of safe conduct
   B. A sword
   C. Pistols and a dagger
   D. Nothing
6. In the line "I soon found that I had overtaxed my strength, and that I must repose before I could continue my journey.", what does "overtaxed" most nearly mean?
   A. to erase completely

B. strained by asking too much of

C. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)

D. set free from chains; released

7. In the line “I had unchained an enemy among them, whose joy it was to shed their blood, and to revel in their groans.”, what does “unchained” most nearly mean?

A. to erase completely

B. set free from chains; released

C. strained by asking too much of

D. a sloping gallery with seats for spectators (as in an operating room or theater)

Answer key: 1. B (His father); 2. B (His dreadful secret); 3. B (Himself); 4. B (By boat across the lake to Evian); 5. C (Pistols and a dagger); 6. B (strained by asking too much of); 7. B (set free from chains; released)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XXII,” how does Shelley show a letter, a secret and the wedding? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XXII, how does Shelley develop the idea of a letter, a secret and the wedding? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XXII develops the idea of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXII suggests about a letter, a secret and the wedding. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter XXII to complicate the reader's understanding of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XXII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of a letter, a secret and the wedding responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XXII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of a letter, a secret and the wedding follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXII and its treatment of a letter, a secret and the wedding. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXII as evidence for a larger claim about a letter, a secret and the wedding in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of a letter, a secret and the wedding. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *He wished as much as possible to obliterate the memory of the scenes that had taken place in Ireland, and never alluded to them, or suffered me to speak of my misfortunes.*

   As used in the text, what does the word “obliterate” most nearly mean?

   A. to erase completely

   B. something that is a source of danger

   C. be conducive to

   D. not having enough money to pay for necessities

2. *My father yielded at length to my desire to avoid society, and strove by various arguments to banish my despair. Sometimes he thought that I felt deeply the degradation of being obliged to answer a charge of murder, and he endeavoured to prove to me the futility of pride.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXII”?

   A. Injustice and exile

   B. The wedding night and its catastrophe

   C. A letter, a secret and the wedding

   D. First experiences of the senses

SAT key: 1. A (to erase completely); 2. C (A letter, a secret and the wedding)

Lesson 30: Chapter XXIII

Focus: the wedding night and its catastrophe

Content note (murder, grief): Elizabeth is murdered on her wedding night and Victor's father dies of grief. Allow students space; do not ask for vivid description.
Student preview: This chapter includes a murder and a death from grief.
Suggested language: "How does loss change Victor's purpose?"

Teacher only · spoilers

At the inn at Evian, Victor, pistol in hand, sends Elizabeth to bed while he searches the house; he then hears her scream and finds her murdered. He sees the creature grinning at the window and fires, but it escapes into the lake. Victor returns to Geneva, where his father dies of grief within days. Victor is confined for months as a madman; on release he tells his story to a Genevan magistrate, who listens with half-belief but doubts anything can be done, and Victor vows to pursue the creature himself.

Background: Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; after Victor's release his family's affairs are settled and he leaves Geneva for good.

Significance: The catastrophe Victor never foresaw shows how completely his self-absorption has blinded him; his loss turns him into the creature's pursuer.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to creation and responsibility because.... Content note before we start: This chapter includes a murder and a death from grief.
Prompt: How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to creation and responsibility because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor becomes the pursuer.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: deviating — turning aside; straying; inspecting — looking at closely; examining; intimidated — frightened; made fearful; seizure — capture; being taken by force; maddening — driving one wild.
Words: deviating: turning aside; straying · inspecting: looking at closely; examining · intimidated: frightened; made fearful · seizure: capture; being taken by force · maddening: driving one wild

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; after Victor's release his family's affairs are settled and he leaves Geneva for good. The catastrophe Victor never foresaw shows how completely his self-absorption has blinded him; his loss turns him into the creature's pursuer. Plot: Elizabeth's murder on the wedding night; the creature at the window; the father's death. Imagery: Elizabeth "thrown across the bed"; the creature's grin. Characterization: Victor dedicates himself to revenge. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "for a short time on the shore, enjoying the transitory light, and then retired to the inn, and contemplated the lovely scene" (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 1).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife" (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10). Mocking accusation. That is plot at work: Elizabeth's murder on the wedding night; the creature at the window; the father's death.

> *with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife* (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10)

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. "with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife" (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10). Mocking accusation. That is plot at work: Elizabeth's murder on the wedding night; the creature at the window; the father's death.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: "Lifeless" recalls the lifeless matter of creation: Victor's work turned into death. Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility? Expected: Victor becomes the pursuer. (Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.)

> *She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed* (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: "Lifeless" recalls the lifeless matter of creation: Victor's work turned into death.
Ask: How does this line connect to creation and responsibility?
Expected answer: Victor becomes the pursuer. (Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)

Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).

Annotate the chapter for plot, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the wedding night and its catastrophe? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXIII develops the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. When the text says "A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness" (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14), it shows this directly. He says "a fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness," the same hopeless isolation the creature described, and like the creature he turns to vengeance.

Task: Annotate the chapter for plot, imagery (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the wedding night and its catastrophe? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXIII develops the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)

Exemplar: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. When the text says "A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness" (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14), it shows this directly. He says "a fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness," the same hopeless isolation the creature described, and like the creature he turns to vengeance.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)

Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.

Anchor question: How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter? Ask: who is the monster now?

Anchor question: How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter?

Facilitation: Ask: who is the monster now?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)

Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).

Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the wedding night and its catastrophe? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. ("A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness", Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the wedding night and its catastrophe? Support it with one short quotation.

Answer: Model answer: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. ("A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness", Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

> **87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)**
> Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
> *Today we saw how plot shapes the wedding night and its catastrophe. Key takeaway: Victor becomes the pursuer.*

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Plot:** Elizabeth's murder on the wedding night; the creature at the window; the father's death.
- **Imagery:** Elizabeth "thrown across the bed"; the creature's grin.
- **Characterization:** Victor dedicates himself to revenge.

Themes and how they develop

- **creation and responsibility:** Victor becomes the pursuer.

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “for a short time on the shore, enjoying the transitory light, and then retired to the inn, and contemplated the lovely scene” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 1).
- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “inn, and contemplated the lovely scene of waters, woods, and mountains, obscured in darkness, yet still displaying their black outlines” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 1).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8) Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation.
- “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10) Mocking accusation.
- “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14) Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles.
Evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14)
Reasoning: He says "a fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness," the same hopeless isolation the creature described, and like the creature he turns to vengeance.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
deviating (verb)	turning aside; straying	*I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
inspecting (verb)	looking at closely; examining	*She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
intimidated (verb)	frightened; made fearful	*As I spoke, rage sparkled in my eyes; the magistrate was intimidated:—"You are mistaken," said he, "I will exert myself; and if it is in my power to seize the monster, be assured that he shall suffer punishment proportionate to his crimes.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
seizure (noun)	capture; being taken by force	*When I had concluded my narration, I said, "This is the being whom I accuse, and for whose seizure and punishment I call upon you to exert your whole power.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
maddening (adjective)	driving one wild	*I was possessed by a maddening rage when I thought of him, and desired and ardently prayed that I might have him within my grasp to wreak a great and signal revenge on his cursed head.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
auditor (noun)	someone who listens attentively	*This address caused a considerable change in the physiognomy of my own auditor.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tingling (verb)	prickling or stinging slightly	*As I heard it, the whole truth rushed into my mind, my arms dropped, the motion of every muscle and fibre was suspended; I could feel the blood trickling in my veins, and tingling in the extremities of my limbs.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
intervened (verb)	get involved, so as to alter or hinder an action, or through force or threat of force	*But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had intervened to prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
torrents (noun)	a heavy rain	*There were no horses to be procured, and I must return by the lake; but the wind was unfavourable, and the rain fell in torrents.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
conjured (verb)	summon into action or bring into existence, often as if by magic	*After passing several hours, we returned hopeless, most of my companions believing it to have been a form conjured up by my fancy.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter?

2. Where does foreshadowing appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with nature versus nurture?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. Where does Elizabeth's murder take place? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: At the inn at Evian
2. What does Victor see at the window after finding Elizabeth? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: The creature, grinning
3. How does Victor's father die? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Of grief, soon after the news
4. What happens to Victor after his father's death? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He is confined as a madman for months
5. How does the Genevan magistrate respond to Victor's story? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: With half-belief, doubting anything can be done
6. Retell the three most important events of “Chapter XXIII” in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: At the inn at Evian, Victor, pistol in hand, sends Elizabeth to bed while he searches the house; he then hears her scream and finds her murdered. He sees the creature grinning at the window and fires, but it escapes into the lake. Victor returns to Geneva, where his father dies of grief within days. Victor is confined for months as a madman; on release he tells his story to a Genevan magistrate,…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in “Chapter XXIII”? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does “Chapter XXIII” take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: “I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation.” What does “deviating” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: deviating: turning aside; straying.
10. Reread: “She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.” What does “inspecting” mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: inspecting: looking at closely; examining.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does “Chapter XXIII” suggest about the wedding night and its catastrophe? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The catastrophe Victor never foresaw shows how completely his self-absorption has blinded him; his loss turns him into the creature's pursuer.
2. Find one example of foreshadowing in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: Look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events.
3. How does the irony in this chapter shape what we understand about the wedding night and its catastrophe? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8): Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. In the passage that begins “She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XXIII”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: At the inn at Evian, Victor, pistol in hand, sends Elizabeth to bed while he searches the house; he then hears her scream and finds her murdered. He sees the creature grinning at the window and fires, but it escapes into the lake. Victor returns to Geneva, where his father dies of grief within…
6. How does “Chapter XXIII” build on “Chapter XXII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10): Mocking accusation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14): Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge. On characterization: Victor dedicates himself to revenge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “How does the wedding-night catastrophe change Victor from creator to hunter?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.

9. Where does characterization appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with nature versus nurture? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Look for what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8): Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation. On characterization: Victor dedicates himself to revenge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Weddings in this social class involved property arrangements; after Victor's release his family's affairs are settled and he leaves Geneva for good. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10): Mocking accusation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The catastrophe Victor never foresaw shows how completely his self-absorption has blinded him; his loss turns him into the creature's pursuer.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14): Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8): Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation. On characterization: Victor dedicates himself to revenge. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XXIII” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the wedding night and its catastrophe? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10): Mocking accusation. Theme link: Victor

becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XXIII”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14): Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

5. Connect this chapter to the sublime power of nature: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8): Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the foreshadowing in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10): Mocking accusation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XXIII” treats the wedding night and its catastrophe with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14): Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. Predict what “Chapter XXIV” will bring, using two clues from this chapter. After reading, evaluate your prediction. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “She was there, lifeless and inanimate, thrown across the bed” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 8): Echoes the "lifeless matter" of creation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the wedding night and its catastrophe? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “with his fiendish finger he pointed towards the corpse of my wife” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 10): Mocking accusation. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: Elizabeth's murder strips Victor of everything the creature lost, making creator and creation doubles. Useful evidence: “A fiend had snatched from me every hope of future happiness” (Chapter XXIII, paragraph 14): Total despair; in the next chapter it becomes a vow of revenge. Theme link: Victor becomes the pursuer. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Foreshadowing:** look for hints, warnings or images that point to later events (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true
- Also notice **Characterization**: what characters say, do and think, and how others react to them

Chapter quiz

1. Where does Elizabeth's murder take place?
   A. On the boat
   B. At the inn at Evian
   C. In Paris
   D. In Geneva
2. What does Victor see at the window after finding Elizabeth?
   A. The creature, grinning
   B. Clerval's ghost
   C. A magistrate
   D. His father
3. How does Victor's father die?
   A. At sea
   B. Murdered by the creature
   C. Of grief, soon after the news
   D. In a duel
4. What happens to Victor after his father's death?
   A. He marries again

B. He is confined as a madman for months

C. He is tried for murder

D. He sails to the Arctic at once

5. How does the Genevan magistrate respond to Victor's story?

A. With half-belief, doubting anything can be done

B. With laughter

C. With full belief and action

D. By arresting Victor

6. In the line “I now related my history, briefly, but with firmness and precision, marking the dates with accuracy, and never deviating into invective or exclamation.”, what does “deviating” most nearly mean?

A. turning aside; straying

B. frightened; made fearful

C. capture; being taken by force

D. looking at closely; examining

7. In the line “She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary.”, what does “inspecting” most nearly mean?

A. frightened; made fearful

B. turning aside; straying

C. capture; being taken by force

D. looking at closely; examining

Answer key: 1. B (At the inn at Evian); 2. A (The creature, grinning); 3. C (Of grief, soon after the news); 4. B (He is confined as a madman for months); 5. A (With half-belief, doubting anything can be done); 6. A (turning aside; straying); 7. D (looking at closely; examining)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.3, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XXIII,” how does Shelley show the wedding night and its catastrophe? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the foreshadowing you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XXIII, how does Shelley develop the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the foreshadowing in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.5, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XXIII develops the idea of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of foreshadowing and irony shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXIII (where it begins, turns and ends) and its foreshadowing shape the reader's understanding of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXIII suggests about the wedding night and its catastrophe. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's foreshadowing and irony), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses foreshadowing in Chapter XXIII to complicate the reader's understanding of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XXIII within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the wedding night and its catastrophe responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XXIII alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the wedding night and its catastrophe follows or bends those conventions, using the foreshadowing as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXIII and its treatment of the wedding night and its catastrophe. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's foreshadowing and irony, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXIII as evidence for a larger claim about the wedding night and its catastrophe in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXIII as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the wedding night and its catastrophe. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *As I spoke, rage sparkled in my eyes; the magistrate was intimidated:—"You are mistaken," said he, "I will exert myself; and if it is in my power to seize the monster, be assured that he shall suffer punishment proportionate to his crimes.*

As used in the text, what does the word "intimidated" most nearly mean?

A. frightened; made fearful

B. a heavy rain

C. summon into action or bring into existence, often as if by magic

D. get involved, so as to alter or hinder an action, or through force or threat of force

2. *She left me, and I continued some time walking up and down the passages of the house, and inspecting every corner that might afford a retreat to my adversary. But I discovered no trace of him, and was beginning to conjecture that some fortunate chance had intervened to prevent the execution of his menaces; when suddenly I heard a shrill and dreadful scream. It came from the room into which Elizabeth had retired. As I heard it, the whole truth rushed into my mind, my arms dropped, the motion of every muscle and fibre was suspended; I could feel the blood trickling in my veins, and tingling in the extremities of my limbs. This state lasted but for an instant; the scream was repeated, and I rushed into the room.*

Which choice best states a central concern of "Chapter XXIII"?

A. Loneliness and the desire for a friend

B. First experiences of the senses

C. Delay and dread

D. The wedding night and its catastrophe

SAT key: 1. A (frightened; made fearful); 2. D (The wedding night and its catastrophe)

Lesson 31: Chapter XXIV

Focus: the final reckoning

Content note (suicide (planned self-destruction), the word "abortion"): The creature vows to destroy himself on a funeral pyre, and calls himself "an abortion" (meaning a failed or monstrous creation). Use the safe-messaging script; the word is not on the vocabulary list.
Student preview: The ending includes a character planning to end his own life. Support is available if this is hard to read.
Suggested language: "What does the creature's final speech claim about responsibility?"
Safe messaging: Discuss the character's despair and what the text does with it; do not dwell on methods. Before the lesson, remind students that support is available and how to reach the counselor. Check in privately with any student who seems affected and follow your school's referral protocol. **Share with students:** If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today. Let a counselor know in advance that this chapter is being taught.

Teacher only · spoilers

Walton resumes writing. The ice traps the ship; the crew demands to turn south, and Walton yields. Victor dies. The creature appears over his body, mourns, condemns himself, and vows to destroy himself on a funeral pyre before vanishing into darkness.

Background: Walton's choice to return is a moral decision, contrasting with Victor's refusal to stop.

Significance: The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to ambition and knowledge because.... Content note before we start: The ending includes a character planning to end his own life. Support is available if this is hard to read. If you or someone you know is struggling or thinking about suicide, call or text 988 (Suicide & Crisis Lifeline, U.S.) or talk with a school counselor today.
Prompt: Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to ambition and knowledge because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition."

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: curdles — thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold; disencumbered — freed from a burden; execrate — to curse; to hate; congeal — to thicken or freeze (here, with horror); glimmers — shines faintly. “curdles”: Frequentative of curd (v.) "to form curds"; English, not from Latin cura.
Words: curdles: thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold · disencumbered: freed from a burden · execrate: to curse; to hate · congeal: to thicken or freeze (here, with horror) · glimmers: shines faintly

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Walton's choice to return is a moral decision, contrasting with Victor's refusal to stop. The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word. Structure: The frame closes: Walton's letters resume; the creature appears over Victor's body. Characterization: The creature's final speech mixes grief and self-hatred. Setting: The Arctic ice traps the ship; the crew demands return. Watch for light and fire: Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: “to execute this dear revenge, will I again behold the sun, and tread the green herbage of earth, which otherwise should vanish” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 5).

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57). Victor's lesson; partly retracted. That is structure at work: The frame closes: Walton's letters resume; the creature appears over Victor's body.

> *Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition* *(Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57)*

Think-aloud: I read the line once for meaning and once for craft. “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57). Victor's lesson; partly retracted. That is structure at work: The frame closes: Walton's letters resume; the creature appears over Victor's body.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: The ending is open: we don't see the creature die. The darkness echoes the novel's theme of the unknown. Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge? Expected: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." (The ending: ambiguous death.)

> *He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75)*

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: The ending is open: we don't see the creature die. The darkness echoes the novel's theme of the unknown.
Ask: How does this line connect to ambition and knowledge?
Expected answer: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." (The ending: ambiguous death.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the final reckoning? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXIV develops the idea of the final reckoning. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. When the text says “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75), it shows this directly. Victor advises "seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition" yet adds that another may succeed; the creature disappears into "darkness and distance," leaving judgment open.
Task: Annotate the chapter for structure, characterization (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this chapter suggest about the final reckoning? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how Chapter XXIV develops the idea of the final reckoning. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. When the text says “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75), it shows this directly. Victor advises "seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition" yet adds that another may succeed; the creature disappears into "darkness and distance," leaving judgment open.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it? Ask: does Walton learn the lesson? Point to his decision to turn back.
Anchor question: Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it?
Facilitation: Ask: does Walton learn the lesson? Point to his decision to turn back.

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Chapter quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Chapter quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the final reckoning? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. ("He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance", Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this chapter suggest about the final reckoning? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. ("He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance", Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the chapter; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how structure shapes the final reckoning. Key takeaway: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition."

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Structure:** The frame closes: Walton's letters resume; the creature appears over Victor's body.
- **Characterization:** The creature's final speech mixes grief and self-hatred.
- **Setting:** The Arctic ice traps the ship; the crew demands return.

Themes and how they develop

- **ambition and knowledge:** Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition."

Symbols and motifs

- **light and fire:** Light stands for knowledge and fire for its double edge: warmth and burning. Victor seeks the "light" of discovery; the creature discovers fire and is burned by it. In this chapter: "to execute this dear revenge, will I again behold the sun, and tread the green herbage of earth, which otherwise should vanish" (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 5).

- **sublime nature:** Mountains, glaciers, storms and lakes reflect and sometimes soothe the characters' feelings; the sublime is both comfort and terror. In this chapter: “laugh. It rung on my ears long and heavily; the mountains reechoed it, and I felt as if all hell surrounded me” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 7).

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57) Victor's lesson; partly retracted.
- “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75) The ending: ambiguous death.
- “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74) The creature's longing for release.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief.
Evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75)
Reasoning: Victor advises "seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition" yet adds that another may succeed; the creature disappears into "darkness and distance," leaving judgment open.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
curdles (verb)	thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold	*You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?*	“curdles”: Frequentative of curd (v.) "to form curds"; English, not from Latin cura. (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/curdle)
disencumbered (verb)	freed from a burden	*But this was not the time for delay: I disencumbered the dogs of their dead companion, gave them a plentiful portion of food; and, after an hour's rest, which was absolutely necessary, and yet which was bitterly irksome to me, I continued my route.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
execrate (verb)	to curse; to hate	*Why do you not execrate the rustic who sought to destroy the saviour of his child?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
congeal (verb)	to thicken or freeze (here, with horror)	*You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

glimmers (verb)	shines faintly	*Frankenstein has daily declined in health: a feverish fire still glimmers in his eyes; but he is exhausted, and, when suddenly roused to any exertion, he speedily sinks again into apparent lifelessness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
scaring (adjective)	frightening	*I approached this tremendous being; I dared not again raise my eyes to his face, there was something so scaring and unearthly in his ugliness.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
tardily (adverb)	slowly; late	*You will find near this place, if you follow not too tardily, a dead hare; eat, and be refreshed.*	"tardily": tardy + -ly; tardy is from Old French tardif, from Latin tardus "slow." (Not from ardere "to burn.") (Online Etymology Dictionary, https://www.etymonline.com/word/tardy)
composes (verb)	calms; settles	*Oh, no! the only joy that he can now know will be when he composes his shattered spirit to peace and death.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
modulated (verb)	adjusted in tone	*He spoke this with a voice so modulated to the different feelings expressed in his speech, with an eye so full of lofty design and heroism, that can you wonder that these men were moved?*	Student look-up (not yet verified)
participated (verb)	shared with others	*When I first sought it, it was the love of virtue, the feelings of happiness and affection with which my whole being overflowed, that I wished to be participated.*	Student look-up (not yet verified)

Discussion questions

1. Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it?
2. Where does point of view appear in this chapter, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this chapter connect to the book's larger concern with the sublime power of nature?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Middle School: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16, 17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What do Walton's crew demand? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: To turn back south
2. How does Walton respond? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He agrees to return
3. What happens to Victor? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: He dies on the ship
4. What does the creature plan to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Destroy himself on a funeral pyre
5. Whose voice ends the story? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Walton's, recording the creature's departure
6. Retell the three most important events of "Chapter XXIV" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Walton resumes writing. The ice traps the ship; the crew demands to turn south, and Walton yields. Victor dies. The creature appears over his body, mourns, condemns himself, and vows to destroy himself on a funeral pyre before vanishing into darkness.
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "Chapter XXIV"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: Names and actions taken from the chapter; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "Chapter XXIV" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the chapter.
9. Reread: "You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?" What does "curdles" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: curdles: thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold.
10. Reread: "But this was not the time for delay: I disencumbered the dogs of their dead companion, gave them a plentiful portion of food; and, after an hour's rest, which was absolutely necessary, and yet which was bitterly irksome…" What does "disencumbered" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · RL.7.1, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.1] Look for: disencumbered: freed from a burden.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "Chapter XXIV" suggest about the final reckoning? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word.
2. Find one example of point of view in this chapter. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know.
3. How does the theme in this chapter shape what we understand about the final reckoning? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Look for statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: "Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition" (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57): Victor's lesson; partly retracted. Theme link: Victor's final

advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “What his feelings were whom I pursued I cannot know.”, why might Shelley have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.4, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.4] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “Chapter XXIV”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: Walton resumes writing. The ice traps the ship; the crew demands to turn south, and Walton yields. Victor dies. The creature appears over his body, mourns, condemns himself, and vows to destroy himself on a funeral pyre before vanishing into darkness.
6. How does “Chapter XXIV” build on “Chapter XXIII”? Name one link of cause and effect. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous chapter.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75): The ending: ambiguous death. On structure: The frame closes: Walton's letters resume; the creature appears over Victor's body. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74): The creature's longing for release. On characterization: The creature's final speech mixes grief and self-hatred. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Does Walton learn from Victor? What evidence shows it?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does irony appear, and how does it connect this chapter to the larger concern with the sublime power of nature? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57): Victor's lesson; partly retracted. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Walton's choice to return is a moral decision, contrasting with Victor's refusal to stop. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the chapter? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75): The ending: ambiguous death.

On setting: The Arctic ice traps the ship; the crew demands return. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: “The ending lets Walton learn the lesson, while the creature's final speech gives him the last eloquent word.” How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the chapter. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74): The creature's longing for release. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this chapter acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.3] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57): Victor's lesson; partly retracted. On characterization: The creature's final speech mixes grief and self-hatred. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of “Chapter XXIV” from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about the final reckoning? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75): The ending: ambiguous death. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about “Chapter XXIV”: one recall, one “why/how”, and one “should/what if”. Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74): The creature's longing for release. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this chapter to the costs of unchecked ambition: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Shelley need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and

avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57): Victor's lesson; partly retracted. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the point of view in this chapter effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · RL.7.6, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.6] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75): The ending: ambiguous death. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

7. Compare how “Chapter XXIV” treats the final reckoning with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does Frankenstein see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74): The creature's longing for release. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

8. As the final chapter, does this ending resolve the sublime power of nature? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.3, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.5] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “Seek happiness in tranquillity, and avoid ambition” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 57): Victor's lesson; partly retracted. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this chapter (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about the final reckoning? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “He was soon borne away by the waves, and lost in darkness and distance” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 75): The ending: ambiguous death. Theme link: Victor's final advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

10. What question would you most like to ask Mary Shelley about this chapter, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · RL.7.2, SL.7.1, RL.9-10.2] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: The ending leaves the reader to judge, with Victor's lesson undercut by his doubt and the creature's grief. Useful evidence: “I shall die, and what I now feel be no longer felt” (Chapter XXIV, paragraph 74): The creature's longing for release. Theme link: Victor's final

advice: "Seek happiness in tranquillity and avoid ambition." Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Point of view:** look for who is telling the story and what that narrator can and cannot know (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Theme**: statements or moments that connect to the book's big ideas
- Also notice **Irony**: gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true

Chapter quiz

1. What do Walton's crew demand?
   A. More pay
   B. To find the creature
   C. To turn back south
   D. To land in Russia
2. How does Walton respond?
   A. He punishes them
   B. He leaves the ship
   C. He agrees to return
   D. He refuses
3. What happens to Victor?
   A. He returns to Geneva
   B. He marries again
   C. He kills the creature
   D. He dies on the ship
4. What does the creature plan to do?
   A. Destroy himself on a funeral pyre
   B. Rule the Arctic
   C. Create a mate
   D. Go to London
5. Whose voice ends the story?
   A. Elizabeth's
   B. Victor's
   C. Clerval's
   D. Walton's, recording the creature's departure
6. In the line “You have read this strange and terrific story, Margaret; and do you not feel your blood congeal with horror, like that which even now curdles mine?”, what does “curdles” most nearly mean?
   A. to thicken or freeze (here, with horror)
   B. thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold

C. freed from a burden

D. to curse; to hate

7. In the line “But this was not the time for delay: I disencumbered the dogs of their dead companion, gave them a plentiful portion of food; and, after an hour’s rest, which was absolutely necessary, and yet which was bitterly irksome to me, I continued my route.”, what does “disencumbered” most nearly mean?

A. to curse; to hate

B. to thicken or freeze (here, with horror)

C. thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold

D. freed from a burden

Answer key: 1. C (To turn back south); 2. C (He agrees to return); 3. D (He dies on the ship); 4. A (Destroy himself on a funeral pyre); 5. D (Walton's, recording the creature's departure); 6. B (thickens with horror (of blood); turns cold); 7. D (freed from a burden)

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Middle School (250 words; Common Core: RL.7.6, W.7.1): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track; this novel is above the grades 6–8 complexity band, so work from the passage your teacher selects). In “Chapter XXIV,” how does Shelley show the final reckoning? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the point of view you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): In Chapter XXIV, how does Shelley develop the idea of the final reckoning? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the point of view in the chapter helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; Common Core: RL.9-10.6, W.9-10.1): Analyze how Chapter XXIV develops the idea of the final reckoning. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of point of view and theme shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.5, RL.11-12.1, W.11-12.1): Analyze how the structure of Chapter XXIV (where it begins, turns and ends) and its point of view shape the reader's understanding of the final reckoning. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Two readers disagree about what Chapter XXIV suggests about the final reckoning. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the chapter's point of view and theme), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; Common Core: RL.11-12.6, W.11-12.1): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how Mary Shelley uses point of view in Chapter XXIV to complicate the reader's understanding of the final reckoning. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.3, ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.1): Situate Chapter XXIV within its historical and literary context and argue how the chapter's treatment of the final reckoning responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-LIT-1, LeL-C2-W-1): Read Chapter XXIV alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the chapter's handling of the final reckoning follows or bends those conventions, using the point of view as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-LIT-1, LeL-C3-W-1): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to Chapter XXIV and its treatment of the final reckoning. State your method, show what it reveals in the chapter's point of view and theme, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-LIT-1, LeL-C4-W-1): Develop a research argument that reads Chapter XXIV as evidence for a larger claim about the final reckoning in Frankenstein. Connect close reading of the chapter to the whole novel, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-LIT-1, LeL-GR-W-1): Develop an original argument that reads Chapter XXIV as a hinge in the novel's larger treatment of the final reckoning. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on Frankenstein.

SAT-style questions

1. *Why do you not execrate the rustic who sought to destroy the saviour of his child?*

   As used in the text, what does the word “execrate” most nearly mean?

   A. shared with others

   B. to curse; to hate

   C. adjusted in tone

   D. calms; settles

2. *What his feelings were whom I pursued I cannot know. Sometimes, indeed, he left marks in writing on the barks of the trees, or cut in stone, that guided me, and instigated my fury. “My reign is not yet over,” (these words were legible in one of these inscriptions;) “you live, and my power is complete. Follow me; I seek the everlasting ices of the north, where you will feel the misery of cold and frost, to which I am impassive. You will find near this place, if you follow not too tardily, a dead hare; eat, and be refreshed. Come on, my enemy; we have yet to wrestle for our lives; but many hard and miserable hours must you endure until that period shall arrive.”*

   Which choice best states a central concern of “Chapter XXIV”?

   A. Reading and identity

   B. A privileged childhood and family love

C. Horror at the moment of creation

D. The final reckoning

SAT key: 1. B (to curse; to hate); 2. D (The final reckoning)

Whole-book test

Frankenstein: whole-book test · 90 minutes

Part I: Multiple choice

1. Where was Shelley staying when the ghost-story contest began?
   A. In London
   B. In Venice
   C. On a ship to the Arctic
   D. Near Geneva, Switzerland
2. Which scientist does the Preface mention as having supposed the event possible?
   A. Isaac Newton
   B. Galileo
   C. Humphry Davy
   D. Dr. Darwin
3. To whom is Walton writing?
   A. His sister, Margaret Saville
   B. Victor Frankenstein
   C. A ship's captain
   D. His father
4. What does Walton say he lacks most?
   A. A friend who shares his feelings
   B. A ship
   C. Money for the voyage
   D. Maps of the Arctic
5. How does Walton feel in Letter III?
   A. Ill and weak
   B. Confident and determined
   C. Ready to turn back
   D. Terrified
6. What does the crew first see on the ice?
   A. A polar bear
   B. A lost ship
   C. A gigantic figure on a dog sled
   D. A fire
7. Where is Victor's family from?
   A. Paris

B. Naples

C. London

D. Geneva

8. Which author first fascinates Victor?

A. Cornelius Agrippa

B. Homer

C. Isaac Newton

D. Shakespeare

9. How does Victor's mother die?

A. A carriage accident

B. Drowning

C. Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth

D. Old age

10. What does Victor discover?

A. A route to the pole

B. A cure for fever

C. A new planet

D. The cause of generation and life

11. What month does the creature come to life?

A. March

B. December

C. November

D. June

12. Who writes to Victor during his recovery?

A. Walton

B. His mother

C. Krempe

D. Elizabeth

13. Who has been murdered?

A. Alphonse

B. Elizabeth

C. Clerval

D. William, Victor's youngest brother

14. What happens at Justine's trial?

A. She is freed

B. She escapes

C. She is convicted and condemned

D. The trial is cancelled

15. What does Victor's despair lead him to contemplate?
    A. Ending his own life
    B. Becoming a monk
    C. Marrying at once
    D. Moving to England
16. Where does Victor meet the creature?
    A. In Geneva
    B. In a church
    C. On the glacier at Montanvert
    D. On Walton's ship
17. Who narrates this chapter?
    A. Elizabeth
    B. Walton
    C. The creature
    D. Victor
18. Whom does the creature observe?
    A. Villagers in Geneva
    B. The Frankensteins
    C. The De Lacey family
    D. Walton's crew
19. Who arrives at the cottage?
    A. Safie
    B. Elizabeth
    C. Clerval
    D. Justine
20. Why were the De Laceys exiled?
    A. They were scientists
    B. They stole money
    C. Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape
    D. They insulted the king
21. Which book is NOT among those he finds?
    A. Robinson Crusoe
    B. Paradise Lost
    C. The Sorrows of Young Werther
    D. Plutarch's Lives
22. Where does the creature travel after the De Laceys leave?
    A. To Ingolstadt
    B. To London
    C. Toward Geneva

D. To the North Pole

23. What does the creature demand?
    A. A female companion
    B. Victor's death
    C. To live in Geneva
    D. Money
24. Why does Victor travel to England?
    A. To meet Walton
    B. To study law
    C. To create the female in secret
    D. To visit his mother
25. Where does Victor work on the second creature?
    A. London
    B. A remote island in the Orkneys
    C. Oxford
    D. Edinburgh University
26. Why does Victor destroy the female?
    A. He runs out of materials
    B. He fears a race of devils
    C. The creature asks him
    D. She is finished and dangerous
27. Who is the murdered man?
    A. Felix
    B. Mr. Kirwin
    C. Henry Clerval
    D. William
28. Who travels with Victor to Paris and cares for him there?
    A. Elizabeth
    B. His father
    C. Walton
    D. Clerval
29. Where does Elizabeth's murder take place?
    A. On the boat
    B. At the inn at Evian
    C. In Paris
    D. In Geneva
30. What do Walton's crew demand?
    A. More pay
    B. To find the creature

C. To turn back south

D. To land in Russia

Part II: Short answer

1. Explain how the costs of unchecked ambition develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
2. Explain how creation and responsibility develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.
3. Explain how isolation and the need for companionship develops from the beginning of the novel to the end. Use two chapters.

Part III: Essay

Choose one of the novel's central concerns (the costs of unchecked ambition, creation and responsibility, isolation and the need for companionship, nature versus nurture, the sublime power of nature) and argue how the ending reframes it.

Answer key

Answer key: 1. D (Near Geneva, Switzerland); 2. D (Dr. Darwin); 3. A (His sister, Margaret Saville); 4. A (A friend who shares his feelings); 5. B (Confident and determined); 6. C (A gigantic figure on a dog sled); 7. D (Geneva); 8. A (Cornelius Agrippa); 9. C (Scarlet fever caught nursing Elizabeth); 10. D (The cause of generation and life); 11. C (November); 12. D (Elizabeth); 13. D (William, Victor's youngest brother); 14. C (She is convicted and condemned); 15. A (Ending his own life); 16. C (On the glacier at Montanvert); 17. C (The creature); 18. C (The De Lacey family); 19. A (Safie); 20. C (Felix helped a Turkish merchant escape); 21. A (Robinson Crusoe); 22. C (Toward Geneva); 23. A (A female companion); 24. C (To create the female in secret); 25. B (A remote island in the Orkneys); 26. B (He fears a race of devils); 27. C (Henry Clerval); 28. B (His father); 29. B (At the inn at Evian); 30. C (To turn back south)

Essay assignments

Essay: The costs of unchecked ambition

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about the costs of unchecked ambition. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops the costs of unchecked ambition across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the costs of unchecked ambition. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the costs of unchecked ambition, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of the costs of unchecked ambition in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein, engaging at least four

scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the costs of unchecked ambition in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Creation and responsibility

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about creation and responsibility. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops creation and responsibility across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of creation and responsibility. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of creation and responsibility, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of creation and responsibility in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about creation and responsibility in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on creation and responsibility in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Isolation and the need for companionship

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about isolation and the need for companionship. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops isolation and the need for companionship across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of isolation and the need for companionship. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of isolation and the need for companionship, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of isolation and the need for companionship in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on isolation and the need for companionship in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Nature versus nurture

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about nature versus nurture. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops nature versus nurture across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of nature versus nurture. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of nature versus nurture, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of nature versus nurture in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on nature versus nurture in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on nature versus nurture in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about nature versus nurture in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on nature versus nurture in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: The sublime power of nature

Middle School (600 words; Common Core: W.7.1, RL.7.2): Excerpt-based (Middle School support track): write a five-paragraph essay explaining what Frankenstein teaches about the sublime power of nature. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how Mary Shelley develops the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; Common Core: W.9-10.1, RL.9-10.2): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how Mary Shelley develops the sublime power of nature across Frankenstein. Trace the idea through at least three chapters and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.5): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of Frankenstein (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of the sublime power of nature. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; Common Core: W.11-12.1, RL.11-12.2): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how Mary Shelley's choices in Frankenstein (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of the sublime power of nature, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; Common Core: ICC-WC-1.5, ICC-WC-1.4, ICC-WC-1.7): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places Frankenstein's treatment of the sublime power of nature in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; Common Core: LeL-C2-W-1, LeL-C2-LIT-1): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein that reads the novel against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; Common Core: LeL-C3-W-1, LeL-C3-LIT-1): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; Common Core: LeL-C4-W-1, LeL-C4-LIT-1): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; Common Core: LeL-GR-W-1, LeL-GR-LIT-1): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on the sublime power of nature in Frankenstein, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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